



राजस्थान सरकार

समर्थ महिला समृद्ध राजस्थान

नवजात के संरक्षण से लेकर वृद्ध महिलाओं तक का सम्मान
आधी आबादी का हो रहा उत्थान

■ लाडो प्रोत्साहन योजनान्तर्गत **1.50 लाख**
तक की सहायता, **8.84 लाख**
बालिकाएं लाभान्वित

■ गर्भवती महिलाओं को **6,500** तथा दिव्यांग गर्भवती
महिलाओं को **10,000** की सहायता
■ **15 लाख** आंगनबाड़ी बच्चों को सप्ताह में **5 दिन गर्म दूध**

■ **45,985 छात्राओं** को स्कूटी **13.85 लाख**
बालिकाओं को साइकिल

■ **1.55 लाख** स्वयं सहायता समूहों को **₹739 करोड़** का ऋण
■ **3,432 महिला उद्यमियों** को **₹343 करोड़** के ऋण स्वीकृत

■ **18.21 लाख** महिलाएं बनीं लखपति दीदी
■ **61,078 महिलाओं** को **₹443 करोड़** का ऋण
ऋण सीमा बढ़कर **₹1.50 लाख**

■ महिला सुरक्षा हेतु सार्वजनिक एवं शैक्षणिक संस्थानों में
14,122 सीसीटीवी कैमरों की स्थापना

■ **65 एंटी रोमियो स्कॉर्ड** एवं **600 कालिका** पेट्रोलिंग यूनिट सक्रिय
■ महिला सुरक्षा को और सशक्त बनाने हेतु **2,216 पद** स्वीकृत

■ राष्ट्रीय विधवा पेंशन योजना के तहत **4.17 लाख** महिलाओं को लगभग
662 करोड़ रुपये की पेंशन

■ **25,000** महिलाएं बनीं सोलर दीदी
■ नमो ड्रोन दीदी योजना के तहत **₹2,500 प्रति हेक्टेयर** सहायता

■ **33,321** परिवारों को मुख्यमंत्री कन्यादान योजना का लाभ

■ **₹450** में रसोई गैस सिलेंडर, **68 लाख** परिवारों को
5.87 करोड़ रिफिल पर **₹1,128 करोड़** की सब्सिडी





Emergency personnel and volunteers work at the site of a damaged building after the earthquake in Pereira, Colombia, on Tuesday. REUTERS

Colombia quake toll crosses 200, count of missing over 3,000

Reuters

Pereira, August 11

RESCUE CREWS dug through mountains of shattered concrete in Colombia Tuesday, racing to find survivors after a powerful earthquake killed more than 250 people, according to estimates from local authorities.

Families waited beside the rubble for signs of life. The 7.4-magnitude earthquake, the most powerful to strike the South American country in decades, tore through Colombia's coffee-growing heartland early on Monday, leaving apartment blocks, homes, schools and health centers cracked, leaning or flattened.

In the hardest-hit cities, rescuers worked through the night with cranes, excavators and, at times, their bare hands, cutting through twisted steel and passing buckets of debris in desperate searches for those trapped.

"We are ... focused on the immediate task of saving lives, guaranteeing the arrival of rescue teams, bringing in medical supplies and field hospitals," Interior Minister Rodrigo Laratold *Blu Radio*.

The U.N. humanitarian office OCHA, citing official figures as of Monday night, said 126 people had been confirmed dead and 1,495 injured. But local estimates on Tuesday put the

“We are ... focused on the immediate task of saving lives, guaranteeing the arrival of rescue teams, bringing in medical supplies and field hospitals”

RODRIGO LARA , COLOMBIAN INTERIOR MINISTER

toll around 255, pointing to a disaster still unfolding as crews reached damaged neighborhoods and communications slowly came back online.

Almost 5,000 homes were damaged, while dozens of buildings collapsed and residences were destroyed, OCHA said.

In Cali, residents gathered in the streets after parts of homes and apartment blocks gave way. Families cooked outside, salvaged what they could and braced for another day away from home. Several of the top floors of one of the city's hospitals — some dedicated to pediatric care — collapsed, leaving some patients trapped and 600 others tended to on a street strewn with rubble. Irne Torres Castro, the hospital's director, told *Caracol* television.

Russia frees former US Marine held on disputed charge for over four years

Associated Press

Washington, August 11

RUSSIA HAS released an American military veteran who spent over four years in prison on disputed charges under abusive conditions and was said to be ill and at risk of dying, a group advocating for him said Tuesday.

Robert Gilman was on his way to a US military hospital in Texas, where he will be medically and psychologically assessed and treated, said Eric Lebson, chief strategy officer of Global Reach, a group working to free him and other American detainees abroad. Gilman's family has flown to Texas to be with him, including his mother, who was in Russia attempting to see him at a hospital.

President Donald Trump, however, posted on social media that Gilman will arrive at Andrews Air Force Base in Maryland on Tuesday evening.

"I just spoke to him, and he had one request — A GREAT cheeseburger when he lands,"



Former US Marine Robert Gilman during a hearing in Voronezh, Russia, on April 6, 2026. REUTERS

Trump wrote. "I will take care of that!" Trump said he spoke with Russian President Vladimir Putin before Gilman's release, which Trump said was "very much on a Humanitarian Basis." "We appreciate this decision, and the fact that Russia asked for no one in return — No exchange took place," Trump said.

Gilman, a 32-year-old teacher detained since 2022, was initially handed a 3 1/2-year sentence after he was convicted of beating a police officer who took him off a train for causing disturbance.

MEDIATOR PAK SAYS WASHINGTON AND TEHRAN ARE CLOSE TO 'SOME SORT' OF DEAL

Iran: Strait to remain closed until US meets our demands

4 of crew killed in suspected Houthi attack on cargo ship

Reuters

Dubai, August 11

THE STRAIT of Hormuz will remain closed as long as the US does not change its behaviour and accept Iran's conditions to end the war, the newly appointed secretary of Iran's Supreme National Security Council said on Tuesday.

"As long as America does not change its behaviour and does not accept Iran's conditions, the Strait of Hormuz will not be opened," Mohsen Rezaei, a close ally of Supreme Leader Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei, was quoted by semi-official *Tasnim* news agency as saying. "America must end the war, pay Iran's frozen assets, the war must end throughout the region, including in Lebanon and Gaza," he said. "If an agreement is reached between Iran and Oman regarding the transit route through the Strait of Hormuz, this agreement will be a



Iran's Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi with Pakistan's Interior Minister Mohsin Naqvi in Tehran on Tuesday. REUTERS

matter separate from the closure of the Strait of Hormuz."

Rezaei, appointed Sunday as second-in-command of body that coordinates Iran's security and foreign policy, said the conditions had been transmitted to the US through mediators.

Mohammad Mokhber, an adviser to Khamenei, also said on X on Tuesday that "the punishment of the aggressor continues, and the Strait of Hormuz will not be opened until Iran's conditions are met". Oil futures extended their gains due to con-

cerns over the fate of the strait.

There was no immediate comment from Washington on Iran's latest comments, but President Donald Trump had already raised a new US demand himself - that Iran pay compensation for people killed in wars, attacks and protests - and also accused Tehran of being "devious negotiators".

"We're going to ask for money for the damage they've done over a 50-year period," Trump said at the White House on Monday. In an interview re-

Iran threat forced Trump to take catering truck, board secret flight out of Turkey

Reuters

Washington, August 11

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump took a secret military flight from Turkey last month in an operation that involved him being moved between aircraft in a catering truck, an extraordinary deception prompted by an Iranian assassination threat, the *Washington Post* reported.

The White House said at the time the president was flying aboard Air Force One from Turkey, where he attended a NATO summit, to Britain. But moments after Trump had boarded the plane, he left it in secret via the catering truck and boarded another aircraft for the flight to Britain, the *Post* said on Monday, quoting unnamed sources.

The *New York Times* carried a similar report, quoting un-



Two catering containers alongside Air Force One in Turkey. NYT

named US officials.

Trump had taken a newly renovated Qatari-donated jet to Ankara for the NATO summit but unexpectedly announced he would use an older Air Force One when departing the country, a move that prompted questions about the newer plane's security.

The trip to NATO was the first international travel for the

new plane, whose speedy upgrades triggered questions over its cost and security, and took place as hostilities escalated with Iran, which borders Turkey.

Before departing Ankara, Trump said on Truth Social that he would use an older baby blue Air Force One plane "for old time's sake" to RAF Mildenhall in Britain while the new plane stopped at the same base so

leased late on Monday, he described some of his current options in the war — "just bop along" and let Tehran fail economically or hit them "really, really hard".

"I'm sort of negotiating," Trump told *Real America's Voice* in the phone interview. "They're very devious negotiators."

Before the rhetoric escalated again, Pakistan, one of the main mediators in the conflict, had raised hopes the two sides might be closing in on a deal that would in effect reopen the Strait.

"The signals in the last two, three days are that we are close to some sort of an arrangement," Pakistani Defence Minister Khawaja Asif said in an interview with *Bloomberg News*.

Adding to the rhetoric from both sides, there were reports of new attacks on shipping in the Gulf of Oman and the Red Sea.

Four crew were killed in a suspected attack by Yemen's Iran-backed Houthis on a small cargo vessel in the Bab el-Mandeb Strait on Tuesday, Yemen's Transport Ministry said.

A ship was also hit by a missile off Pakistan, while sailing through Gulf of Oman in a suspected US attack, sources said.

US service members stationed there could tour the aircraft.

After Trump boarded the old Air Force One in front of cameras in Ankara, he was secretly shuttled by the airport catering truck to a smaller plane, an Air Force C-32A, the *Post* reported citing a US official familiar with the operation and corroborating material it reviewed.

The deception operation was triggered by a credible threat to Trump, the *Post* reported.

On this occasion, the journalists who thought they were traveling with Trump on the older Air Force One, which was effectively used as a decoy, reported being advised to keep their window shades in the press cabin closed. The *Post* said aside from reporters, some White House staff also believed that the president was on board.

• BRIEFLY

SYRIA

Former President Assad sentenced to death in absentia for war crimes



Former Syrian president Bashar al-Assad at the Elysee Palace in Paris. FILE

A SYRIAN court sentenced ousted Syrian President Bashar Assad along with his younger brother to death in absentia Tuesday for crimes against humanity and war crimes during Syria's 14-year conflict that left about half a million people dead. "Bashar Assad used state agencies to commit war crimes and crimes against humanity," said judge Fakhreddine al-Aryan. The sentences at the Fourth Criminal Court in Damascus are the first against Assad and his inner circle since the Assad family's five decades in power came to an end 20 months ago. REUTERS

LEBANON

In first for region, Beirut abolishes death penalty

LEBANON'S PARLIAMENT on Tuesday abolished the death penalty and replaced all existing death sentences with life imprisonment, the speaker's office said in a statement. The move makes it the first country in West Asia to formally end capital punishment, after maintaining a de facto moratorium on executions since 2004, although people were technically on death row. REUTERS

SOUTH AFRICA

14 miners found dead at disused mine, say police

AT LEAST 14 artisanal miners are dead and scores are injured at a disused mine in South Africa, police said Tuesday. The South African Police Service said the miners were found dead at a mine near the city of Rustenburg, around 130 kilometres northwest of Johannesburg. The national police service did not give more details on the circumstances of deaths. AP

• NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH

PAKISTAN

President okays appointment of 19 HC judges

PAKISTAN PRESIDENT Asif Ali Zardari on Tuesday approved the appointment of 19 additional judges to five high courts and confirmed five other judges as permanent, ending a weeks-long deadlock between the president's office and the federal government over judicial appointments. PTI

SRI LANKA

Govt eases refugee return from India

SRI LANKA'S government has approved special immigration arrangements to facilitate the voluntary return of refugees in India who left the island nation without valid travel documents during its decades-long civil war, according to a cabinet note issued here on Tuesday. PTI

Congo says over 2,000 dead in Ebola outbreak, fastest growing on record

Associated Press

Bunia, August 11

AT LEAST 2,000 people have died in Congo's Ebola outbreak, the fastest-growing on record, according to the latest data, as health authorities struggle to get help to remote localities due to rebel conflict, bad roads and strikes over payment issues.

Government data published overnight into Tuesday showed the outbreak has recorded a total of 4,381 confirmed cases, including 2,011 deaths. A total of 704 patients are in admission and isolation. The outbreak was declared on May 15 but health authorities say sequencing showed it began months earlier, in February.

It's already the second-largest outbreak in history, only behind the 2014-2016 West Africa outbreak that recorded more than 28,000 cases including over 11,000 deaths.

The Ebola outbreak is unlike most previous ones because the rare Bundibugyo



A health worker dries boots at the treatment centre in Bunia General Hospital in Ituri, eastern Congo, on Tuesday. AP

virus responsible for it has no approved vaccines or treatments. Clinical trials for those have begun in Ituri province, the epicentre of the outbreak, in eastern Congo.

Aid workers say the outbreak continues to outpace response that's been expanding across the five eastern provinces affected. Many health workers have gone on strike to protest lack of payment for their work since the outbreak was declared.

• FROM AIR-CONDITIONED APPAREL TO COOLING SPRAYS THAT CLAIM TO LOWER BODY TEMPERATURE, A MARKET ONCE DOMINATED BY INEXPENSIVE HAND-HELD FANS HAS GROWN TO INCLUDE SOPHISTICATED PRODUCTS

AC vests and UV parasols: Southeast Asia turns to high-tech gadgets to beat the heat

Max Kim

August 11

STROLL THROUGH Tokyo on a summer day and you'll see hand-held fans everywhere. But the light-blue one that Eimi Nakayama was holding on a recent afternoon was a more high-tech variety. Outfitted with a small metal plate that runs on the same science behind semiconductors, it uses electrical currents to generate a chill.

The sensation is "kind of like holding a cold drink against your neck," said Nakayama, a 20-year-old university student. "Maybe because of the plate, the air flow feels a bit cooler, too."

The product has lately been

sweeping through cities in southeast Asia, where a deadly heat wave this month has led to canceled baseball games in South Korea and a new meteorological term in Japan: kokushobi, or "cruel heat day."

Southeast Asia's summers are becoming hotter and longer, and such "personal cooling" has become a ubiquitous part of daily life. A market once dominated by inexpensive hand-held fans now includes a growing array of more sophisticated products, from air-conditioned apparel to cooling sprays that claim to lower your body temperature within seconds.

Sales of cooling products are soaring, and employers and gov-

ernments increasingly see them as a necessity rather than luxury.

As in Japan, the market for such products in South Korea has grown dramatically over the past two years, said Lee Joo-young, an expert in the relationship between clothing and thermal environments at Seoul National University.

She said a major factor is that motors and batteries have become cheaper and more effective, making powerful new cooling products accessible.

In Japan, the birthplace of the fan-cooled jacket — invented by Hiroshi Ichigaya, a former Sony electrical engineer, in 2004 — the online market for "heat countermeasure" prod-



A worker wears an air-conditioned jacket which has cooling fans on its back in Tokyo. REUTERS

ucts has expanded more than sixfold since 2020, according to Rakuten, one of the country's biggest e-commerce platforms.

It now lists roughly 800,000 products in that category.

Ichigaya's invention has since evolved considerably. One

apparel company recently introduced a vest studded with the same metal plates now appearing on hand-held fans.

But these gadgets are no longer just aimed at consumers looking for quick relief during their commutes. Increasingly, they are becoming part of how governments and employers are adapting to extreme heat.

Chinese delivery platform Meituan is piloting "air-con jackets" — another spin on Ichigaya's invention — for its delivery workers in Chongqing, a city in the country's southwest.

In Hubei Province in central China, the state-owned power company has equipped some of its workers with waist-mounted

mini fans.

In Japan, the Ministry of the Environment and Tokyo's metropolitan government have promoted parasols as an effective way to reduce heat stress, while some South Korean municipalities have been outfitting their street cleaners with neon cooling vests.

In South Korea, the need for such technologies is especially great on farms, said Kim In-soo, a researcher at the country's National Institute of Agricultural Sciences. He recently designed his own cooling vest for greenhouse workers that is being piloted at 350 farms around the country.

"Greenhouses are one of the

worst places to be during a heat wave," he said. "It's hot and humid and a lot of the work is time-sensitive harvesting that can't be stopped at will."

The vest, which relies on a technology known as a "vortex tube," is hooked up to a compressor that shoots cold, dry air into thin tubes, which then distribute it across the skin through tiny perforations running throughout the vest.

The race to beat heat has spawned more unusual inventions. In Japan, a company has developed a human-sized refrigerated booth that offers quick relief at construction sites, universities and evacuation shelters for natural disasters. NYT

WEDNESDAY, AUGUST 12, 2026



The IndianEXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

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Happening today

●OVER 400 DELEGATES from India and abroad will gather in Chhattisgarh for the Green Steel and Mining Summit hosted by CII. The two-day event will focus on innovative tech and policy frameworks to support India's green transition in steel sector.

●RACHNATMAK CONGRESS, a platform to connect the Congress with civil society groups, domain experts and social activists, will begin hosting a two-day convention in Delhi.

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THE BIG PICTURE



THE INDUS CODE
PAGE 15

NATION PAGE 8
NTA SUBJECT EXPERT HELD SPECIAL CLASS, GAVE 132 NEET-UG QUESTIONS: CBIPROBE



Personnel of J&K Police on patrol ahead of Independence Day celebrations, in Srinagar on Tuesday. PTI

After threat letter, Kashmiri Pandits working in Valley told to stay home

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, August 11

AFTER A threat letter was posted online warning Kashmiri Pandits working in the Valley to “change their ways”, and publishing the details of some of them, the Jammu and Kashmir government is learnt to have instructed departments under it to send Kashmiri Pandit employees on leave. The government is also learnt to have asked them to remain alert and move to safer places.

This letter emerged around a week after two migrant workers were killed at a brick kiln in south Kashmir's Kulgam on July 31, putting the security establishment on high alert.

Police sources say they are verifying the authenticity of the

CHURCH, CIVIL SOCIETY GROUPS FEAR PAST INVESTMENTS CAN BE PENALISED

Amid pushback from Opp, Govt ready to refer FCRA Bill to JPC



Counter-protests by MPs from the Opposition parties (left) and the ruling NDA at Makar Dwar of Parliament, Tuesday. ANI MORE REPORTS. PAGE 6

Govt bid to break deadlock in Parliament, allay concerns over asset-vesting rules

Deeptiman Tiwary
New Delhi, August 11

THE GOVERNMENT is ready to send the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, to a Joint Parliamentary Committee (JPC), sources told *The Indian Express* Tuesday.

The Opposition has been demanding the withdrawal of

the Bill and civil society and religious bodies, especially the Church, have expressed concern that asset-vesting rules in the Bill could be used to penalise past investments. Several Church bodies have voiced their fears in meetings with Union Home Minister Amit Shah over the last few days.

A Union Minister said,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Business as Usual
By EP UNNY



Bills passed without debate; Opp and BJP face off outside

Asad Rehman & Jatin Anand
New Delhi, August 11

AS THE impasse in Parliament continued on Tuesday, with Bills being passed without debate, the face-off between the ruling alliance and the Opposition shifted to the steps outside the Makar Dwar, with Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra exchanging words with National

Democratic Alliance (NDA) MPs who were protesting.

While BJP-led NDA MPs protested against the violence on students in Jharkhand, the Opposition held a demonstration nearby against the alleged theft of donation funds at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya and demanded a statement from Union Home Minister

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Relief to Adani: US court permanently dismisses criminal case against him

Welcome decision, committed to nation-building: Gautam Adani

Press Trust of India
New York, August 11

A US federal judge has permanently dismissed criminal charges against Adani Group chairman Gautam Adani and his nephew Sagar, removing a major legal overhang that had dogged the ports-to-energy conglomerate for nearly two years.

US District Judge Nicholas Garaufis of the Eastern District of New York approved the Justice Department's request to dismiss the charges.

Adani welcomed the decision, saying he accepted it with “humility” and “deep respect” for the judicial process.

In a 47-page order issued on

August 10, Garaufis granted the Justice Department's Rule 48 (a) motion to dismiss Counts Two, Three and Four of the indictment against Gautam Adani, Sagar Adani, and former Adani Green Energy CEO Vneet Jaain.

The counts covered securities-fraud conspiracy, wire-fraud conspiracy and securities fraud. The dismissals were with prejudice, meaning the charges cannot be refiled.

Garaufis reserved judgment on Count One, alleging Foreign Corrupt Practices Act violations, and Count Five, alleging conspiracy to obstruct justice, both involving five non-appearing, India-based co-defendants: Ranjit Gupta, Cyril Cabanes, Saurabh Agarwal, Deepak Malhotra and Rupesh Agarwal.

The Justice Department has until August 31 to satisfy the court's requirements, while counsel for the non-appearing

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 9

EXPRESS special

Question mark on rehab of families in Adani Dharavi project, landfill cleanup faces delays

Five of seven statutory clearances pending; NECL says was informed late about key approvals; BMC official says scrapping tender will create more delays

Pratip Acharya
Mumbai, August 11

A SHOWPIECE Maharashtra government project to relocate a section of residents of Dharavi in Deonar, the site of the largest and oldest landfill in Mumbai, is stuck in a maze of red tape. Work is yet to begin on clearing a portion of the 99-year-old landfill — marking a delay of over six months from the original deadline, Right to Information (RTI)

records obtained and investigated by *The Indian Express* show.

The records show that while the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC) awarded a Rs 2,537-crore contract to clean up the landfill to Hyderabad-based Navayuga Engineering Company Limited (NECL), marking January 2026 as the deadline for all approvals

YOUR RIGHT to know
AN EXPRESS RTI APPLICATION

to be obtained and work to begin, five of the seven statutory clearances are pending.

This delay raises fresh questions over the timeline for housing thousands of families on the Dharavi site. All residents are to be handed over houses within seven years of the masterplan approval in May 2025.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 9



Maharashtra govt earmarked 124 acres in Deonar for rehabilitation housing under the project in October 2024. AMIT CHAKRAVARTY/FILE

Deepening ties, NASA invites ISRO to join its Moon Base programme

Anjali Marar & Amitabh Sinha
New Delhi, August 11

MOVING TO strengthen their partnership, US space agency NASA has invited ISRO to join its Moon Base programme, the recently-launched effort to get humans back to the Moon with the larger objective of setting up a permanent settlement there.

The offer, disclosed Tuesday, was made at the ninth meeting of the India-US Civil Space Joint Working Group in



US envoy Sergio Gor spoke at the Bengaluru meeting last week. FILE

Bengaluru on August 5 and 6 which US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor also addressed.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

E. EXPLAINED

The collaboration
NASA's invitation to ISRO for the Moon Base programme reflects the growing ties between the two space agencies. It comes in the wake of Shubhanshu Shukla's Axiom flight to the ISS last year and the launch of the dual-frequency radar satellite NISAR. In 2023, India signed the US-led Artemis Accords.

Pilot of Air India flight that dropped 300 feet tests positive for marijuana

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, August 11

THE CONFIRMATORY drug test of the Air India pilot-in-command of a Phuket-Delhi flight that fell 300 feet, leaving 24 people injured, has come in as positive for marijuana, according to sources.

The Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA) had said on Sunday that the preliminary drug screening gave a “non-negative” result.

The samples were sent for



24 people on the Phuket-Delhi flight on August 4 were injured

confirmatory testing, and the result has come as positive with the substance identified as mari-

juana, it is learnt. Confirmatory tests are required in the case of a non-negative preliminary screening as certain foods and medications can throw up false positives in initial screenings.

Emails sent to MoCA, Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) and Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB) regarding the confirmatory drug test did not elicit any response. Air India didn't comment on the development.

The Air India Airbus A320

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 9

● ON STICKY WICKET AS MUMBAI INDIANS CAPTAIN AFTER TEAM LOST 10 OF 14 GAMES IN LATEST SEASON

Hardik seeks return to Gujarat Titans, with captaincy rider; IPL franchise says no

Devendra Pandey
Mumbai, August 11

MUMBAI INDIANS' captain Hardik Pandya held talks with Gujarat Titans over a possible return to the franchise but was rejected after he made it conditional on being reinstated as captain, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

According to sources, Gujarat Titans, where Pandya won the Indian Premier League (IPL) as captain in their inaugural campaign in 2022 before

moving back to Mumbai Indians in 2024, had been open to bringing him back. They had already discussed the prospect with current captain Shubman Gill, but Pandya's captaincy condition was a deal-breaker.

“The franchise was fine with him making a return. They had even discussed the same with its captain Shubman Gill, and he, too, had agreed that the franchise could trade him back. But when his condition of captaincy was put up, everyone said no to it,” said a

source.

Gill is the India captain for both Tests and One-Day Internationals.

When contacted, a Gujarat Titans representative refused to comment on the matter.

“Hardik Pandya had no direct conversation with any franchise whatsoever regarding transfer trade, or otherwise. If any approach has been made to him, that has been directed to the MI franchise,” Pandya's spokesperson said.

The development follows weeks of uncertainty over Pandya's position at Mumbai In-



Hardik Pandya (left) was released by Mumbai Indians in 2022, joined Gujarat Titans and won the title as their captain, and then returned to MI in 2024 to replace Rohit Sharma. AMIT CHAKRAVARTY/FILE

dians. *The Indian Express* had reported earlier that MI's team management was not keen to retain him as captain and was even evaluating his role in the squad, after a season in which the team lost 10 of their 14 games, finished ninth, and extended the franchise's title drought to six years.

The unravelling was laid bare in a team talk by the coaching staff after MI's final game of the season, against Rajasthan Royals. “The coaching staff was very clear in their message to the senior players that wherever they play, they

need to be coachable. There were many instances where the coaching staff recommended something which was backed by data but players didn't follow it,” a source had told *The Indian Express*.

Mumbai Indians, with among the biggest names in the IPL, have looked out of step with the T20 format of late. None of their players featured in the race for the Orange (most runs) or Purple (most wickets) Caps; their best batsman, Ryan Rickelton, finished 17th among the season's run-getters, while leg-spinner Allah Ghazanfar

was 14th among wicket-takers. Pandya's relationship with the MI fanbase has also been complicated since he was released by the franchise in 2022, joined Gujarat Titans and won the title as their captain, then returned to MI in 2024 to replace Rohit Sharma, days after the latter had led India to the 2023 50-over World Cup final. Fans booed Pandya through his first season back, when MI finished bottom of the table.

A partial recovery in 2025 had raised hopes of a reconciliation, but the 2026 season undid them.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

FCRA Bill

“There is nothing in the Bill to oppose it. It is not against any community. However, we are ready to send the Bill to a JPC for further deliberation.”

The Opposition parties, including the Congress, TMC, Left parties and DMK, have been demanding that the Bill be withdrawn entirely. However, sources said the government’s willingness to refer it to a JPC could provide a way out of the standoff inside and outside Parliament — the monsoon session is due to end August 13.

A CPM MP said, “Through this Bill, the government is not trying to regulate the use of foreign contributions. It is actually trying to regulate the organisations receiving them. That is not acceptable. The provisions of the Bill are draconian. We want the Bill to be withdrawn completely. But if the government does not want to withdraw the Bill, we are okay with it being sent to the JPC.”

The Congress too has maintained that the Bill should be withdrawn although sources said the party would be agreeable to its referral to a JPC.

DMK MPP Wilson met Shah last week with a delegation of Church leaders and handed over a memorandum expressing concerns over provisions of the Bill being perceived as adverse to the Christian community. The memorandum had sought withdrawal of the Bill or its reference to a JPC.

Mizoram Chief Minister Lalthuoma too met the Union Home Minister and conveyed concerns of the state’s Christian community.

An AAP MP said the government’s argument that only a small fraction of FCRA contributions actually went to Christian NGOs missed the larger issue. “A law passed by Parliament will outlive the government of the day. It will have far-reaching consequences,” the MP said.

A JPC and a Select Committee are both ad hoc committees constituted to examine a Bill in greater detail, but the key difference is in their composition. A JPC has members from both Houses of Parliament, with the composition decided through motions adopted by Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha, while a Select Committee is constituted by one House and consists only of members of that House.

In either case, the committee can examine the Bill clause by clause, hear the government and stakeholders, seek evidence and suggest amendments; its recommendations are not binding on the government, though they carry considerable parliamentary weight. A JPC is generally seen as a broader mechanism because it brings MPs from both Houses into the examination process. Some key Bills that were sent to the JPC included the Waqf (Amendment) Bill, Personal Data Protection Bill, One Nation, One Election Bill.

The government’s decision to consider a JPC referral for the FCRA Bill is also being viewed in the context of its political outreach to the Christian community in Kerala and Tamil Nadu. The BJP has been seeking to expand its electoral footprint in Kerala and has been making a concerted effort to build ties with the Christian community, whose support it sees as important for any future electoral headway in the state.

The timing is also significant in the context of the BJP’s efforts to secure DMK’s support on the delimitation Bill that the government is planning to bring in the near future.

While the government has the numbers to push the Bill, the Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOH6oBd0F>

through Parliament, sources maintained that the government does not want to pass the Bill without proper discussion.

The Bill proposes to insert a new Chapter IIIA into the FCRA, providing for the vesting of foreign contributions and assets created from them in a government-designated authority in certain circumstances.

One of the key concerns relates to the proposed concept of “cessation” of an FCRA certificate. Under Section 14B, a certificate would be deemed to have ceased if an organisation does not apply for renewal, its renewal application is refused or it is not renewed before expiry. Section 16A provides that, in such cases, the organisation’s foreign contribution and assets created from it would provisionally vest in the Designated Authority.

The authority could take possession of the assets and, if considered necessary in the public interest, manage the organisation’s activities. If the organisation subsequently obtains a fresh, renewed or restored certificate within the prescribed period, the assets are to be returned; failing that, the assets would permanently vest in the authority.

The Bill also provides that assets permanently vested in the

authority can be transferred to a government ministry, department, agency or local authority, or sold, with the sale proceeds and unutilised foreign contribution credited to the Consolidated Fund of India.

In the case of a place of worship, however, the authority is required to ensure that its religious character is maintained while entrusting its management or operation to an eligible person.

Another concern is that the proposed law would cover an asset in its entirety even if it was created or acquired partly from foreign contribution and partly from other sources. The organisation can apply for the return of a “distinct or ascertainable” portion attributable to domestic funds, but the entire asset would initially vest with the Designated Authority. This has raised concerns among organisations that have built institutions such as schools, hospitals or other facilities through a combination of foreign and domestic donations.

The Bill had also attracted particular criticism over Section 16B, which provided for retrospective application of the new framework. It stated that foreign contributions and assets that had already vested under the existing Section 15 before the amendment came into force would be deemed to have been provisionally vested under the

new Chapter IIIA from the date the amendment takes effect. This would bring such assets under the new regime governing their management, return, transfer and eventual disposal. The retrospective provision had become especially contentious amid fears that, when read with the provisions on “cessation”, the new regime could have implications for organisations whose FCRA registrations had lapsed in the past.

While the Bill does not expressly state that assets of all such organisations would be retrospectively taken over, critics have argued that the interaction of Sections 14B and 16A could potentially bring assets created from foreign contributions under the new vesting mechanism.

The government has maintained that the FCRA amendments are intended to plug gaps in the existing law relating to the management and disposal of foreign-funded assets when an organisation’s registration is cancelled, surrendered or ceases to exist.

The Statement of Objects and Reasons says the existing framework has resulted in administrative uncertainty and scope for misuse and proposes a comprehensive system of provisional and permanent vesting, supervision, management and disposal of such assets.

Moon Base

In 2023, India had joined the Artemis Accords, a US-led space alliance, whose stated purpose is to evolve and commit to a common set of principles that govern the civil exploration of outer space including the Moon. India was the 27th country to sign on the Artemis Accords. Now, a total of 70 countries are part of the Accords.

“NASA invited ISRO to join its Moon Base program, building on the two countries’ partnership under the Artemis Accords,” a read-out from the US Embassy in India stated.

“The two sides also agreed to advance discussions for cooperation on open scientific data sharing under the Accords,” it stated.

In the last few years, the space agencies of the two countries have come closer to each other than ever before. The same year that India joined the Artemis Accords, the two countries had also agreed to develop a “strategic framework for human spaceflight cooperation”.

It was in the same vein that NASA had agreed to provide advanced training to Indian astronauts at its facilities with the objective of sending them to the International Space Station through privately-operated

missions. The flight of Indian astronaut Shubhanshu Shukla to the ISS in 2025 was a result of this arrangement.

Last year, two space agencies achieved a big milestone when they launched the long-awaited NISAR (NASA-ISRO Synthetic Aperture Radar) mission, an ambitious and first-of-its-kind joint space mission.

The offer to cooperate further on Moon missions is a logical extension of these efforts.

“The August 5-6 meeting focused on further expanding commercial and civil space cooperation between the two countries. The two sides also spoke on furthering joint missions to the Moon and beyond, and identified the area in which the two countries could share their expertise and knowledge,” an ISRO scientist said.

“NISAR’s data sharing and operations were discussed in depth. It is seen as a successful joint venture and could pave the way for more such complex space missions, including the human space flight mission and building the lunar base,” the scientist said.

NASA has launched an Artemis programme to take humans back to the Moon.

ISRO is also pursuing its own human spaceflight programme Gaganyaan. It has plans to make a human landing on the Moon by 2040.

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RG9mIjMzgl

Face-off

Amit Shah on the police crackdown on protesters in Delhi on July 20.

BJP MP Sanjay Jaiswal, who led the NDA protests, said, “We are ready for a detailed discussion (on students’ agitation), but Rahul Gandhi, by changing the goalpost every day, still does not let Parliament function. The Home Minister is ready to answer every question.” Sources said the decision to hold the protest was taken at the NDA’s weekly meeting. It was decided that all senior MPs, except the ministers, would join the demonstration.

As the Samajwadi Party (SP) contingent led the Opposition protest, Priyanka Gandhi addressed the BJP MPs, telling them that Rahul Gandhi, the Leader of the Opposition (LoP)

in the Lok Sabha, had “met students from Jharkhand”. The BJP’s Surat MP, Mukesh Dalal, responded by asking the Wayanad MP why the LoP had not visited Jharkhand yet.

Targeting the BJP, Priyanka Gandhi said, “For the first time, I am seeing ruling party MPs protesting. We have forced them to do so. Now they should come forward and make a statement.”

A few metres away, BJP’s Tarun Chugh and Congress MP Varsha Gaikwad shouted slogans at each other — “Rahul Gandhi *maafi mange* (Rahul Gandhi apologise)” and “Amit Shah *maafi maange* (Amit Shah apologise)” — even as senior security officials stepped in to ensure the situation did not spiral out of control.

“Rahul Gandhi’s double-face has been exposed. Whether it is the streets or Parliament, his dual character has emerged.

You don’t have a single word to say against the atrocities being committed against students by police in Jharkhand. On the one hand, you tried to hatch a conspiracy to politically hijack the students’ protest at Jantar Mantar; Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s government accepted all their demands, but a twin face when it comes to Jharkhand?” said Chugh, a Rajya Sabha MP.

“Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi’s concern towards students’ issues is very clear; he always wants to stand with students and has categorically stated that the attack on students in Ranchi is unacceptable, emphasising that their demands must be met and negotiated peacefully. The way the BJP and the RSS are getting involved to politicise the student movement is unacceptable,” Congress whip in the Lok Sabha, Manickam Tagore, said.

SP’s Rajya Sabha MP Ram

Gopal Yadav targeted the NDA over the Ram Temple issue, saying, “The temple donation theft case is not just national; it’s international. Billions of dollars have been sent from abroad, but we can’t trace where the gold and silver have gone. There’s no account for it... They’re toying with people’s faith.”

Congress MP Jairam Ramesh took a swipe at Shah, saying, “After all that planting of news and desperate attempts to shift the narrative, the Union Home Minister was a no-show in the Lok Sabha today as well, even though he had business listed against his name. Once again, he has proved that those who intimidate are themselves cowards.”

The Lok Sabha passed without debate two more Bills, including one seeking to rename Kerala as Keralam, as the Opposition continued to protest, demanding Shah’s presence in



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आवेदन की अंतिम तिथि : 14 अगस्त 2026

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LAW MAY BE REPLACED WITH NEW POLICY FRAMEWORK

Govt repeals B&B law months after Hauz Rani fire killed 23

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, August 11

DELHI IS overhauling the way bed-and-breakfast establishments operate in the city, with the State Assembly Tuesday approving a proposal to repeal a nearly two-decade-old law governing them. It plans to replace it with a new policy framework.

The move comes after a fire at a B&B in Malviya Nagar claimed 23 lives in June and triggered a city-wide crackdown on properties violating safety norms and building bylaws.

More than 750 B&B establishments are currently registered with the Delhi Tourism Department under the existing law. The government stated that the proposed changes are aimed at keeping pace with the changing tourism and hospitality sector and making the rules more flexible.

The Delhi Bed and Breakfast Establishments (Repeal) Bill, 2026 was introduced in the Assembly on Tuesday, repealing the National Capital Territory of



At the site of the blaze in Malviya Nagar. FILE

Delhi (Incredible India) Bed and Breakfast Establishments (Registration and Regulation) Act, 2007, along with its amendments of 2010 and 2021.

The existing B&B Act was enacted in 2007, at a time when online accommodation booking platforms were not widely available. Speaking during the Monsoon Session, BJP Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa: "The act is very old and has several shortcomings. We also witnessed a fire incident in which many innocent people lost their lives."

He also said the government is considering replacing the existing statutory framework

with a policy-based system that would provide greater flexibility while ensuring necessary checks and balances. "We want to deregulate it to an extent and improve the compliance pattern. The Government of India also has a B&B policy, which we are studying. Based on what emerges, a framework will be prepared and a better policy will be brought for Delhi," Sirsa said.

According to the Bill, the repeal will come into force on a date to be notified by the government in the Official Gazette. To avoid creating panic among people already registered and running B&Bs in the city, the proposed Bill provides that existing registrations, certificates, orders, approvals and proceedings under the repealed Acts will continue to remain valid, as long as they are not inconsistent with the provisions of the new Act.

It also states that the repeal will not affect the previous operation of the laws or anything already done under them.

As per the document, Tourism Minister Kapil Mishra cited the need for a "flexible" policy. "Over a period of time, the tourism and hospitality sector has undergone significant transformation, including the emergence of new forms of accommodation and evolving policy approaches. In this context, it has been considered necessary to discontinue the existing statutory framework governing bed and breakfast establishments and to replace it with a more flexible and facilitative policy regime," read the bill document undersigned by Mishra.

Mishra said the government proposes to revamp and re-initiate the regulation and promotion of B&B establishments through an executive policy framework, which would be implemented in a more liberalised manner, while continuing to ensure compliance with applicable laws. "... During the transition period, fresh registrations and processing of pending applications under the existing Act shall remain in abeyance," it read.

LAST DAY OF DELHI ASSEMBLY'S MONSOON SESSION

AAP protests in Assembly against rice 'scam', MLAs marshalled out

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 11

ON THE last day of the Monsoon Session Tuesday, AAP leaders staged a protest in the Delhi Assembly against alleged irregularities in rice procurement. The leaders shouted slogans and threw rice in the House, following which eight were marshalled out of the Assembly.

The leaders also demanded the resignation of Food and Supplies Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa. The MLAs squatted on the floor in front of LoP Atishi's office, with rice sacks before them, and raised slogans like: "Gareeb ka chawal kahan gaya?" (Where did the rice meant for the poor go?). Sirsa said they neither bought, nor sold any rice.

"We had a representation from a company. I only wrote 'May be considered as per rules'. I think, the Opposition has no real issue left to raise... I will take them to court..." Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Sirsa said he will send a defamation notice to AAP's Delhi unit president Saurabh Bharadwaj and MLA Sanjeev Jha. "This is the same old politics of the Aam Aadmi Party and Arvind Kejriwal Ji—when ever the BJP government works for Delhi's people, bring out new accusations and stories to divert attention," Sirsa wrote on X.

Bharadwaj, addressing Sirsa, wrote: "A responsible minister should calmly answer the opposition's questions. Don't try to intimidate by threatening court action." "Crores of rupees were earned as illegal commission," he said in another post.

Sprinkling pesticides to remove termites: CM slams AAP regime

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 11

HITTING OUT at the previous AAP government, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday said her government is "sprinkling pesticides" to remove the "termites" that had infested the system and affected governance, development and the implementation of schemes and projects. Addressing the Assembly on the last day of the Monsoon Session, Gupta, while citing findings of the CAG reports tabled in the House, said the previous government, steeped in scams, was headed by a chief minister (Arvind Kejriwal) who did not hold a single portfolio.

"Two major reports tabled in the House were, in fact, a report card. The report card had been prepared neither by the Opposition nor the government or any political party. It had been prepared by the CAG, the country's highest constitutional audit institution... The audit institution has explained in detail how irregularities took place in the use of public money and Delhi's funds were misused during the tenure of the previous government," she added.

The CAG report on Delhi's electricity subsidy scheme had said that subsidy expenditure had increased from Rs 2,405.59 crore in 2019-20 to Rs 3,161 crore in 2022-23. It added that the policy "did not target the deserving and disadvantaged section of the population and paid it to nearly the entire domestic consumer base".

The second CAG report said that Delhi's e-procurement system used common PAN



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta with others at Assembly on Tuesday.

● BILLS PASSED

● The Delhi Bed and Breakfast Establishment (Repeal) Bill, 2026

● Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (Amendment) Bill 2026 to change cut-off date for jhuggi jhopri clusters from January 2006 to January 2025

● Delhi (Right of Citizens to Time Bound and Ease of Delivery of Services) Bill, 2026

numbers and identical email IDs, pointing to possible collusion and cover bidding. The report, which examined the system between 2017-18 and 2022-23, found that in 7,181 tenders worth Rs 3,21,744 crore, involving 14,527 valid bids, bidders had used the same IP addresses. "We are sprinkling pesticides and AAP's termites are coming out," the CM said.

Gupta alleged that the AAP government had "committed scams in all departments — from education to health".

She said that of the Rs 80,798-

crore Budget in 2024-25, "only around Rs 61,000 crore was spent out...". She claimed that if capital expenditure had been undertaken in public interest, roads and flyovers could have been built, schools could have been opened and other essential development works could have been carried out.

"But this was not the previous government's focus, the CM said. "Its objective was to find ways to commit scams, siphon off money & mislead people by putting up large photographs even without doing the work."

BMW mows down woman crossing road in Delhi Cantt, locals protest

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, August 11

A 48-YEAR-OLD woman was killed after she was allegedly hit by a BMW in the Delhi Cantonment area on Tuesday afternoon.

Police said the accused, Deepak, 38, was apprehended. A resident of Pratap Nagar in Mandoli, he worked as a driver and was returning from the Delhi Airport.

The accident triggered a protest by local residents, who blocked the road for nearly three hours, disrupting traffic movement towards Terminal-3 (T-3) of the airport.

According to police, they received a PCR call regarding the accident at the Delhi Cantt police station around noon.

A police team reached the spot, but the injured woman had already been shifted to Deen Dayal Upadhyay Hospital, where doctors declared her dead.

The woman was identified as Jaiwanti, 48, a resident of East Mehram Nagar. Police said she worked as a cleaner with the Cantonment Board. A preliminary inquiry revealed that Jaiwanti was crossing the road



Victim Jaiwanti. EXPRESS

when she was allegedly hit by the BMW.

Describing the incident, local resident Sonu Prajapati said, "She was a resident of this village and belonged to the Valmiki community. She was returning home from work for lunch and was crossing the road when the BMW came at high speed and hit her. She was thrown to the ground and seriously injured."

"When people in the village came to know that one of our women was lying injured on the road, everyone gathered at the spot. The villagers then blocked the road in protest. The road remained blocked for around two-and-a-half to three hours. Senior police officers eventually came to the spot and assured us that the accused had

been apprehended and that action would be taken at the earliest," he said.

The resident also raised concerns about road safety in the area, claiming that accidents had occurred there in the past. "There is a school barely 50 metres from the spot, yet no adequate safety measures have been put in place... What happened today was extremely serious. A woman has lost her life," Prajapati added.

According to the resident, the road is an important and heavily used stretch connecting the airport terminals and other major routes.

For Jaiwanti's three children, the accident has left them facing both an emotional and financial crisis.

Her daughter, Bindu, said, "We lost our father... our mother was the sole breadwinner of the family... we cannot fathom the fact that she is gone..."

"We have already lost several members of our family, one after the other, and now this has happened. We want justice for our mother and a permanent solution to our financial difficulties so we can survive," she added.

New PM-POSHAN menu: Idli-sambar in govt schools soon

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, August 11

IDLI-SAMBAR will soon be on the plates of students in Delhi government schools, with the dish set to be introduced within two weeks under a revised PM-POSHAN menu that also replaces *ragi halwa* with wheat

flour and *chana masala*, and vegetable *daliya* with jowar and bajra. The Directorate of Education (DoE) has directed the schools and implementing agencies to make the necessary arrangements by August 24.

The revised menu replaces some of the existing meal items and includes *poori* with black

chana gravy, rice with *chhole* and mashed vegetables, *poori* with *chhole*, rice with dal and rice with *kadhi*, as per an order issued by the DoE on Monday.

While most of the revised menu will come into force immediately, idli with sambar has been given a two-week transition period as its preparation

requires specific equipment, specialised ingredients, dedicated infrastructure and trained manpower, it said.

The meal review panel recommended the changes after reviewing the existing weekly menu, meal coverage, stakeholder feedback and implementation experience, the DoE said.

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[Regulation 52 (8), read with Regulation 52 (4) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (LODR Regulations)] Extract of the Unaudited Financial Results for the Quarter ended 30 th June 2026 (₹ in Cr)									
S. No.	Particulars	Standalone		Consolidated		Quarter Ended 30.06.2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter Ended 30.06.2025 (Unaudited)	Year Ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)	Year Ended 31.03.2025 (Audited)
		Quarter Ended 30.06.2026	Quarter Ended 30.06.2025	Quarter Ended 30.06.2026	Quarter Ended 30.06.2025				
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8		
1	Total Income from Operations	1,625.47	1,079.59	7,087.50	1,625.47	1,079.67	7,087.66		
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items#)	350.31	180.60	1,028.58	350.03	180.11	1,018.84		
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items#)	350.31	180.60	1,028.58	350.03	180.11	1,018.84		
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items#)	293.83	144.24	1,036.15	293.57	143.88	1,028.97		
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit/ (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	291.18	144.47	1,028.94	290.92	144.11	1,021.76		
6	Paid up Equity Share Capital	4,358.53	3,665.88	4,358.53	4,358.53	3,665.88	4,358.53		
7	Other equity (excluding Revaluation Reserve)	8,256.55	7,535.66	7,965.38	8,246.91	7,531.25	7,955.92		
8	Securities Premium Account	-	-	-	-	-	-		
9	Net worth*	12,615.08	11,188.76	12,323.91	12,605.44	11,184.35	12,314.45		
10	Paid up Debt Capital	23,185.03	22,449.13	23,249.92	23,217.25	22,515.08	23,320.28		
11	Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares	-	-	-	-	-	-		
12	Debt Equity Ratio	1.84	2.00	1.89	1.84	2.01	1.89		
13	Earnings Per equity share (of ₹10/-each) (for continuing and discontinued operations) --								
	1. Basic: (in ₹)	0.67	0.39	2.79	0.67	0.39	2.78		
	2. Diluted: (in ₹)	0.67	0.39	2.78	0.67	0.39	2.76		
14	Capital Redemption Reserve	-	-	-	-	-	-		
15	Debenture Redemption Reserve	491.87	387.45	467.26	491.87	387.45	467.26		
16	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	1.39	1.42	1.68	1.38	1.41	1.67		
17	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	2.64	2.43	2.37	2.64	2.43	2.37		
# - Exceptional and/or extraordinary items adjusted in the Statement of Profit and Loss in accordance with Ind AS Rules / AS Rules, whichever is applicable.									
* Excluding fly ash utilization reserve.									
Notes:									
1. The above results have been approved by the Board of Directors at their meeting held on 10.08.2026.									
2. The above is an extract of the detailed format of financial Results filed with the Stock Exchange(s) under Regulation 52 of the Listing Regulations.									
3. The full format of the Financial Results is available on the websites of the stock exchange(s) and THDCIL (https://search.nseindia.com/content/debt/WDM/TIL671_1008202620223_Outcome.pdf) and https://beta.bseindia.com/xml-data/corpfiling/AttachLive/dc4f8b8e-3394-456b-b799-0a8186ced878.pdf)									
4. For the other line items referred in regulation 52(4) of the Listing Regulations, pertinent disclosures have been made to the stock exchange(s) (NSE and BSE) and can be accessed on the URL (https://search.nseindia.com/content/debt/WDM/TIL671_1008202620223_Outcome.pdf) and https://beta.bseindia.com/xml-data/corpfiling/AttachLive/dc4f8b8e-3394-456b-b799-0a8186ced878.pdf)									
5. Previous Periods figures have been reclassified wherever considered necessary.									
Date: 10.08.2026									
Place: New Delhi									
Follow us: f @THDCIL24x7 t @thdc_india_limited i @THDC India Limited-Official y @THDC India Limited-Official x @THDCIL_MOP									
For and on Behalf of Board of Directors									
Sd/- (Sipan Kumar Garg) Managing Director and Director (Finance) DIN: 10746205									

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EXPRESS special

Rain hits landfill clean-up, MCD deadlines at risk

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, August 11

MONSOON RAIN has slowed biomining operations at Delhi's three largest landfill sites, potentially delaying the Municipal Corporation of Delhi's (MCD) effort to meet deadlines for clearing decades-old waste from the city's towering garbage dumps.

According to the civic body's dashboard, the slowdown has been most pronounced at the Okhla landfill, where daily biomining output — which had averaged between 6,000 and 9,000 metric tonnes per day (TPD) — fell to around 650 TPD between August 3 and 11 with several days showing no legacy waste has been lifted. During the same period, around 2,800 TDP of municipal waste continued to arrive at the site daily, offsetting much of the progress.

At Bhalswa landfill, daily processing has declined to roughly 1,700 TPD last week, after averaging between the usual 6,000 and 11,500 TPD, according to the MCD dashboard. Around 4,300 TPD of fresh waste is being dumped daily at the landfill. The drop is significant as MCD has set a goal of eliminating both the Okhla and Bhalswa landfill by December.

The Ghazipur landfill, the city's largest, has also fallen short of its target. The MCD has set a daily biomining goal of 7,000 TDP of legacy waste there, but official data shows that only around 1,400 TPD was lifted over the last nine days. Meanwhile, another 2,400 TDP of fresh municipal solid waste are deposited at the site each day.

Urban Development Minister Ashish Sood had directed the MCD to ramp up the biomining capacity from 7,000



NUMBERS AT A GLANCE

LANDFILL	TARGET/EARLIER OUTPUT	CURRENT OUTPUT	FRESH WASTE ADDED DAILY
Okhla	6,000–9,000 TPD*	650 TPD	2,800 TPD
Bhalswa	6,000–11,500 TPD	1,700 TPD	4,300 TPD
Ghazipur	7,000 TPD	1,400 TPD	2,400 TPD

*Metric tonnes per day; Source: July-August biomining report from eSBM MCD Portal

TPD to 12,000 TPD by July 31 to meet the December 2027 deadline, while on his visit to the Ghazipur landfill site in June.

The process

Biomining involves excavating legacy waste, biologically treating it and separating recyclable and reusable materials, allowing portions of landfill land to be reclaimed.

Officials say the recent rainfall has complicated that process. "Heavy rainfall has made the waste wet. This wet waste gets clogged in the trommels and affects the separation process. The machines have to be cleaned multiple times, making it difficult to meet the output target," a senior MCD official said.

A civic body official on site, explained the process of biomining. "Biomining is done by using trommels which are large, elevated rotating drums equipped with perforated screens. As excavated legacy waste is fed into the elevated end of the cylinder, the drum slowly rotates, causing the material to tumble and

eventually separate."

Biomining relies on trommels — large, rotating, cylindrical screens that separate excavated waste into different categories. As waste becomes saturated with rainwater, it clumps together and sticks inside the machinery, reducing efficiency and requiring repeated cleaning.

The sorting process produces three primary streams: inert material, refuse-derived fuel (RDF) and construction and demolition waste.

RDF consists largely of combustible material such as non-recyclable plastics, paper and cardboard that can be used as an alternative fuel in cement plants, another MCD official said.

As per a report submitted by the MCD to the National Green Tribunal in 2025, inert material and construction waste recovered through biomining are transported to low-lying areas in Uttar Pradesh and Haryana for use in proposed industrial and commercial developments.

The disruption

Officials acknowledged that the monsoon regularly disrupts the operation and said contractors are likely to maximise processing before the season begins. "We always advise the contracted firms to achieve their targets before the monsoon arrives because the biomining process slows considerably during this period. If they fail to meet the second-phase deadlines, penalties will be imposed," another official said.

Decades-old problem

The MCD began biomining in 2019 after directions from the National Green Tribunal to scientifically process and remove legacy waste that had accumulated over decades.

The city's landfill sites, some of which have been in operation since the 1980s, grew into vast mounds of garbage. Ghazipur, which rises to about 65 m, has become one of the country's most recognisable landfill mountains.

Officials said that a new fresh waste processing plant is being built at Okhla with a daily capacity of 1,400 TPD, which will be completed by October to increase the pace of biomining.

According to MCD officials, about 30 of the 62 acres at the Okhla landfill have been reclaimed, while roughly 25 of Bhalswa's 70 acres have been cleared. At Ghazipur, around 20 acres have been reclaimed, with the second phase of biomining scheduled for completion in September.

As of June, the MCD estimated that nearly 100 lakh TPD of legacy waste remained across the three landfill sites. Ghazipur accounted for about 69 lakh TPD, followed by Bhalswa with 18 lakh TPD and Okhla with 12 lakh TPD.

Skywatch



Forecast: August 12, 2026

Generally cloudy sky. Possibility of very light rain during afternoon, evening.

MAX: 34-36

1.8°C above normal

MIN: 24-26

3°C below normal

•Sunrise: 5:49 AM (August 13)

•Sunset: 7:04 PM (August 12)

•Moonrise: 6:12 AM (August 13)

•Moonset: 7:55 PM (August 12)

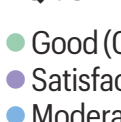
AQI Tracker



Bawana
Moderate
AQI: 143



Shadipur
Satisfactory
AQI: 61



Anand Vihar
Moderate
AQI: 110



Aya Nagar
Satisfactory
AQI: 71



Legend:
● Good (0-50)
● Satisfactory (51-100)
● Moderate (101-200)
● Poor (201-300)
● Very Poor (301-400)
● Severe (401-500)



The Curtain Call

Traffic snarls on NH-9 in New Delhi on Tuesday on the occasion of Sawan Shivratra, the final day of the Kanwar Yatra. PRAVEEN KHANNA

EXPRESS exclusive

Delhi Master Plan set to be tabled today at DDA meeting for approval

Devansh Mittal

New Delhi, August 11

THE MASTER Plan for Delhi (MPD) 2047 will be taken up at the Delhi Development Authority's (DDA) meeting on Wednesday, set to be considered for approval, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

"MPD-2047 will be tabled in the meeting and if approved, will be notified by the Central government in a few days," a source said.

The DDA did not respond to queries sent by *The Indian Express*.

The Indian Express had reported in June that the union government is deliberating on changing the horizon year for

the Delhi Master Plan 2041 to 2047, apart from issues related to the land pooling, green development area and Yamuna O-Zone, an eco-sensitive protected floodplain in the Capital.

The MPD is already facing a five-year delay. The Delhi Master Plan 2041 was approved by the DDA on February 28, 2023, and sent to the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA) for notification on April 13, 2023. Since then, several deadlines have been missed, including the 100-day deadline set by the MoHUA after the Narendra Modi government was elected for the third term in 2024.

Officials said that chairman of the Delhi Master Plan Com-

mittee, Bhopender Bazad, belonging to the rural group Delhi Dehat Vikas Manch (DDVM), met Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday. Following the meeting, he had said that there are strong indications that the Master Plan is expected to be approved very soon.

In June, Housing and Urban Affairs Minister Manohar Lal had said that the Master Plan 2041 would be finalised after one "last meeting" to be chaired by union Home Minister Amit Shah. "We have completed the work and submitted it... Just two-three final suggestions have to be incorporated and one last final meeting will be held..." he had said.

Drafted under the Delhi Development Act, 1957, the first Master Plan for Delhi was announced in 1962, followed by Master Plans of 2001 and 2021. The Delhi Master Plan 2021 had also missed deadlines and it was notified in 2007.

Among others, policy on how the government intends to deal with unauthorised colonies in Yamuna's O-Zone, which houses over five lakh people will be watched, in the wake of Delhi High Court order in May that residential colonies in the eco-sensitive floodplain are "completely impermissible".

In the absence of the full notification, the government had introduced key policy changes to Delhi's urban planning framework in recent months.

'Lack of evidence': 1 more bail in Mann video row

Abhimanyu Hazarika

Gurgaon, August 11

DAYS AFTER a contractual cyber expert — arrested amid a controversy over a video allegedly linked to Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann — was granted relief, a Gurgaon court Monday granted bail to another accused in the case. The court noted there was lack of evidence hinting at organised crime.

Additional Sessions Judge Sudeep Goel granted the regular bail to Arjun alias Arun. He was arrested on June 23 following allegations of being part of an organised crime syndicate that allegedly pressured a digital forensics worker to fabricate a report on the video.

While explaining the application of Section 111 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) that pertains to organised crime, the court noted that there must be legally admissible prima facie evidence to constitute any continuing unlawful activity.

The judge observed that without such evidence "the State cannot make any suspect undergo custodial interrogation to hunt for such evidence against the suspect or others". The order detailed that evi-

dence must first be gathered to establish a prima facie case under BNS Section 111.

The judge ruled that without legally admissible accusations, the state cannot use suspect as "custodial bait by any hook, line, and sinker" to bring the case under the organised crime provision. During the proceedings, the investigating agency conceded that the accused had clean criminal antecedents with no other pending FIRs, and that the forensic report on the seized electronic equipment was still awaited.

Ankit Bhardwaj, a contractual cyber expert with the National Investigation Agency, was earlier granted bail by the same court after the judge noted that organised crime charges could not be invoked without a forensic laboratory report.

Granting relief to Arun on the basis of parity, the court noted that the investigating agency failed to distinguish his case from that of co-accused Ankit. The judge stated in the order, "Moreover the co-accused Ankit has been granted the concession of bail vide order dated 30.07.2026. The present accused is also entitled to bail on the ground of parity."

'SC panel on Aravallis must hear more people'

Express News Service

New Delhi, August 11

CIVIL SOCIETY groups and communities affected by mining in the Aravalli region Tuesday said that consultations by the high-powered committee (HPC) constituted by the Supreme Court have left out several districts and did not adequately hear the voices of the local people. They also alleged that those affected have been receiving threats from those affiliated to mining companies.

The Aravalli Virasat Jan Abhiyan, which works with communities dependent on the Aravalli Hills, and affected communities, demanded that the HPC seek an extension of its August 31 deadline to submit its report. The demand came a day after the panel's 21-day period for inviting comments from stakeholders ended.

It also demanded a systematic approach, similar to the one adopted a decade ago by the Western Ghats Expert Ecology Panel, to hold direct outreach and public hearings.

The group alleged that their voices were not heard during the HPC's field visit in Gurgaon, Alwar, Ajmer and Udaipur between August 6 and 10.

Grassroot Adivasi leaders from Udaipur said a meeting with the HPC scheduled for August 10 was changed to the evening of August 9, making it difficult for several people to attend.

Neelam Ahluwalia, co-founder of Aravalli Virasat Jan Abhiyan, claimed that around 80% of the representations in Ajmer were pro-mining, with a similar pattern in other cities. The lobby in Alwar, Ajmer and Udaipur, she alleged, threatened those speaking about negative impact of mining.

"Our biggest demand from this committee is that it needs to write to the SC and get an extension on the August 31 deadline. Without meaningful consultations with the rural communities in all the 64 districts in Delhi, Haryana, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh and Gujarat, no decision should be taken," she said.

Kailash Chand Yadhav, secretary of Jodhpura Sangharsh Samiti, said they had asked the HPC to visit villages affected by limestone mines and stone crushers. "They did not come to the village despite the visit being there on their agenda."

Sadhna Meena, a Bhil Adivasi leader from Udaipur, said most people at the public hearing were from the mining lobby.

IMD corrects 'entry error', Delhi still 29.6 mm short of normal August rain

Sophiya Mathew

New Delhi, August 11

CITING AN "entry error", the India Meteorological Department (IMD) on Tuesday revised the rainfall recorded for August 6 from 56 mm to 18.7 mm, bringing down cumulative rainfall recorded at Safdarjung weather station — the base station for the Capital — for August to 197.2 mm. Until Monday, the figure was recorded as 230.5 mm on the IMD website, as per which Delhi had already crossed its August average normal rainfall in just the first eight days of the month.

However, the revised figure meant Delhi has received about 87% of its normal August rainfall so far.

As per IMD's long period average (1991-2020), Safdarjung receives 226.8 mm of rainfall in August, leaving the city about 29.6 mm short of the monthly normal this year as of now.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, IMD Director Dr. Mrutyunjay Mohapatra said the discrepancy was likely due to a human error in data logging and that the reason behind the mistake was being checked.

How IMD records data

● Safdarjung is a manual meteorological observatory/station where instruments automatically transmit observations to a receiving centre.

● Precipitation, temperature, humidity, wind and cloud cover, among others, are recorded manually by observers.

● Records are sent to the designated Meteorological Centre or Regional Meteorological Centre, where they are scrutinised and manually entered into standard digital formats.

● The data then undergo offline ingestion into IMD database.

● IMD's data management system has separate routes for recording manual and automatic observations.

● Both feed into the central database, where data processing, quality control and consistency checks are carried out before data products are generated and supplied to users.

● Errors can enter at several points, including during observation, instrument measurement, transmission or data entry.

● 'Suspect readings' are flagged for further validation rather than being discarded.

"The same has been corrected today and 197.2 mm is the correct figure" he said.

IMD senior scientist Krishna Mishra said the meteorological parameters at the Safdarjung are manually measured and logged.

"Once an incorrect value was entered into the system, it was picked up and retained in the cumulative calculation," he added.

● FACILITY WAS REDESIGNED LAST YEAR TO INTRODUCE YOUNG PEOPLE TO SERVICES BEYOND LETTERS AND STAMPS

'I can use UPI, text to check if they are open': Inside IIT-Delhi's 'Gen-Z' post office

Reva Thakkar

New Delhi, August 11

At IIT-Delhi's Hauz Khas Post Office, there are no grim walls or hard chairs.

Instead, there are pink cushioned chairs, a coffee machine, and a painting titled "That's so IIT Delhi".

Last year, it was redesigned as "an attempt to make a traditionally bureaucratic space more welcoming to young people and to introduce them to services beyond letters and stamps.

On a Saturday afternoon, Ravendra Kumar, 31, stood at the counter with his daughter Kavya, 11, to update their Aadhaar cards. "I never feel like

coming here is a hassle," he said.

One of the walls and the ceiling of the post office are panelled in red; the others stand in a complementary white. Behind the red-and-white desk, a doodle mural covers a white wall. The names of the IIT Delhi students who painted it are written in the corner of the wall. A weighing machine for parcels sits next to a display case containing post office merchandise.

Manoranjan Baditya, filled out forms to enrol his daughter Akshita, a toddler, in Sukanya Samridhi Yojana. His wife, Hemangi, and son Rudraj, 4, also accompanied him. "We can bring our children here without any tension", Hemangi said.

The post office offers financial and insurance services



Outside the post office in Hauz Khas; (right) a doodle mural by IIT-Delhi students on a wall. REVA THAKKAR

alongside the usual mail and postal services, as well as Aadhaar facilities. It also has the India Post Payments Bank and a philately counter with a variety of heritage stamps.

There are two employees behind the desk: Pooja Yadav, the postal assistant, and Adarsh Yadav, a multi-tasking staff.

Another visitor, Menka Singh, 28, a PhD student at IIT, recalled her experience at post offices elsewhere in the city: long queues, unpredictable clo-

sures, and long waiting hours. Here, she added, the staff are friendly enough that she "can just text them to check if they are open".

"It does not seem bureaucratic at all. I just go and get my work done. I can pay via UPI; there's no compulsion for cash," she added.

That accessibility is by design, says Postmaster Manender Singh Rawat, 38.

The idea took shape in July last year. Implementation began in September and wrapped by October-November.

Rawat explained the initiative was for a generation that as-

sociated post offices only with letters.

The space was formally inaugurated as India Post's first Gen Z-themed campus post office, part of a nationwide plan to revamp 46 post offices located on educational campuses by December 15, 2025.

The initiative was Communications Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia's vision of turning post offices into youth-centric spaces.

"Union Minister Scindia visited the IIT Delhi post office in January 2026 and his signature is now part of the office's own small history," said Rawat.

The numbers back up the

shift in perception: footfall has climbed to 40-50 customers a day. Students use the post office for parcel services when they graduate and ship their belongings home. PhD scholars use it to send Speed Post applications for academic positions.

"Most lectures end around 5 pm, so we decided to extend the hours," added Rawat.

Akanksha Gayakwad, 21, a first-year MSc student, said: "I never have to wait too long... and they explain if there is any trouble."

Swapna Mishra, 56, an IIT Delhi alumna, said the change has added a personal touch. She has used the office for a savings account, an RD, an MIS, and is now opening an account for her domestic help.

State of border affairs with China will reflect on larger bilateral ties: India

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 11

REJECTING CHINA'S criticism of New Delhi identifying 27 places and features in Arunachal Pradesh by their standard names, India on Tuesday said that the state of border affairs with China will reflect on the state of the "larger bilateral ties" and underlined that maintenance of peace and tranquillity along the Line of Actual Control (LAC) is of "utmost importance".

Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) official spokesperson, Randhir Jaiswal, also asserted that Arunachal Pradesh is an "inalienable and integral" part of India and nothing can change this "indisputable reality."

"In matters relating to the border areas between India and China, we have always emphasised in discussions with the Chinese side that we consider these issues as most serious," Jaiswal said. "The maintenance of peace and tranquillity in these areas is of the utmost importance. We have also stated that the state of the border affairs will reflect on the state of our larger bilateral ties," he said.

Jaiswal said that this was reiterated last week at the meeting of the Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination on India-China border affairs (WMCC). "At this meeting, the two sides engaged in frank discussions and reviewed the situation along the Line of Actual Control (LAC)," he said.

The Indian side again underlined that maintaining peace and tranquillity in the border areas is essential for the overall development of bilateral relations, Jaiswal said.

"It was agreed to continue to use existing diplomatic and military channels, including the WMCC, local commander-level meetings and other agreed mechanisms, to resolve outstanding issues and avoid misunderstanding and miscalculation along the LAC," he said.

With China repeatedly renaming some places in Arunachal Pradesh, India last week formally identified 27 places and features in the state by their standard names on the official Indian map. "Identifying them formally on the Survey of India map of Arunachal Pradesh is aimed at facilitating their accurate recognition and better awareness among the public at large," an official statement had said.

China's act of renaming places in Arunachal Pradesh has always been categorically rejected by India which has consistently termed such moves "vain and preposterous" while asserting that these will not alter the "undeniable" reality that the state "was, is, and will" always remain an integral part of India.

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'US, India share several goals': Gor, Doval talk strategic cooperation

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 11

US-INDIA partnership is vital to addressing global security challenges, US Ambassador Sergio Gor said Tuesday, following fruitful talks with NSA Ajit Doval. Gor said both sides share several same goals and that the engagement continues to grow.

The US envoy's meeting with Doval came a day after his talks with Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri. "Had a fruitful meeting with National Security Advisor Ajit Doval to discuss deepening US-India strategic cooperation," Gor said on social media.

"Our close partnership with India is vital to addressing global security challenges. The US and India share many of the same goals and our engagement continues to grow," he said.

Gor's meeting with Misri and Doval came days after US Vice-President J D Vance dialled PM Narendra Modi to discuss expanding the India-US comprehensive global strategic ties amid West Asia conflict.

Modi and Trump, during their meeting in France in June, instructed officials to work towards a balanced, mutually beneficial and commercially meaningful trade agreement.



Our beloved
Dr. Kusum Kumar
Writer & Artist
Passed Away on
Friday, August 7th 2026,
at the age of 87.
Please join us to honour her life.

Prayer Meeting
Laburnum Courtyard,
South Gate, The Laburnum Condominium,
Sushant Lok - 1, Sector 28, Gurugram
In Grief: Atul & Minna, Archana & Gordon,
Ritvik, Rohan & Namit

VASANTDADA PATIL PRATISHTHAN'S LAW COLLEGE
Vasantdada Patil Educational Complex, Eastern Express Highway,
Padmabhushan Vasantdada Patil Marg, Sion Mumbai 400022.

UNAIDED
Applications are invited for the following
Teaching Posts from the Academic year 2026-27

Sr. No.	Cadre	Subject	Total No. of Posts	Posts Reserved for
1.	Principal	--	01	01- Open
2.	Assistant Professor	Law	08	01 - SC, 01-ST, 01 - DT (A), 01 - OBC, 01 - SEBC, 01 - EWS, 02 - Open. Horizontal Reservation - Women - 01 Post (Open - 01)
3.	Librarian	--	01	01 - Open

The posts for the reserved category candidates will be filled in by the same category candidates (Domicile of State of Maharashtra) belonging to that particular category only. Reservation for women will be as per University Circular No. BCC/16/74/1998 dated 10th March, 1998. 4% reservation shall be for the persons with disability as per University Circular No. Special Cell/ICC/2019-20/05 dated 05th July, 2019. Candidates having knowledge of Marathi will be preferred.

"Qualification, Pay Scales and other requirement are as prescribed by the UGC Notification dated 18th July, 2018 Government of Maharashtra Resettlement No. Misc - 2018 / C.R.56 / 18 / UN-1, dated 8th March, 2019 and University circular No. TAAS / (CT) / ICD / 2018-19 / 1241, dated 26th March, 2019 and revised from time to time" The Government Resolution & Circular are available on the website mu.ac.in

Applicants who are already employed must send their application through proper channel. Applicants are required to account for breaks, if any in their academic career. Application with full details should reach the **GENERAL SECRETARY, Vasantdada Patil Pratishthan's LAW COLLEGE, Vasantdada Patil Educational Complex, Eastern Express Highway, Padmabhushan Vasantdada Patil Marg, Sion, Mumbai - 400022, within 15 days from the date of publication of this advertisement.** Sd/-
This is University approved advertisement. **GENERAL SECRETARY**

Sena-UBT in SC: Legislature party split doesn't amount to split in political party

New Delhi: A split in a legislature party can never, by itself, amount to a split in the political party and the EC's decision to recognise the Eknath Shinde-led unit as "real Shiv Sena" and grant it the bow-and-arrow symbol was unlawful, the Uddhav Thackeray faction told the Supreme Court on Tuesday.

by Senior Advocate Kapil Sibal, appearing for Sena (UBT), before a bench comprising CJI Surya Kant and Justices Joy-malya Bagchi and V Mohana. On the EC's decision, Sibal said, "The assumption that the split in legislative party means the split in the political party is unlawful and liable to be set aside."

PTI



स्वतंत्रता दिवस - 2026

INDEPENDENCE DAY - 2026



ENTRANCE

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ENTRANCE

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खाने-पीने की चीजें, केचप, सॉस
Eatables, Ketchup, Sauce



थैला, ब्रीफकेस, रिमोट नियंत्रित कार लॉक चाबियाँ
Bag, Briefcase, Remote Controlled Car Lock Keys



रेडियो, ट्रांजिस्टर, टेपरेकार्डर, पेजर
Radio, Transistor, Tape Recorder, Pager



कैमरा, दूरबीन, हैंडycैम
Camera, binoculars, Handycam



थर्मस, पानी की बोतल, कैन, छाता
Thermo Flask, Water Bottle, Cans, Umbrella



पटाखे, बारूद, फ्लेयर्स, किसी भी प्रकार के विस्फोटक
Firecrackers, Gunpowder, Flares, Any Type of Explosives



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Cigarettes, Bidi, Lighter



ज्वलनशील पदार्थ, माचिस, शराब, एरोसोल, जेल / पेस्ट, इत्र, स्प्रे इत्यादि
Fuel, Matchbox, Alcohol, Aerosol, Gel/Paste, Perfumes, Spray etc.



हथौड़े, ड्रिल, आरी, तलवार, कटार, पेंचकस
Hammers, Drills, Saws, Sword, Dagger, Screw Driver



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रेजर, ब्लेड, चाकू, कैंची, तार, नुकीला हथियार
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INDEPENDENCE DAY CELEBRATIONS

TRAFFIC ADVISORY

on 13th August, 2026

FULL DRESS REHEARSAL

Independence Day Ceremony will be celebrated on 15th August-2026 at Red Fort. Hon'ble Prime Minister of India will address the nation from the rampart of Red Fort. A full-dress rehearsal for the arrangement will be conducted on 13th August 2026. As such for the convenience of public and security reasons, certain traffic restrictions have been imposed around the Red Fort on 13th August 2026.

TRAFFIC ADVISORY

FULL DRESS REHEARSAL
INDEPENDENCE DAY CELEBRATIONS
13 - 08 - 2026
(0400 Hrs. To 1000 Hrs.)



TRAFFIC RESTRICTIONS AROUND RED FORT
The following roads will be closed for general traffic from 4.00 AM to 10.00 AM on 13.08.2026 and only labelled vehicles will be permitted:-

- Netaji Subhash Marg from Delhi Gate to Chhatta Rail Chowk;
- Lothian Road from GPO Delhi to Chhatta Rail Chowk;
- S.P. Mukherjee Marg from H.C. Sen Marg to Yamuna Bazar Chowk;
- Chandni Chowk Road from Fountain Chowk to Red Fort;
- Nishad Raj Marg from Ring Road to Netaji Subhash Marg;
- Esplanade Road and its Link Road to Netaji Subhash Marg;
- Ring Road from Raighat to ISBT.

ROADS THAT MAY BE AVOIDED FROM 04.00 AM TO 10.00 AM ON 13.08.2026:
Those vehicles which do not have parking labels for the rehearsal may avoid C. Hexagon India Gate, Copernicus Marg, Mandi House, Sikandra Road, W-Point, A-point Tilak Marg, Mathura Road, BSZ Marg, Netaji Subhash Marg, J.L. Nehru Marg, Ring Road between Nizamuddin Khatta and ISBT Kashmiri Gate & Outer Ring Road from Nizamuddin Khatta & ISBT Kashmiri Gate via Salimgarh bypass.

North-South Access:
Alternative- 1: Auroribond Road – Seldarjung Road – Kamal Ataturk Marg- Kautilya Marg- S Marg- 11 Murti- Mother Teresa Crescent- Park Street- Mandir Marg – Panchkulan Road – Rani Jhansi Road and reach their destinations in North Delhi and vice-versa.
Alternative- 2: Reach Connaught Place – Mirto Road – Bhairbhuti Marg – Ajmeri Gate – Shradhanand Marg – Lahori Gate Chowk – Naya Bazar – Peeli Kothi – S.P. Mukherjee Marg up to ODRS and reach their destination in North Delhi and vice versa.
Alternative- 3: Reach Nizamuddin Bridge to cross Yamuna – Pushtha Road – G.T. Road and cross Yudhister Setu to ISBT and reach their destination in North Delhi and vice versa.

East West Access:
1. NH-24 (NH-9) Nizamuddin Khatta- Barapulla Road- under AIIMS Flyover- Ring Road.
2. DND- Barapulla Road further as per 1. above or via Ashram on Ring Road & proceed accordingly.
3. NH-24 (NH-9) Nizamuddin Khatta- Ring Road- Bhaigran Road- Mathura Road- Subrahmanyam

TRAFFIC RESTRICTIONS AROUND RED FORT

B. Netaji Subhash Marg from Chhatta Rail Chowk to Delhi Gate.
C. Shyama Prasad Mukherjee Marg.
D. Ring Road between Nizamuddin Khatta (NH-24) and Northern loop of ISBT Kashmiri Gate.
E. C Hexagon, Sher Shah Road, Dr. Jai Prakash Road, Pandara Road, Shahjahan Road, Akbar Road, Rajghat, Ashoka Road, KG Marg, Copernicus Marg, Tilak Marg, Purana Qulla Road, Sikandra Road, Bhagwan Dass Road and BSZ Marg.
F. Ashoka Road from R/A Windsor Place to "C" Hexagon.
G. KG Marg from Ferozeshah Road to "C" Hexagon.
H. Vikas Marg beyond loop towards Delhi Secretariat.
I. Mathura Road from Ashram Chowk to W-Point.
Buses ordinarily terminating at Red Fort, Jama Masjid and Delhi Main Railway Station will be curtailed/ diverted as below:-

1. Opposite Ramlika Ground on J.L.N. Marg for buses approaching from South Delhi and West Delhi.
2. At Mori Gate and Tis Hazari - for buses coming from North, North West via Baraf Khana and East Delhi via ISBT Bridge.
3. At Boulevard Road opp. Maharaja Agrasen Park, for buses coming from North Delhi side from Ring Road.
Normal bus services will be restored after 11:00 AM on 13.08.2026.
How to Approach / Reach Important places:-

1) Old Delhi Railway Station:-

- From West and South Delhi:-** Mother Teresa Crescent - Park Street - Mandir Marg - Panchkulan Road- Rani Jhansi Flyover- Azad Market - Boulevard Road - Mori Gate - Pul Dufferin - S.P. Mukherjee Marg to reach the Railway Station or Dhaula Kuan- Ridge Road (Vande Matram Marg) - Faiz Road- Rani Jhansi Road & thereafter as above & vice versa.
- From North:-** Mori Gate - Pul Dufferin - S.P. Mukherjee Marg to reach the Railway Station.
- From East/North East:-** Pusta Road- Yudhister Setu - Mori Gate - Pul Dufferin- SP Mukherjee Marg then proceed further accordingly.

2) New Delhi Railway Station:

- From East:-** Vikas Marg, DDU Marg, Bhairbhuti Marg, New Delhi Railway Station.

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Happy Meal

A CHAOS of a different kind was witnessed in the Parliament canteen on Tuesday when Amritsari kulcheh-hole and fruit cream, specially ordered by BJP Rajya Sabha Member Tarun Chugh, arrived during lunchtime. MPs, who were trading barbs on the floor of the House minutes ago, were seen digging into the Amritsar-special meal arranged by the first-time BJP MP who has his roots in the Punjab city. Party lines blurred as Chugh personally served his fellow parliamentarians. He not only ran out of the 200-plus servings he got delivered via train, but also had to arrange extra disposable plates to meet the increasing demand.

No Pressure

AMID DISRUPTIONS in the Rajya Sabha on Tuesday, Leader of Opposition Mallikarjun Kharge remarked from his seat that House Chairman C P Radhakrishnan was “under pressure” from the Treasury Benches. Kharge was trying to raise the Ram Mandir donation row, which was disallowed by the Chairman. Radhakrishnan said he had also stopped the Treasury benches from raising the Jharkhand students’ protest issue. With a wry smile, Radhakrishnan remarked that they (Treasury benches) never pressure him. “It’s always you (Kharge) who does it. I am never under pressure from anyone except Kharge-ji,” he said.

Balancing Act

AS IT continues its stakeholder consultations, the Joint Committee of Parliament on One Nation One Election Bills is set to have a series of interactions on August 24. The panel, chaired by BJP MP P P Chaudhary, is scheduled to meet former Union Minister P Chidambaram, Padma Awarded from Delhi and representatives of think tanks Nation First Policy Research Centre and Vidhi Centre for Legal Policy. The Nation First Policy Research Centre is linked to senior BJP leaders, with BJP national general secretary and Rajya Sabha MP Tarun Chugh serving as its chairperson.

Brittas moves privilege notice against BJP MP over her remarks

New Delhi: CPI (M) MP John Brittas Tuesday submitted a notice of breach of privilege to Rajya Sabha Chairman C P Radhakrishnan against BJP MP Sushmita Dev over a remark she made about him during House proceedings on Monday, sources said.

Brittas is learnt to have objected to the use of the word as a way to denigrate people from South India. He, along with a group of legislators from Kerala, met the chairman to lodge their protest.

Brittas alleged that on Monday, when he was moving a statutory resolution against the Income Tax (Amendment) Ordinance, 2026, the BJP MP repeatedly used a word to describe him. The MP flagged the context of the use of words directed at people from South India in Mumbai during 1960s and 70s, and said such words reduce their identity to stereotypes.

When contacted, Dev said that she will move a notice of breach of privilege against Brittas as, according to her, the Kerala member, too, had made a remark against her. ENS

Parliament passes Tribunals Reforms Bill amid Opp walkout

Law Minister: Bill meant to ensure transparent, timely and fair resolution

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 11

THE RAJYA Sabha passed the Tribunals Reforms Bill, 2026 by voice vote on Tuesday amidst sloganeering and a walkout by the Opposition.

At the start of the debate in the post-lunch session, Deputy Chairman Harivansh gave the floor to the Leader of the Opposition Mallikarjun Kharge, but said he could only speak on the Bill. Kharge was cut off when he tried to raise the Ram Mandir donation theft row. As the Chairman called the next Speaker, the Opposition MPs staged a walkout from the House.

Earlier, the Rajya Sabha witnessed two adjournments as the Opposition and the Treasury benches disrupted the proceedings. Vice-President and Rajya Sabha Chairman C P Radhakrishnan adjourned the House soon after Kharge began speaking on the Ram Temple donation row. When the House reconvened, Radhakrishnan proceeded with the Question Hour. Noting that Kharge wanted to raise an issue related to a state, the Chairman said “it will not be encouraged”. He said even the Treasury side wanted to raise a state-related issue on Jharkhand students’ protest, but he disallowed it. As the MPs disrupted the Question Hour, the House was adjourned till 2 pm.

When the House met after the second adjournment, Law and Justice Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal moved the Tribunal Reforms Bill. Replying to the debate, Meghwal said all the members who spoke agreed that



Law and Justice Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal; (right) Leader of Opposition Mallikarjun Kharge in Rajya Sabha on Tuesday. PTI, ANI

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It was a very important change. He said that the key point of the Bill was the setting up of the National Tribunal Commission. “The proposed National Tribunal Commission will be chaired by a former judge of the Supreme Court or a former chief justice of HCs. There will be two judicial and two technical members. Some members mentioned that the government will appoint the members. It will be done by NTC itself. There will be a search-cum-selection system.”

He said the Bill will also not change the jurisdiction of any tribunal. It’s meant to ensure a transparent system that could offer a timely and fair resolution. He said it is not merely meant for quick dispute resolution but also to ensure that the capital investment does not remain locked and comes back to the economy. Meghwal said no other government had thought to bring in such structural reforms — the tribunals were working alright, but the PM thought of improving the system. He said over the years the number of tribunals had been rationalised from 26 to 19 to now 16.

The minister specifically addressed the concerns raised by AAP MP Sanjay Singh, who said the process would lead to skew-

ed representation in tribunals as there were very few judges from the SC and ST communities. Meghwal said while the appointment of judges is done through the Collegium system, the government has written to judiciary, and that has, in fact, led to improved representation among new judges.

Singh said there has been only one ad-hoc judge so far to represent a 10-crore population. “There needs to be reservation in the tribunals, otherwise we cannot support the Bill,” he said.

This led to a “clarification” from Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju, who said any wrong message should not go that the government does not want to appoint people from the minority communities. He said while it is true that there has been only one tribal judge who retired many years ago, the selection has been done by the Collegium system for years. He asked why before 1992, the then Congress government did not appoint judges from these communities.

Rijiju said that under the current government, he became the first tribal law minister and the first Buddhist one since Baba Saheb Bhimrao Ambedkar.

Singh also alleged the gov-

• Inquiry panel report on Justice Varma to be tabled in LS today

Report of an inquiry committee which probed into allegations against Justice Yashwant Varma — against whom removal proceedings were initiated over the alleged discovery of unaccounted for cash from his official residence — will be placed before the Lok Sabha on Wednesday. According to the list of business of LS for Wednesday, the secretary general will “lay” the two volumes of the report along with oral evidence in the House. The panel had submitted its findings to the Speaker in May. PTI

ernment did not want to bring the NCLT under the jurisdiction of the NCT because it wanted to continue to control the body. BJD MP Sasmit Patra said NCLT should be brought under the same framework. DMK’s Tiruchi Siva raised the Cauvery water sharing matter.

He said Karnataka has not yet implemented tribunal direction to share water with Tamil Nadu. He batted for a mechanism to ensure that tribunal orders are followed.

Bill to alter Kerala name passed by voice vote in LS

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 11

THE LOK Sabha passed two Bills — the National Cooperative Development Corporation (Amendment) Bill 2026 and the Kerala (Alteration of Name) Bill 2026 — by voice vote amid Opposition protests on Tuesday. The House was adjourned for the day soon after the passage of the two Bills.

With one day remaining for the Monsoon Session — it ends on Thursday — there was no clarity on whether Union Home Minister Amit Shah will speak in the House, though BJP sources said he is ready with his statement, if need be, after the government said on Monday that he would speak if the Opposition did not disrupt his speech.

As Opposition continued its protest seeking the presence of Shah in the House, Union Minister of Parliamentary Affairs Kiren Rijiju took a dig at Congress leader K C Venugopal, who comes from Kerala, after the passage of the Bill to rename Kerala to Keralam. “The Kerala Bill was passed, but K C Venugopal could not speak on it. I am sad to say this,” said the minister.

Union MoS for Cooperation Murlidhar Mohol spoke briefly amid slogans before the Bill dealing with National Cooperative Development Corporation was passed. He said under the original Act of 1962, some organisations are not yet registered. “NCDC can now give direct loans and grants against security to any organisation working under cooperative sector,” he said.

Sitharaman, Nitin Gadkari, Shivraj Singh Chouhan, and S Jaishankar, among others.

Ministers belonging to NDA constituent parties, namely H D Kumaraswamy (JDS), Kinjarapu Ram Mohan Naidu (TDP), and Ramdas Bandu Athavale (RSP-A), and leaders Praful Patel (NCP), Upendra Kushwaha (RLM), and Satabdi Roy (NCPI), and were also in attendance.

The NDA parliamentary party meeting also saw a presentation by Union Minister of Jal Shakti C R Paatil on different aspects of the ministry that is responsible for laying down policy guidelines and programmes for the development, conservation and management of water as a national resource.

Sources present at the meeting said Finance Minister Sitharaman was praised by the PM for her speech in Rajya Sabha a day earlier in which she slammed the Opposition MPs in relation to the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026, and the Bankers’ Books Evidence Bill, 2026.



PM Narendra Modi, BJP chief Nitin Nabin and other leaders at the NDA Parliamentary Party meeting on Tuesday. ANI

at the Parliament House complex, ministers and MPs who had gathered there to part in the weekly meeting greeted him by waving the national flag and raising Vande Mataram and Bharat Mata Ki Jai slogans.

PM Modi reciprocated by holding a national flag and waving towards the members present who included BJP president Nitin Nabin, Union ministers Amit Shah, Nirmala

Govt clears introduction of one billion polymer banknotes of Rs 10 & 20

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, August 11

THE GOVERNMENT has approved the introduction of one billion polymer banknotes of Rs 10 and Rs 20 for field trials, Parliament was informed Tuesday.

The RBI, with recommendation of its central board, had sent a proposal to the government in terms of Section 25 of the RBI Act, 1934, for introduction of one billion pieces each of Rs 10 and Rs 20 polymer banknotes for field trials and for regular issuance of polymer banknotes in these two denominations after successful completion of field trials, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said in a written reply in the Rajya Sabha.

“The proposal has been approved by the government. As per the RBI, these polymer banknotes are proposed to be issued along with paper substrate-based banknotes,” she said.

RBI has informed that the procurement process is presently at an initial stage, she said.

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Therefore, at this point of time, it would not be possible to determine the exact timeframe for introduction of polymer banknotes or the expenditure likely to be incurred thereon. Replying to another question, Sitharaman said average retail inflation has declined steadily from 5.4% in 2023-24 to 4.6% in 2024-25 and further to 2.1% in 2025-26.

Owing to commodity price shock and elevated global energy prices stemming from the West Asia crisis, a seasonal pickup in vegetable prices, and the expected unfavourable El Niño conditions, retail inflation rose to 3.9% in Q1 of 2026-27, she said.

However, she said, it is still below RBI’s inflation target of 4%. “The 56th meeting of GST Council has brought in a two-rate structure with a standard rate of 18%, a merit rate of 5% and a special de-merit rate of 40% for a select few goods & services (but inclusive of earlier compensation cess rate and hence with no increase in overall tax burden).”

Celebrate I-Day with honour, pride, take pledge for developed India: PM

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 11

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi on Tuesday exhorted citizens to celebrate the nation’s 80th Independence Day with honour, pride and glory while pledging to work towards a developed India.

Sharing visuals from the NDA’s weekly ‘Mangal Milan’ meeting in Parliament where each MP waved tricolours amid chants of Bharat Mata Ki Jai and Vande Mataram, PM Modi also urged citizens to participate in the ‘Har Ghar Tiranga’ campaign in an Instagram reel.

“Let us pay tribute to our freedom fighters. Let us take a pledge for a developed India. Har Ghar Tiranga, Ghar Ghar Tiranga, Har Mann Tiranga. Come, let us hoist the tricolour at every home. Bharat Mata Ki Jai, Vande Mataram, Vande Mataram, Vande Mataram,” he said.

Earlier, as soon as he entered the venue of the NDA parliamentary party meeting at the GMC Balayogi Auditorium

Commercial misuse of court remarks: SC seeks Govt reply on plea for CBI probe

Issues notice on plea for probe into fake advocates, activities ‘associated with CJP’

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 11

The Supreme Court Tuesday issued notice on a plea seeking CBI probe into how courtroom interactions including the recent “metaphorical expressions” about cockroaches are increasingly “meme-ified, mimicked, commercially circulated, and transformed into viral digital content detached from constitutional and procedural context”, undermining constitutional promise of justice.

A bench, led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and comprising Justice Joymalya Bagchi and Justice V Mohana, sought response from the Centre, the CBI and the Bar Council of India on the plea which also sought probe into “activities associated with Cockroach Janta Party” in this regard while recognising that “fair criticism, democratic dissent, satire, and constitutionally protected free speech remain permissible within the framework of constitutional morality and institutional dignity”.

The plea by advocate Raja Choudhary also urged the court to direct probe into allegations concerning fake advocates, fraudulent law degrees, impersonation within legal practice, and deterioration of professional standards in the legal profession.

The petitioner referred to the top court’s proceedings on May 15 during which the CJI had made the “cockroaches” remark. Later, the CJI had told The Indian Express, “It was about the lawyers who have entered the profession through backdoor based on mostly fake degrees. Issue was about fake law degrees and how to clean up. It was in that context that I commented.”

At that hearing, the plea said, “Concerns were expressed regarding procedural misuse of courts, conferment of Senior Advocate designation, deterioration of professional standards and repeated procedural insistence within judicial process. During the course of spontaneous courtroom interaction, certain metaphorical (cockroach) expressions were used in the context of institutional frus-

tration and procedural anxiety. However, isolated fragments of oral proceedings were thereafter selectively clipped, meme-ified, mimicked, commercially circulated, and transformed into viral digital content detached from constitutional and procedural context.”

Choudhary contended that “metaphorical references involving animals, insects, vermin, creatures, or symbolic imagery have historically existed within literature, jurisprudence, constitutional discourse, political theory and legal philosophy as recognised tools for expressing institutional anxiety, bureaucratic alienation, procedural disorder, collapse of communication between individuals and authority systems, and symbolic commentary upon social behaviour.”

Invoking Franz Kafka’s ‘The Metamorphosis’, the petitioner argued that the author “used vermin imagery not literally, but symbolically to describe alienation, bureaucratic violence, and institutional absurdity. Contemporary scholarship further recognises that animal metaphors are universal cognitive devices embedded within human communication and institutional discourse.”

The plea said that “similarly, Indian constitutional discourse and judicial traditions have historically used symbolic metaphors such as ‘Jungle Raj’, ‘watchdog’, ‘marketplace of ideas’, ‘fraud on the Constitution’, and ‘guinea pig’ while describing governance failures, constitutional anxieties, institutional accountability, and procedural realities. Such expressions have never been interpreted through fragmented literalism but through constitutional context and jurisprudential understanding.”

The petitioner argued that what happened subsequently, “including activities associated with the ‘Cockroach Janta Party’ alleged trademark-commercial assertions, branding campaigns, and monetised digital circulation, prima facie demonstrate organised commercial appropriation of judicial controversy and oral courtroom interaction.”

Cong spent Rs 136 cr in Assam, TN, Kerala, Bengal & Puducherry polls

Damini Nath
New Delhi, August 11

THE CONGRESS’S total expenditure on Assembly elections in Assam, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Puducherry and West Bengal stood at Rs 136.94 crore, according to expenditure report submitted to the Election Commission. BJP’s expenditure report was yet to be published by EC.

The break-up of expenses stands as: Rs 40.51 crore on “general party propaganda”, which includes Rs 21.78 crore for travel expenses of star campaigners and Rs 11.95 crore on media ads;

Rs 1.23 crore on public meetings, processions, rallies etc; and Rs 96.42 crore on candidates, of which Rs 95.29 crore was given in lump sum payments to candidates, while Rs 1.13 crore was spent on virtual campaigns.

In addition to amount spent by Central party office, Congress gave Rs 83.2 crore to state units. It ended the poll cycle with a balance of Rs 85.48 crore. State Congress units spent Rs 102.48 crore, of which Assam unit spent Rs 22.62 crore, Kerala Rs 59.28 crore, TN Rs 6.27 crore, West Bengal Rs 7.56 crore and Puducherry Rs 6.74 crore, the report showed.

• SATWANT SINGH, THE SON OF KEY CONSPIRATOR KEHAR SINGH, IS THE FIRST CANDIDATE OF AKALI DAL (WARIS PUNJAB DE) FOR NEXT YEAR’S PUNJAB ELECTIONS

Why Amritpal Singh’s party has fielded Indira Gandhi assassin’s son

Kamaldeep Singh Brar
Amritsar, August 11

THE PUNJAB Assembly elections may be months away, but Amritpal Singh’s Akali Dal (Waris Punjab De) has made plain its intention to make a play for Panthic votes by fielding Satwant Singh as its first candidate. Satwant is the son of Kehar Singh who was executed for his role in the 1984 assassination of Prime Minister Indira Gandhi.

With this, family members of the three men involved in Indira Gandhi’s assassination have found a prominent place in the pro-Khalistani outfit. Faridkot MP Sarabjit Singh Khalsa is a founding member of the party, and the son of Beant Singh, one of the assassins. The outfit’s parliamentary board member

Sukhwinder Singh Aghwan is the nephew of Satwant Singh, the second assassin who was hanged alongside Kehar Singh.

Announcing Satwant Singh’s candidacy from Bassi Pathana in Fatehgarh Sahib district Monday, the party’s working president and Amritpal’s father Tarsem Singh said, “The politics of the ADWPD is not limited merely to gaining power, but is committed to advancing panthic principles, Punjab’s rights, and the honour and respect of families who have made sacrifices for Sikhs.” Tarsem Singh said the candidacy of Satwant Singh was a direct rebuttal of recent claims that the party was ignoring such families.

Satwant Singh, a former bank manager, told *The Indian Express*, “For a long time, Sarab-



Satwant Singh will contest from Bassi Pathana

jit Singh, Sukhwinder Aghwan, and I have been meeting at functions where we are honoured

due to the shared background of our families. I had joined the campaign for Sarabjit Singh Khalsa in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections. Now, both Khalsa and Aghwan have recommended my name for the party ticket.”

Kalsa said last week’s appointment of Aghwan to the parliamentary board was important. The board will select suitable candidates across all 117 Assembly constituencies.

Aghwan said Kehar Singh’s family had been “completely forgotten” until now. “Those who call themselves Panthic have never before shown such families this kind of respect, even though these families made huge sacrifices,” he said.

The Waris Punjab De faced criticism for allegedly ignoring the families with what many

have labelled a “sacrifice background”. The criticism has come most notably from Mandeep Singh, the brother of Sandeep Singh who is facing trial in the murder of Shiv Sena leader Sudhir Suri, and former police officer Suba Singh, who has been convicted in a fake encounter case during the militancy years.

Last year, Mandeep Singh contested the Tarn Taran by-polls as an independent, backed by the Waris Punjab De and the Shiromani Akali Dal (Amritsar). He finished third.

Akal Takht Jathedar Giani Harpreet Singh, who heads the breakaway Akali group SAD (Punjab Surjit), urged all Akali factions to unite and reserve seats for families of “political prisoners and martyrs”. Calling for Panthic unity — in this case,

the parties that represent the collective interests of the Sikh community — he said at a seminar, “Giving due respect and a share to martyrs’ families and Sikh political prisoners is the greatest need of the hour. A total of 30% of seats should go to ‘Bandi Singhs’ (political prisoners) and martyrs’ families.”

While Waris Punjab De has garnered a sizable following due to popularity of Amritpal Singh — the Khadoor Sahib MP has been in jail since 2023 — and following Sarabjit Singh’s win, it lacks viable leaders and an organised cadre. It is trying to fill this gap and make a play for panthic votes by tying itself closely to the families of Indira’s assassins and inducting known faces.

This comes at a time when Panthic politics in Punjab is in

flux. The political footprint of the Akali Dal has rapidly shrunk and it is facing a strong challenge from SAD (Punjab Surjit).

In June, the party managed to pull off a coup when sitting Dakhla MLA Manpreet Singh Ayali joined it. Ayali won on a SAD ticket in 2022 before briefly joining the SAD (Punjab Surjit) last year. A political figure like him brings vital experience of ground-level election machinery that Waris Punjab De lacks at the moment. On July 29, the party made an impact by holding a protest in Chandigarh, demanding the release of ‘Bandi Singhs’. The party claimed credit after CM Bhagwant Mann wrote to Governor Gulab Chand Kataria recommending a 10-day parole for Jagtar Singh Hawara, convicted in Beant assassination.

SC asks for data on SIR appeal disposal, refuses to fix timeline

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 11

THE SUPREME Court said Tuesday that it cannot fix a timeline for the tribunals formed to hear appeals against the exclusion of names from the voters' list following the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) in West Bengal but said it would look into the quantum of disposal and sort logistical issues.

A three-judge bench presided over by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant asked the Election Commission of India (ECI) to submit data, "Let the ECI furnish details on the quantum of disposals of appeals by the appellate tribunals," the bench also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana said.

The court was hearing a plea filed by Congress leader Adhir Ranjan Chowdhury seeking expeditious disposal of SIR-related appeals by the tribunals. Senior advocate Rauf Rahim, appearing for him, submitted that the tribunals had not decided even 1 per cent of the appeals.

Justice Bagchi recalled that the tribunals were set up following Supreme Court orders and told ECI counsel senior advocate D S Naidu, "They have a role to play in the due process. ..If the performance appears to be wanting with regard to the volume and time taken, then to

request you to revisit and re-structure the architecture of disposal. If there can be online access of the judge concerned, like you have in arbitration..."

The judge said that given that substantial time has lapsed, the immediate concern is the quantum of case disposal by the tribunals. "We are not concerned with the result itself, but the quantum..." he added.

Naidu then said, "If there is a logistical delay, we will address that. Will get the details". Justice Bagchi responded, "You may not address us. But we, as creators of the tribunals, also need to see how we can ensure an outcome of the due process. Just to file an appeal may not satisfy a litigant".

When Chowdhury's counsel urged the court to fix a timeline for the tribunals' decisions, Justice Bagchi said, "timeline we cannot fix." The counsel pointed out that the state was denying ration and other benefits to those deleted from the rolls and whose appeals were pending, but the court said the matter has a different cause of action and advised Chowdhury to raise it before the Calcutta High Court.

The SC agreed to look at logistical issues after another counsel pointed out that people from distant areas found it difficult to access the tribunals.

The court will hear the matter next on August 25.

SC seeks govt response to Netaji's daughter plea for return of his 'ashes'

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 11

THE SUPREME Court on Tuesday sought the Centre's response to a plea by Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose's daughter Anita Bose Pfaff seeking the return of his ashes, believed to have been preserved at the Renko-ji temple in Tokyo, to India.

Bose was presumed dead in an air crash in 1945 in Taihoku, the former Japanese colonial name for Taipei, the capital of modern-day Taiwan.

A three-judge bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana issued notice on the plea after Senior Advocate A M Singhvi, appearing for the petitioner, pointed out that the daughter herself had approached the court.

"Let (the) Union reply. Issue notice," the court said.

The plea filed through Advocate Ritika Vohra said the "Union of India's prolonged failure to take a final, reasoned and time-bound decision to repatriate (or at least facilitate repatriation) to India the mortal remains/ashes attributed to Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose, preserved at Renko-Ji Temple, Tokyo, Japan" is a "continuing constitutional wrong".

It said bringing the remains back would enable Pfaff to "perform (Netaji's) final rites in India with dignity and finality".

The plea submitted that "Netaji's remains were supposed to be kept at Renko-Ji Temple for a few months" but have remained there for over 80 years — preserved by successive head priests — forming a continuing state of affairs of "posthumous exile and non-closure for Netaji's now late wife - Ms. Emilie Schenkl - and daughter Professor Anita B. Pfaff..."

"Notably Indian visitors and delegations, inter alia, Late Shri Rajendra Prasad, former President of India; Late Shri Jawahar Lai Nehru, former Prime Minister of India; Late Smt. Indira Gandhi, former Prime Minister of India; Late Shri Atal Bihari Vajpayee, former Prime Minister of India; and Late Shri Pranab Mukherjee, former President of India have paid respects at the Renko-Ji Temple... This is relevant to demonstrate long-standing State knowledge and engagement and the continuing nature of issue," the plea stated.

Suvendu: After UCC, planning laws against conversion, land sale

Ravik Bhattacharya
Kolkata, August 11

AFTER APPROVING the introduction of the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) in the state, West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Tuesday signalled that his government's next big political-legal moves would be the introduction of an anti-religious conversion law and a law restricting land transactions.

Asked about the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, that has seen several minority groups, especially Christian outfits, raise questions, Adhikari told reporters in Bankura, "The answer for this can be given by Hamim (suspected Jaish-e-Mohammed operative Hamim Mondal), who was arrested from Purba Bardhaman. So many illegal establishments have been set up in the name of religious institutions... fundamentalists and radical groups are bringing foreign funds into the country."

"Where we are sitting, in Bankura district, in Jangalmahal (Purulia, Bankura and Jhargram areas), there is a trend of religious conversion with the help of foreign funds and taking advantage of the poor economic conditions of people. We



West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari at a press conference in Bankura on Tuesday. EXPRESS

have experienced this. We have to stop this."

"We have given land on the border (to the BSF). We have cancelled an illegal OBC list. We have cancelled stipends for imams and muezzeens. No weapons came out this Muharram. We have protected respect for cows. After a few days, UCC

will come. One nation, one law. One law for all... I have two jobs left. One, to bring a law against religious conversions and a law on the buying and selling of land. This work I will do," said the CM.

He, however, did not clarify the law on the strictures on land transactions.

200 ABVP activists detained during march in Jharkhand

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, August 11

MORE THAN 200 ABVP activists, including three senior office-bearers, were detained on Tuesday while marching from Ranchi's Old Assembly area towards the new Assembly building in protest against the lathi-charge on students, who were protesting alleged irregularities in government job examinations on Monday.

Those detained included Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) national general secretary Dr Virendra Singh Solanki, national secretary Abhay Pratap Singh and Jharkhand state secretary Prakash Tuti.

According to ABVP social media coordinator Satyam Mishra, the activists were detained around 2-2.30 pm near the Old Assembly after police stopped their march and took

them in different vehicles. They were released after 9pm.

Mishra said there was some use of force by the police to stop the protesters, but clarified that there was no full-fledged lathi-charge. "There was some light use of force," he said.

The ABVP had organised the event in protest against the previous day's lathi-charge on students during their march.

The ABVP march came on a day when the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) had called a Jharkhand bandh over the incident.

The BJP has launched a social media campaign using the hashtag #HitlerHemant to target the Hemant Soren-led Jharkhand government over the police action against protesting students on August 10.

BJP state general secretary Amar Kumar Bauri, while criticising the action over the stu-

dents and the ABVP activists, said the hashtag was not merely a social media trend but a symbol of what he called the government's "cruelty and brutality" towards students.

Bauri alleged that the government was trying to suppress the students' movement through force, adding the BJP would continue the fight "from the streets to the Assembly."

Meanwhile, student leader Devendra Nath Mahto, after he was allegedly injured in the protest on Monday, issued an open letter from the hospital.

Thanking all those who participated in the Assembly gherao programme, he demanded action against those responsible for the lathi-charge on the protesters.

On Tuesday evening, students also took out a silent march in protest against the lathi-charge.

SC declines to interfere in HC order on TMC bank accounts

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 11

THE SUPREME Court on Tuesday declined to interfere with the July 20 Calcutta High Court (HC) order refusing to grant interim permission to the Mamata Banerjee faction of the Trinamool Congress (TMC) to operate three bank accounts earlier frozen by the Enforcement Directorate (ED).

A bench comprising Justices M M Sundresh and P B Varale noted that the HC had on July 9 allowed partial operation of the accounts to meet day-to-day expenses and said it is "satisfied that the HC... has passed a balanced order". Disposing of appeals by the All India Trinamool Congress (AITC) and Biswanath Das, a rebel TMC leader, Justice Sundresh said, "The interim order takes care of it. Only other issue is whether something more needs to be done... For day-to-day administration funds are there... We will not say anything. We will dispose of both the matters and leave it to the discretion of the Special Officer appointed by the HC".

The ED had frozen the accounts carrying Rs 400 crore in connection with a money laundering probe stemming from a West Bengal Police FIR. On July 9, the HC had appointed former Calcutta HC judge, Justice Subrata Talukdar, as the Special Officer till September 30.



Uttar Pradesh CM Yogi Adityanath inaugurates a two-lane road in Gorakhpur on Tuesday. BJP MP Ravi Kishan also present. ANI

Yogi: Only those who respect aastha can bring vikas

Express News Service
Lucknow, August 11

WITH RAHUL Gandhi and Akhilesh Yadav upping their attack on the BJP and Narendra Modi government over unemployment and the state of education in the country, Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on Tuesday hit out at the Opposition leaders, asking if they were "uneducated" to level such charges.

The CM also said that a government that respects "faith can bring development" and added that "those who do not have respect for your faith in their hearts cannot bring development".

Addressing a government event in Sant Kabir Nagri district, where he inaugurated and laid foundation stones for 201 development projects of over Rs 684 crore, the chief minister said: "The government that respects faith will bring development. Those who don't have any respect for your faith in their hearts cannot bring development. They usurp students' scholarships, loot money from development works, and loot jobs of youth."

Accusing Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi and Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav of "only doing politics" and "resorting to propaganda", the BJP leader said, "I would like to tell Rahul Gandhi and Akhilesh Yadav that if you pay attention to the figures, their reality will come out. The figures show that before 2014, that is, before Prime Minister Modi, there were only 16 IITs in the country

after Congress ruled for a long time, and after 2014, under Modi ji's leadership, the number of IITs has become 23 — a 40 per cent increase."

"The number of IITs has increased from 13 to 22 — an increase of 69 per cent... Before 2014, there was no system like the Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana in existence. Today, 600 centres are being operated across the country," the chief minister said, adding, "I do not know whether these people (Rahul and Akhilesh) are even educated or not. Their ridiculous statements themselves put them in the dock."

"Before 2014, their parties did not show any interest in building medical colleges, so where could a child have secured admission? And today you are doing politics — only politics, but you cannot do justice to the youth... During their time, jobs were looted, but now, if anyone plays with the future of the youth, along with property seizure, we will ensure a sentence of life imprisonment. Here too, the policy of zero tolerance will be visible," the CM added. He said development required political will and cited the establishment of medical colleges across eastern Uttar Pradesh.

Speaking about Sant Kabir of the Nirgun tradition, after whom the district was named, Adityanath said that Kabir spoke as much against Muslim fundamentalism as he did against Hindu fundamentalism. "But Hindus worship him, while Muslims do not even want to touch him from a distance."



हरकोर्ट बटलर प्राविधिक विश्वविद्यालय
नवाबगंज, कानपुर - 208002, उ.प्र., भारत
HARCOURT BUTLER TECHNICAL UNIVERSITY
NAWABGANJ, KANPUR-208002, U.P., INDIA
(Formerly Harcourt Butler Technological Institute, Kanpur)
Phone +91-0512-2534001-5, 2533812, website: www.hbtu.ac.in, Email: vc@hbtu.ac.in

File No. 1069/Admn/OTSC/Adv-2/2026
Dated: 11-08-2026

Applications are invited from eligible Candidates for Temporary Positions of 'Adjunct Faculty' and 'Professor of Practice'; and also from organisations for instituting of 'Chair Professor' in various departments of the University later by August 24th, 2026.
For more details visit our website <http://www.hbtu.ac.in>

Registrar



त्रिपुरा विश्वविद्यालय
TRIPURA UNIVERSITY
(विश्वविद्यालय / A Central University), सुनमिनगर, त्रिपुरा (W), पिन / PIN - 799022
No. ETU/REG/ADVT/NT/2026 Date: 11.08.2026

EMPLOYMENT NOTIFICATION
Tripura University invites online application from the eligible Indian Citizens for filling up various Non-teaching Group-A positions : Registrar - 1 (UR), Controller of Examinations - 1 (UR), Senior System Analyst - 1 (UR).
The filling up of online application form will start from 12.08.2026. Last date of submission is 11.09.2026. Details are available in the Tripura University website: www.tripurauniv.ac.in and <https://tripuraunivnt.samarth.edu.in> (NB: Hindi version is available on T.U. website).
Sd/- (Prof. Samir Kumar Sil), Registrar(I/c)

IN THE MATTER OF APPLICATION BY ADANI ENERGY SOLUTIONS STEP-ELEVEN LIMITED AND ADANI ENERGY SOLUTIONS LIMITED FOR GRANT OF PARALLEL DISTRIBUTION LICENSE FOR THE DATA CENTER PARK SITUATED AT NOIDA, UTTAR PRADESH

ADANI ENERGY SOLUTIONS STEP-ELEVEN LIMITED & ADANI ENERGY SOLUTIONS LIMITED
Adani Corporate House, Shantigram, Near Vaishno Devi Circle, Shantigram, S G Highway, Ahmedabad, Gujarat - 382421. Email id: Saloni.Fulmali@adani.com | CIN: U27104GJ2024PLC157135

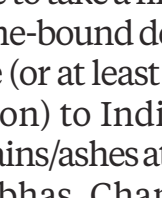
PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE u/s 15(2)(i) of ELECTRICITY ACT, 2003 FOR INVITING COMMENTS / SUGGESTIONS / OBJECTIONS ON APPLICATION FILED BY ADANI ENERGY SOLUTIONS STEP-ELEVEN LIMITED ALONG WITH ADANI ENERGY SOLUTIONS LIMITED FOR GRANT OF PARALLEL DISTRIBUTION LICENSE UNDER SECTION 14 AND SECTION 15 OF THE ELECTRICITY ACT, 2003 (CASE NO. 2333 of 2025 BEFORE UTTAR PRADESH ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION)

- Adani Energy Solutions Step-Eleven Limited (AESSEL) is a company incorporated under the relevant provisions of the Companies Act, 2013, inter alia engaged in the business of developing and managing electricity infrastructure facilities and other allied business activities in India. AESSEL as Operator has filed an application along with Adani Energy Solutions Limited (AESL) before the Hon'ble UPERC for grant of Parallel Distribution License for undertaking supply and distribution of electricity within the Data Centre Park being developed by DC Development Noida Limited at Plot 20, Sector 62, Noida, Uttar Pradesh, bearing Case No. 2333 of 2025 under Sections 14 and 15 read with Section 86 (1) (d) of Electricity Act, 2003 ('the Act') read with UPERC (General Conditions of Distribution Licence) Regulations, 2004 ('**UPERC Distribution License Regulations**') read with Distribution of Electricity License (Additional Requirements of Capital Adequacy, Creditworthiness and Code of Conduct) Rules, 2005 ('**Distribution License Rules**') and the Amendment thereof, and Government of Uttar Pradesh Notification No. 444/24-P-3-2023 dated 10.03.2023, and read with Uttar Pradesh Data Centre Policy 2021 (as amended on 07.11.2022) ('**DC Policy**'). The Hon'ble Commission has admitted the Application on 30.07.2026 and directed AESSEL to publish a Public Notice under Section 15(2) of the Act.
- Description of Proposed Area of Supply:** AESSEL has filed an application for grant of Parallel Distribution License for undertaking supply and distribution of power within the Data Centre Park being developed by DC Development Noida Limited at Plot C-20/1A/10, Sector 62, Noida, Uttar Pradesh. The said data center park falls within the Notification No. 444/24-P-3-2023 dated 10.03.2023 and read with Uttar Pradesh Data Centre Policy 2021 (as amended on 07.11.2022) and satisfies the criteria of 'minimum supply area' for the purpose of grant of parallel distribution license as per the Electricity Act, 2003 and the rules framed thereunder.
- The Petitioner is a Company incorporated under the Companies Act, 2013 (18 of 2013) on 17.12.2024 bearing Corporate Identification Number (CIN) U27104GJ2024PLC157135.
- The Application / Petition is available for the purposes of inspection on the website www.adanienergysolutions.com and at the Adani Energy Solutions Step-Eleven Limited, Office of Adani Enterprises Limited, 9th Floor, Shalimar Iridium, Vibhuti Khand, Gomti Nagar, Lucknow, UP - 226010.
- AESSEL hereby confirms and declares that it duly complies with additional requirements laid down under Distribution License Rules including its amendments. Documents indicating the compliance of the aforesaid requirements are part of the Distribution License Application and the same can be accessed on the above-mentioned website.
- In accordance with the order dated 05.08.2026 passed by the Hon'ble UPERC in the present matter, notice is hereby given to the public in general and other stakeholders ('**Noticee(s)**') desirous of making comments / suggestions / objections with reference to the grant of License. Noticee(s) may file such comments / suggestions / objections before the Secretary, UP Electricity Regulatory Commission, Vidyut Niyamak Bhawan, Vibhuti Khand, Gomti Nagar, Lucknow - 226010 by post, along with soft copy through email at secretary@uperc.org within thirty (30) days from the date of publication of this notice, along with proof of service to AESSEL on the email: saloni.fulmali@adani.com
- In case the Hon'ble Commission allows subsequent amendment / changes resulting in amendment of the license petition, AESSEL undertakes to publish such changes or the complete notice afresh for soliciting the comments / suggestions of the public and shall adhere to the requirements u/s 15 of the Act and UPERC Regulations, 2004.

Sd/-
Saloni Fulmali
(Authorised Signatory)
Adani Energy Solutions Step-Eleven Limited

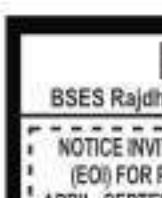
Date: **12.08.2026**
Place: **Mumbai, Maharashtra**



BS&S
BS&S Rajdhani Power Limited, New Delhi

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI) FOR PURCHASE OF POWER DURING APRIL-SEPTEMBER FOR THE PERIOD 2027-2029.
EOI No. HOD (PWS)/2026-27/860 DATED 11th AUG 2026

BS&S Rajdhani Power Limited (BRPL) invites Expression of Interest (EOI) from eligible Power Generators, Power Trading Licensees and other authorized entities for supply of up to 500 MW of medium-term power during April-September for the period 2027-2029.
EOIs are invited for one or more of the following:
• **Peak Power:** 00:00-03:00 HRS and 18:00-24:00 HRS
• **Hydro Power:** Seasonal/profile-based supply
• **RTC Power:** Coal-based/RE/RE-Hybrid or any other combination source
This EOI is issued solely to assess market availability and procurement options & shall not constitute an invitation to bid or any commitment by BRPL to procure power.
The detailed EOI document, eligibility criteria and submission schedule is available on the BRPL website: <https://www.bsdsdhi.com/web/brpl/power-procurement-tenders>
Last Date for Submission: 2nd September 2026
Head (Power Management Group)
Address : BS&S Rajdhani Power Limited
BS&S Bhawan, Nehru Place,
New Delhi - 110019. (Tel: 011-49209037)
Regd. Off. : BS&S Rajdhani Power Limited,
BS&S Bhawan, Nehru Place, New Delhi-110019
Corporate Identification No.: U40100DL2001PLC111527
Telephone No. : +91 11 4912 1235
Website : www.bsdsdhi.com



ICAR-INDIAN VETERINARY RESEARCH INSTITUTE
IZATNAGAR-243 122 (UP) INDIA
Website : www.ivri.nic.in

ADMISSION NOTICE FOR BVSc & AH DEGREE PROGRAMME, 2026-27
Applications are invited from eligible candidates for admission to the BVSc & AH degree programme at ICAR-IVRI Deemed University as per the detailed procedure mentioned in the Information Bulletin -cum- Prospectus uploaded on ICAR-IVRI website (www.ivri.nic.in). Merit list of NEET (UG)-2026 will be considered for the counseling & admissions in BVSc & AH degree programme. The candidate has to apply online using the "**IVRI BVSc & AH Admission 2026-27 Application Portal**" during period from **14.08.2026 to 31.08.2026**. The candidates are advised to visit the ICAR-IVRI Website regularly for updates.

Senior Registrar



ICAR-INDIAN VETERINARY RESEARCH INSTITUTE
IZATNAGAR-243 122 (UP) INDIA
Website : www.ivri.nic.in

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Senior Registrar

RG Kar case: FIR against TMC ex-MLA, 2 others over hurried cremation

Tanusree Bose
Kolkata, July 11

THE BARRACKPORE Police Commissionerate in West Bengal's North 24 Parganas district on Monday registered a fresh FIR against former TMC MLA Nirmal Ghosh over the hurried cremation of R G Kar rape and murder victim in Panihati in 2024.

The FIR was registered based on a complaint from the victim's father, naming three persons: former TMC MLA and party's ex-chief whip, Nirmal Ghosh, Panihati Municipality councillor, Somnath Dey, and a neighbour of the victim's family, Sanjeev Mukherjee.

Police said they have spoken to people at the crematorium and found that though two other bodies were in queue, once the R G victim's body arrived, it was rushed through. The signature on the forms were neither of the parents nor of any family member but of neighbours, police said.

NEET-UG PAPER LEAK CASE

Probe: NTA subject expert gave son of coaching centre owner 132 questions

Accused Raghunath Motegaonkar's son attended classes held in a 'deluxe room' at Latur hospital for three days: CBI probe

Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, August 11

THE 18-YEAR-OLD son of Shivaraj Raghunath Motegaonkar, owner of Latur's Renukai Career Coaching Institute who is a key accused in the NEET-UG paper leak case, is learnt to have told the CBI that he attended a special class in a 'deluxe room' at the Siddhivinayak Hospital in Latur, where the National Testing Agency's Chemistry expert Pralhad Vithalrao Kulkarni dictated 132 questions and answers.

Motegaonkar's son had appeared for the NEET exam held on May 3, which was later cancelled. His statement has been cited in the agency's chargesheet which lists 360 witnesses, *The Indian Express* has learnt. The chargesheet that names 13

accused was filed on July 28 before a Delhi fast-track court.

The youth is learnt to have told the CBI that around April 15, Motegaonkar asked him to visit the Siddhivinayak Hospital to meet a Chemistry teacher. The hospital is run by Manoj Bhagwanrao Shirure. Both Kulkarni and Shirure have since been arrested.

"He questioned his father about why he was being sent to another Chemistry teacher when his family already ran a coaching centre. His father, he said, told him that the teacher was a NEET expert and would provide important questions related to the examination," sources said.

The youth is learnt to have told the CBI that he went to Siddhivinayak Hospital on April 18, 19 and 22. "On each of

these days, he was taken to the third floor of the hospital, where an elderly man, later identified by him as P V Kulkarni, conducted Chemistry revision classes for 1.5 to 2 hours. During these sessions, Kulkarni carried a bunch of papers and dictated questions and answers, which he wrote down in his notebook in his own handwriting," sources said.

Across the three classes, he is learnt to have said that he noted down 132 Chemistry questions along with their answers. "During investigation, he also identified Dr Shirure, who runs Siddhivinayak Hospital, as his family doctor. He said the hospital was the place where the classes were conducted. On April 18, Dr Shirure was present at the hospital and directed the receptionist, Bhu-

jang Rajkumar Birajdar, to take him to the third floor," sources said.

According to sources, the youth also identified the receptionist from a video call. He is also learnt to have identified Kulkarni and Shirure.

"He also claimed that he went to the hospital again on April 20 but Kulkarni did not arrive, and he left without attending any class. He did not go on April 21 because of ill health. On April 22, he again visited the hospital, met the receptionist, went to the third floor and attended another session with Kulkarni," sources said.

The youth is learnt to have told investigators that after returning from these classes, his father would check his notebook. He is learnt to have said that Motegaonkar was not convinced about the questions, so he did not memorise them. While the youth got 117 marks out of 180 in Chemistry, he is learnt to have said that if he had

trusted the list of questions, he could have scored full marks.

The CBI, it is learnt, also asked him whether Motegaonkar had copied or made notes of the questions. "He said his father had not made any such notes in his presence. However, he added that his father used to go through the questions that he had written in his notebook during Kulkarni's classes," sources said.

The CBI, it is learnt, asked him where he had kept the notebook containing the questions provided by Kulkarni. According to sources, the youth said that after the completion of NEET-UG, he sold his notebooks to a scrap dealer.

The CBI also learnt to have recorded the statement of the Siddhivinayak Hospital receptionist and asked him about visitor entry records. He said no record for visitors was maintained in the hospital register and only patients' entry records were maintained, said sources.



High Commissioner of India to Bangladesh Dinesh Trivedi calls on Prime Minister Narendra Modi in New Delhi on Tuesday. ANI

Day after talks with Rahman, Trivedi meets PM Modi

Shubhrajit Roy
New Delhi, August 11

A DAY after meeting Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman, India's High Commissioner to Bangladesh Dinesh Trivedi met Prime Minister Narendra Modi in New Delhi and sought his "guidance" for an "enduring" bilateral ties between Delhi and Dhaka.

"High Commissioner Dinesh Trivedi called on Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi today and sought his guidance on further strengthening the multifaceted and enduring bilateral relationship between India and Bangladesh in a constructive manner with a people-centric approach," the Indian High Commission in Bangladesh posted on X.

Five days after ousted Bangladesh Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina's remarks in India angered Dhaka, Bangladesh PM Rahman had raised the issue of her extradition with Trivedi on Monday and had underlined the need to "create a conducive environment to further advance the bilateral relations between the two countries."

On Sunday, Trivedi had described Rahman and Modi as

people's persons and expressed optimism that solutions to issues between the two countries could be found if the two leaders meet.

"We all respect him (Rahman) a lot. He speaks from his heart. I listened to his speeches many times.... He is a people's person, our Prime Minister (Modi) too. I think when two leaders meet, a lot of problems are sorted out. I have full confidence," he had told reporters. This invoking the persona of the two leaders is key, since Rahman is yet to visit India. He has already visited China and met Chinese President Xi Jinping.

After meeting Rahman, Trivedi had described the meeting as "fruitful", and that Bangladesh and India not only share a border but also share dreams.

"...Our invitation is in place. We are positive that if the two leaders meet, there will be discussion. There will be issues in democracies. It's not democracy if there is no issue. But there is only one people's issue, which is good relations. It's a win-win situation if there is a good relationship," he said, referring to India's invitation to Rahman to attend the BRICS leaders' outreach summit in September.

Man roamed Bengaluru hotel for hours after killing 2 daughters: Cops

Kiran Parashar
Bengaluru, August 11

CCTV FOOTAGE from a five-star hotel near the Bengaluru airport showed a man wandering around the premises for hours after allegedly killing his two daughters.

Police said, Imran S G allegedly killed his daughters, aged 10 and 5, around 1 pm on Monday. He then left the room and moved around the hotel until around 4.30 pm.

The family was to check out by Monday noon but when they did not respond, the hotel security opened the room and found the bodies of the two girls. Imran, who was lying unconscious in the room, was taken to Manipal Hospital.

"We went through the CCTV footage... It appears that he did not know what to do after killing his children. He looked stressed, but none of the hotel staff noticed it," a police officer said.

Imran married Sana 12 years ago. The couple, who have been

living separately, had agreed that their children would stay with Sana on weekdays and with Imran on weekends.

There was a dispute over their jointly owned apartment and the custody of their children, with Imran seeking his Rs 8 lakh share in the property and full custody of the children, the police said.

Last Saturday, Imran took his children to his elder brother's apartment, and the next day he checked into the hotel. "The mother did not object as Imran had taken them to a luxurious hotel," the officer said.

On Sunday, the couple got into an argument on WhatsApp over the custody of their children. When Imran refused to send the girls to Sana, she threatened to take legal action. The officer said Imran wrote in the two-page purported suicide note that he did not want his children to grow up in such an environment, and he would take them with him. Imran has been booked for murder.

IPL cricketer held for 'rape' of medical student

Sweetey Kumari
Kolkata, August 11

ABISHEK POREL, an IPL cricketer from West Bengal, has been arrested for rape after a medical student accused him of engaging in sexual relations with her under the false promise of marriage, assaulting her, and confining her against her will.

Porel's arrest comes almost a month after the Calcutta High Court directed the police to trace and apprehend the cricketer and also seize his electronic devices.

The 23-year-old wicket-keeper-batsman, who has played for Delhi Capitals in the

Indian Premier League (IPL), has been arrested on several charges, including rape, causing death or resulting in a persistent vegetative state of the victim of rape, sexual intercourse by employing deceitful means, assault, and cheating, among others.

"Porel was arrested from Emami City under the Dum Dum police station late last night. He was produced in court today (Tuesday) and remanded to police custody for three days," Hooghly (Rural) Superintendent of Police Kunwar Bhushan Singh told *The Indian Express* over the phone.

EXPRESS special

Remote location, reluctant parents: MP battles odds amid outbreak that left 6 kids dead

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, August 11

SIX CHILDREN have died and 100 others have fallen ill in four remote, Baiga-dominated villages of Madhya Pradesh's Balaghat district over the past month.

The health department said it learnt about the deaths only after three children had already died.

Though the exact cause of the illness and deaths is not known yet, the immediate challenge for authorities was locating the children in the remote areas and convincing their parents to allow them to be taken to hospital.

Eventually, the health officials had to take police's help to ensure the children were sent to the hospital.

The children, aged between one and 13, are from Adori, Kunderksa, Bondari and Korka villages in the Baihar area. They have reported high fever, rashes, red spots, stomach pain and ulcers. Of the 100 children who have fallen ill, 47 are currently admitted to hospitals and 54 are being treated at home, officials said.

With the exact cause of the illness not known yet, blood samples have been sent to the ICMR-National Institute of Research in Bacterial Infections in Kolkata and the ICMR-National Institute of Virology in Pune. A team from Jabalpur Medical College is investigating the outbreak.

Series of challenges

Before identifying the disease, the challenge before the authorities was locating the children.



A number of affected children are undergoing treatment at Balaghat district hospital.

"We got to know about the deaths after three had already taken place. After a local source informed us, we sent out a team," Balaghat chief medical and health officer (CMHO) Paresh Upal told *The Indian Express*. The team then faced an arduous journey into the affected settlements.

"It was extremely difficult to access the terrain because some of the houses were located on a small hill, while others were situated near dense forested regions. So it was very difficult to carry out a health investigation on the ground," Upal said.

Once the health teams reached the villages, officials encountered another problem: Families reluctant to dis-

close the cases.

"The villagers were extremely reluctant to come forward with the cases because they did not want their children to be admitted to the hospitals," Upal said.

"We were not able to convince these people to hand over their children for treatment," he said. The officials left and returned with the police.

"We had to go back and get the help of the entire police administration to ensure we got those children to the hospital," Upal said.

By then, some families had started using faith healing and other practices in an attempt to treat or revive the sick children, according to the

chief medical and health officer. "This also took up a lot of time," he said.

'Parents hid their children in forests'

The complications were not over yet.

"We also had this case of parents hiding their children in forests," Upal said.

Health officials had to locate the children and bring them into medical care. The resistance, though, did not end after the children reached hospitals.

According to Upal, in some cases, parents followed their children to the hospital and attempted to take them away before they had been formally discharged.

"We also had this case of parents tracking down their children in the hospital and then trying to leave with them without a discharge slip," he said.

The department spent considerable time trying to persuade the families to keep their children under medical supervision.

With the outbreak continuing to be investigated, the health department has now deployed multiple teams in the affected area.

A medical post has been established on top of a hillock, with two medical officers stationed there to supervise the cases, the CMHO said.

The district administration has also established temporary health camps in the affected villages. With samples being examined at two ICMR laboratories, the children are being monitored for symptoms.

{ M P PARAMESWARAN • 1935-2026 }

Nuclear scientist who worked on popularising science beyond classroom and labs

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram,
August 11

RENOWNED NUCLEAR scientist Dr M P Parameswaran, one of the key figures who worked to popularise the people's scientific movement in the country, died in Kerala's Thirissur on Tuesday. He was 91.

A prolific author, the former BARC scientist had played a pivotal role in several movements such as Kerala Sastra Sahitya Parishad (KSSP), Bharat Gyan Vigyan Samiti (BGVS), All India People's Science Network (AIPSN) and the literacy movement in Kerala.

In early 2000, Parameswa-

ran, a Communist thinker, had triggered an ideological debate in CPI(M) after he advocated the "fourth world" concept. As the party found his concept a deviation from the Marxist-Leninist stream, Parameswaran was expelled from the CPI (M) after being its member for three decades. In the widely debated fourth world concept, he had envisaged an alternative model of development tailoring Marxism, green movement, human rights, people's participatory democracy and Gandhian thought. It was projected as an alternative to traditional socialist models in the wake of the fall of the USSR.

Born in Thrissur, Parameswaran obtained his engineering

degree from College of Engineering in Thiruvananthapuram in 1956 and secured a PhD in nuclear engineering from Moscow Power Institute in 1965. In between, he joined BARC as a nuclear scientist and continued there until 1975, when he turned into an activist of Kerala Sastra Sahitya Parishad (KSSP). Between 1969 and 1973, he also had an innings as an assistant director at the State Institute of Languages in Kerala.

After quitting BARC, he turned into an activist of KSSP, which was then engaged in popularising science beyond the confines of labs and classrooms, and inculcating scientific temperament among people. With



In early 2000, Parameswaran triggered a debate after he advocated the 'fourth world' concept. FACEBOOK/PINARAYI VIJAYAN

the nuclear scientist at the helm, KSSP transformed into a strong people's scientific movement.

Inspired by the success of the KSSP, Parameswaran took his mission nation-wide. He had been at the helm of the Bharat Jan Vigyan Jatha, a people's science and scientific-literacy campaign in India, which started in 1987 following the debates over the 1984 Bhopal gas tragedy. A year later, in 1988, All India People's Science Network, a platform of 40-odd science organisations in the country, was formed. Parameswaran converted the AIPSN into a platform advocating scientific temper, rationalism and secularism.

Parameswaran believed that participatory democracy should have an educated society and hence, he deliberated

on the idea of total literacy.

Working closely with National Literacy Mission, Parameswaran, heading KSSP, had been instrumental in rolling out literacy movement in Ernakulam district, which was declared as the country's first totally literate district in 1990. That year, he was behind the organisation of the Bharat Gyan Vigyan Jatha in support of the national literacy mission, eventually leading to pan-India literacy campaign.

In the mid-1990s, Parameswaran had given an ideological ground for decentralisation of power, which the Left in Kerala took forward. In shaping decentralised development, Parameswaran was influenced by

German-born economist E F Schumacher's work: "Small Is Beautiful. A study of economics as if people mattered."

With Parameswaran at its helm, the KSSP had earned widespread acclaim for activities related to generating environmental consciousness, literacy campaigns, and decentralised, micro-level planning. KSSP went on to bag the Right Livelihood Award in 1996, the UNESCO Literacy Award in 1990, the UNEP's Global 500, and the Vriksa Mitra award.

Parameswaran authored several popular science books in Malayalam and English covering atomic science, astronomy, mathematics,

politics, social science and ecology. Among his notable works are "Fourth World" and "Janakeeya Sastra Prasthanam".

Kerala CM V D Sathesnan, in his message, said that beyond being a scientist, Parameswaran was a philosopher, whose thoughts had profoundly influenced Kerala's thinking on social development.

Opposition Leader and ex-CM Pinarayi Vijayan, said, "Parameswaran had dedicated his life to bringing science closer to ordinary people and fostering scientific awareness and rational thinking in society. He had been a staunch advocate and campaigner of Left politics and scientific, socialist thought."

In tax dispute over judges’ benefits, HC orders halt to processing their ITRs

Sohini Ghosh & Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, August 11

THE DELHI High Court on Monday asked judges of the Supreme Court and High Courts to provide their PAN (Permanent Account Number) to the Income Tax Department, and directed that no tax demand or refund in respect of these PANs should be processed until further orders.

The Delhi HC Bench of Justices Dinesh Mehta and Rajneesh Kumar Gupta was hearing a dispute over taxing the allowances of judges.

The Delhi Tax Bar Association (DTBA), a body of professionals dealing with direct and indirect tax laws, has challenged an office memorandum issued by the Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT) in September 2025, which made allowances and exemptions available to SC and HC judges taxable under the New Tax Regime.

DTBA has said that it has filed the plea since members of the association “not only file returns of income” of HC and SC judges “but also advise them in relation to their investment and tax related issues”. The association has around 800 members.

A petition similar to the DTBA’s was filed by Justice Sandeep Jain of the Allahabad High Court in that court in July.

Under the Old Tax Regime, allowances paid to judges — including the value of rent-free official housing (or a monthly allowance where official housing is not provided), conveyance facilities such as car, driver, and fuel, a sumptuary allowance, and leave travel concession (LTC) — are excluded from taxable salary under the High Court Judges (Salaries and Conditions of Service) Act, 1954, and the Supreme Court Judges (Salaries and Conditions of Service) Act, 1958.

The New Tax Regime, introduced under Section 115BAC of The Income Tax Act from Assessment Year 2021-22, offers lower tax rates in exchange for far fewer deductions. It has since become the default option, although taxpayers can still choose to stay with the old regime.

In his petition in the Allahabad HC, Justice Jain has said that of his gross salary of Rs 46.78 lakh for 2025-26, Rs 2.81 lakh was sumptuary allowance and Rs 7.04 lakh was house rent allowance (HRA). If he filed his return under the new regime, he could not claim exemption

on this Rs 9.85 lakh.

The DTBA has argued that the CBDT’s 2025 memorandum bringing such benefits and perquisites within the tax net under the new regime deprives serving judges of a “statutory benefit forming part of the conditions of service attached to judicial office”, and pushes up their tax liability.

The DTBA has also argued that regardless of the introduction of the new tax regime, the allowances of judges shall continue to remain out of the tax net. It has argued that the 2025 memorandum is “clearly contrary to law”, and amounts to “nothing short of interference in the independence of judiciary”.

Clause 2(iv) of Section 115BAC bars taxpayers under the new regime from claiming any exemption or deduction for allowances or perquisites granted under any other central or state law. Clause 2(i) of the same section, by contrast, lists the specific exemptions that the new regime allows.

“The use of the phrase “under any other law for the time being in force” in the Income-tax Act is in the law to ensure that tax-free allowances or perquisites created outside the Act do not undermine the new tax regime, regardless of existing or fu-

ture legislation,” a person familiar with the developments said.

The DTBA has also argued that the executive cannot, through administrative instructions, “alter the legal incidents of judicial office or diminish benefits which Parliament has attached thereto”.

Judicial independence, being part of the basic structure of the Constitution, requires that judges’ conditions of service be shielded from executive interference, direct or indirect, the association has said in its plea.

In its memorandum, the CBDT reasoned that since the new regime already offers liberal slabs, lower rates and higher rebates, extending further exemptions on perquisites “would tantamount to providing double benefits”.

In an interim order on July 22, the Delhi HC directed the Income Tax Department not to process returns filed by HC and SC judges, and allowed them to declare the allowance amount as ‘receipts not in the nature of income’ under the ‘Exempt Income’ category on the e-filing portal.

On July 28, a Division Bench of the Allahabad HC comprising Justices Saumitra Dayal Singh and Swarupama Chaturvedi, which heard Justice Jain’s plea,

directed that no separate interim relief was needed since the Delhi HC’s order had already enabled the filing of returns under the new scheme.

The Income Tax Department, however, moved an application before the Delhi HC on August 5 seeking modification of the July 22 order. It said that returns are processed automatically within minutes of filing, and there was no way to separately flag judges’ returns at its processing centres. This meant full compliance would require halting the processing of all returns filed nationwide, running into crores.

Taking the Department’s difficulty into account, the court on Monday asked the private secretaries of SC and HC judges who had filed returns under the new regime to furnish their PAN details to an income tax officer by August 18.

It directed the Department not to process returns “of the judges qua whom such intimation has been received”, and ordered that any resulting demand or refund be kept in abeyance pending the outcome of the DTBA’s plea.

Queries sent by *The Indian Express* to the Ministry of Finance and the CBDT went unanswered.

No beds at Gadchiroli tribal school, a night of horror leaves 3 dead of snakebite

2 girls hospitalised, one on ventilator; Maharashtra govt orders cancellation of licence of school

Ankita Deshkar
Nagpur, August 11

MAHARASHTRA CHIEF Minister Devendra Fadnis Tuesday ordered permanent cancellation of the licence of a government-aided residential school for tribal children in Gadchiroli after three girls died of a snakebite there.

A month more, and the incident may not have come to pass.

The children at the school — which was started in 1992 and has 233 students on its rolls currently — slept on mats spread on the ground. A teacher said they had been raising the issue of lack of beds with the principal. “We were told that the students would get the beds after the Pola festival (in September).”

The deaths, at the school located in Japtalai village, has drawn outrage, with the Opposition raising questions over the state of tribal residential schools in Maharashtra, and the Mahayuti government announcing a third-party audit of over 500 ‘ashram’ or residential schools for tribal children in the state.

The school is run by a trust whose secretary is local Congress leader Vishwajeet Marotrao Kowase.

There were 65 girls on the premises of the co-ed residential school, Anudanti Prathamik/Madhyamik Ashram Shala in tribal-dominated Japtalai, when the snake bit six of them in the early hours of Monday. While two died, another succumbed on the way to hospital, and a fourth is critical and on ventilator supports. The nearest hospital is 10 km away and, as per sources, poor road



The hall where the kids slept on the floor. EXPRESS

conditions, worsened by the rains, delayed the journey.

Deepika Madavi, 12, who was also bitten, was airlifted to Nagpur, and is now admitted to the Paediatric Intensive Care Unit at Government Medical College and Hospital (GMCH). Doctors said she is stable.

Fifteen other students, sleeping in the hall along with the injured girls, are believed to be in shock and are under observation.

The snake, a common krait, was caught and killed.

A Class 5 student, Deepika was rushed to Nagpur along with a teacher and her grandfather, Chaturshah Madavi. Sitting by her bedside, gently stroking Deepika’s hair, Chaturshah says: “This was Deepika’s first year at the school.”

There was no time to inform Deepika’s parents, who were in the fields working when the school called to say what had happened. “I rushed to the school, and they told me Deepika had to be shifted to Gadchiroli. I then came to know that we would have to leave in a helicopter for Nagpur,” Chaturshah says.

Till Class 4, Deepika studied at the only school in her village, Kehekavahi. Her parents then

shifted her to the ashram school, where her elder brother was also studying.

Anil Sahare, who has been associated with the Japtalai school for 26 years and teaches Mathematics and Marathi, admits there were no wardens present Sunday night when the incident happened.

“We celebrated World Tribal Day that morning. After that, since it was Sunday, the teaching staff went home. My home is around 2 km from the school,” Sahare says.

Additional Tribal Commissioner Ayushi Singh told *The Indian Express* that a team has visited the school and identified lapses related to safety and infrastructure. Notices have also been issued to the principal and the wardens (male and female), as well as a show-cause notice management representative, Singh says.

“We have also started corrective action at the level of the Tribal Development Department. The verification of all government-aided schools in the Vidarbha region will be done, apart from a third-party audit of these ashram schools.”

Gadchiroli Collector Avishyant Panda told *The Indian Express*, “It is a government-aided private ashram school run by a trust. They did not follow norms and kept the window open at night (the snake is believed to have got in through the window). Action will be taken against those responsible.”

The government has announced Rs 5 lakh each for families of the students who died, as well as a similar sum from the Chief Minister’s Relief Fund.

For the villagers, it is no compensation for the lives lost. On Monday afternoon, when former and present Gadchiroli MLA Ashok Nete and Milind Narote, respectively, visited the ashram school, villagers ghe-raoded them, demanding justice.

Parcel meant for Kashmir farmer throws up 4kg of cocaine

Probe leads to his wife’s ex-boyfriend

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, August 11

EARLIER THIS month, J&K Police received a tip-off: A consignment of narcotics was being sent to Ganderbal district.

The information was significant given the police’s intensified crackdown on drug trafficking, which has lately seen suspected traffickers being booked under the Public Safety Act (PSA), their properties seized, and, in some cases, even their houses demolished.

After intercepting the packet,

police landed at the house of the intended recipient of the parcel: A humble poultry farmer who had got married only a few months ago. He told police that he was expecting poultry feed in the parcel and had no idea about the narcotics.

He did mention another curious piece of information, though. Earlier this year, he had received a phone call from a number in Saudi Arabia, warning him against proceeding with his marriage plan.

Police questioned his wife, which led them to their culprit: A man called Tariq Ahmad Sofi in Srinagar. A resident of Zainakote area, Sofi was the former boyfriend of the poultry farmer’s wife who had hatched the plan



Sofi was arrested on August 9.

to get him arrested in a drugs case, police said. Sofi was arrested on August 9.

A police officer told *The Indian Express* that on August 8,

police received a tip-off about a parcel containing drugs being couriered from outside Jammu and Kashmir. He said the parcel was intercepted at the post office in Ganderbal and opened in front of a magistrate. It contained a consignment of narcotics, including four kilograms of cocaine, 80 grams of cannabis and some psychotropic drugs.

The parcel was couriered from Kanpur in Uttar Pradesh — some 1,300 kms away.

The farmer told the police that he was tricked by the sender, who had contacted him through WhatsApp and promised to send over samples of poultry feed. The farmer shared the phone number of the sender

to the investigators, who found that it was a Saudi Arabian cell-phone number.

A police officer said the farmer told the investigators that he had received a call from a similar number sometime earlier, warning him against marrying the woman. The revelation gave the investigation a new direction.

“It was then that we started to look at the conspiracy angle and the plot to frame him,” he said. Accused Sofi has revealed that the sender from Kanpur, identified as Areeb, was his friend and had shipped the parcel at his insistence.

Sofi has been booked under sections 8/20 and 21 of the NDPS Act.

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Dharavi project

RTI records show that the five clearances were applied for by NECL, through BMC, only after January 2026. Given the delay, the BMC extended the deadline for work to start till March 31. But with only one of the five pending applications being filed within the revised deadline, NECL sought further time until October 30. Subsequently, the BMC extended the deadline again to September 30 while retaining the three-year completion timeline.

The bio remediation work is now likely to begin only by November, according to BMC records — leaving a big question mark over the 2029 completion deadline.

Maharashtra had in October 2024 earmarked 124 acres in Deonar for rehabilitation housing under the Dharavi Rehabilitation Project (DRP), a joint venture between the state government and the Adani Group. It was one of four alternate land parcels identified to relocate those residents who are not eligible for free housing at Dharavi itself. They will be given houses on rent for 12 years after

which the ownership will be transferred to them.

When asked about the delay in filing of applications, NECL said it was due to legal ramifications surrounding the environmental laws. “The project involves freeing the land parcel from the existing mounds of waste. Initially, we were under the impression we would not require an environmental clearance (EC) for the project, as reclaiming the landfill is an environmentally friendly process,” the NECL spokesperson said.

Nothing illustrates the delay better than this sequence: applications for mangrove and wildlife clearances were filed only in April; the Union Environment Ministry was approached for a clearance only in May; and a petition seeking approval from the Bombay High Court is still under preparation, with the BMC appointing its counsel for the purpose only in June.

This Deonar land can be handed over for building apartments only after being fully bio-mined, with clearances being obtained in phases and each development cluster assessed sep-

arately. An investigation by *The Indian Express*, published on April 11, 2025, first revealed that such a project ran contrary to Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) guidelines, which bar housing, hospitals and schools even on a closed landfill.

When asked about commencing construction on the Deonar site, a spokesperson for Adani Navbharat Developers Private Limited executing the Dharavi Redevelopment Project, said, “Any construction work will begin only after all statutory green approvals are obtained and the site is certified by experts as safe and fit for habitation.”

On its part, the BMC said it doesn’t own the land since it was handed over to the state government in 2024, and that its role is limited to executing and monitoring the remediation. “The tender’s deadline was extended because the only alternative was to scrap it, float a fresh tender, and appoint a new contractor. That would have taken even more time and required us to seek fresh approval again. This is the first project of this scale and all permissions have to be in place before work begins,” BMC Deputy Municipal Commissioner (Solid Waste Manage-

ment), Kiran Dighavkar, told *The Indian Express*.

The dumpsite, which sits along the Thane Creek separating Mumbai and Navi Mumbai, is a flamingo habitat adjoined by mangroves and tidal water bodies. The clean-up process mainly involves bioremediation — a process to treat the garbage using natural elements such as air, sunlight and microorganisms. And working on such an eco-sensitive zone requires seven approvals — five of which are now in limbo:

- **Pollution (1 cleared, 1 pending):** Consent to Establish (CTE), which allows machinery and manpower on the site, was applied for on December 2, 2025, and granted by the Maharashtra Pollution Control Board (MPCB) on January 25, 2026. Consent to Operate (CTO), which allows the start of the clean-up, was applied for on January 28, 2026, and remains pending with the MPCB.

- **Coastal (1 cleared):** A No Objection Certificate (NOC), required since the site falls in the coastal zone, was applied for on February 26, 2026, and granted by the Maharashtra Coastal Zone Management Authority (MCZMA) on April 7, 2026.

- **Forest (2 pending):** An

undergo new testing, receive a negative report, and obtain a fitness certificate from the organisation’s medical in-charge.

In case of a second offence, the licence is suspended for three years. A third positive test result leads to the cancellation of licence.

It could not be immediately ascertained if the Air India pilot had tested positive in the past.

Meanwhile, AAIB said in a statement it is “presently engaged in the systematic collection, preservation and examination of all relevant technical, operational, medical and human-factor evidences”. “This includes examination of the aircraft and its systems, recorded flight data, relevant operational and maintenance records, medical information and interviews with persons concerned. All material evidence will be examined in its entirety before any conclusions are drawn,” it said.

The AAIB said the sole objective of the investigation is to determine the circumstances and contributing factors relating to the occurrence and to identify appropriate safety measures to prevent recurrence. It also cautioned that no inference about the probable cause of the incident should be drawn from any isolated information.

“Certain records, statements, medical information and other material collected during the investigation are protected and confidential in accordance with the applicable investigation framework. Maintaining the integrity and confidentiality of the investigation process is essential to a fair, objective and technically sound determination of the facts... The AAIB, therefore, requests all concerned... to... refrain from drawing conclusions on the basis of incomplete, unverified or selectively available information,” it said.

Kashmir

attempts to link their work to the government seizing properties of terrorists.

While the government has not issued a formal order, verbal instructions are learnt to have been passed to various departments, particularly schools and the Revenue Department, to tell Kashmiri Pandits to stay at home.

A principal of a government school said they were initially told to be lenient about migrant employees’ attendance. “First, we were verbally told to allow special leave for them on August 5 (the anniversary of the abrogation of Article 370). Then, we were informed that they should be asked to stay home for some time,” a school principal said.

When contacted, Naseer Ahmad Wani, Director, School Education, said no orders have

been issued to any employee. “We have not asked any employee to work from home or take leave,” he said. “All employees are regularly coming to duty.”

When he was informed that some school principals have confirmed granting special leave to employees, he said he had no knowledge of it.

As part of their rehabilitation, around 6,000 people received benefits under the Prime Minister’s Special Rehabilitation and Employment Package for Kashmiri migrants over the years. One of the conditions is that they work in the Valley. The All Prime Minister’s Package Employees (APMPE) president Sunoo Raina said that around 9,000 such employees are posted in the Valley.

“We have been told to stay home after these posters came up, but that is not a solution to our problem,” Raina said. “We have a social life as well. I have to go to the market to fetch house-

hold items, to get medicines.”

Sources said that while security for migrant employees has been enhanced, as a precautionary measure, they have been asked not to attend work until August 20. Sources said the employees whose names were circulated have been asked to be particularly vigilant.

While the government has made online GPS-based attendance mandatory for teachers in Kashmir, migrant employees have been exempted and are allowed to mark their attendance in an arrival book, it is learnt.

In 2022, militants carried out a string of attacks on migrant Kashmiri Pandit employees. Five people were killed, prompting a protest demanding transfers outside. “We wanted a permanent transfer to Jammu, but L-G *shahib* didn’t listen. He stopped our salary for six months, forcing us to resume our duties,” Raina claimed.



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BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

When tear gas clears, what remains in Ranchi

FOR NEARLY three weeks, thousands of students and job aspirants have taken to the streets of Jharkhand's capital, Ranchi, demanding accountability for alleged irregularities in the state's civil service recruitment examinations. At least five protestors are on hunger strike. The immediate trigger is the controversy surrounding the 14th Jharkhand Public Service Combined Civil Services examination, held in April. Allegations of a paper leak and manipulation in the recruitment process have snowballed into demands for cancellation of the tests and a CBI probe. The state government has ordered investigations, promised fast-track courts and tried to engage with student representatives. Nineteen people, including former Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC) chairperson L. Khiantge, have been arrested. The Hemant Soren government would, however, be misguided in treating the protests merely as a reaction to a single examination that went wrong. The discontent in Ranchi, like the upsurge at Jantar Mantar, reflects a deeper crisis of confidence among a generation whose hopes seem to be increasingly tied to government employment.

More than a quarter-century after it became a state, Jharkhand has struggled to translate the benefits of its immense mineral wealth into opportunities. Private-sector opportunities remain confined to a handful of industrial pockets and the state has among the highest distress-driven labour outflows in the country. Allegations of unfair practices — paper leaks, revised results, interview marks disputes, answer key errors — have dogged recruitment examinations to government services. A CBI probe into the state's first and second civil services examinations — held in 2003 and 2005 — is still underway. Recruitment has also slowed over the years. During the Raghubar Das government's tenure, from 2014 to 2019, no JPSC civil services examination was conducted. The Hemant Soren government has attempted to clear the backlog by conducting tests in one batch. The 7th to 10th civil services examinations were held in 2021, followed by the combined 11th to 13th recruitment tests in 2024. However, the credibility of these exercises was also questioned, and the state was roiled by protests by job aspirants two years ago.

The Soren government owes the state's young population a fair recruitment procedure, and more. It must also work on drawing investment, improving infrastructure, building human capital and easing the burden on government jobs. The protestors have made this point forcefully. Structural changes, such as those required in Jharkhand, need patience and sustained engagement between government, political parties and civil-society groups. All sides need to come together to move towards a resolution.

Infantino foul play, FIFA own goal

LESS THAN a month after the final of the most profitable World Cup in history, generating around \$15 billion in total revenue, the world of football has descended into open war. In the latest development, three of FIFA's six continental governing bodies — UEFA, AFC and CONCACAF — have written to FIFA president Gianni Infantino accusing him of placing "himself above the collective that entrusted him with authority" and calling for an independent review of the now-abandoned proposal to sell a stake in the World Cup to private investors. It is also a polite way of telling him to step down. This is hardly Infantino's first brush with controversy. The FIFA Peace Prize for Donald Trump, who has already waded in to defend him, the Balogun affair, and now the FIFA Forward Enterprise are the latest episodes in a presidency marked by questions over transparency, political motives and the concentration of power at FIFA.

This is not the first time Infantino has sought to push the boundaries of commercial football. In 2018, a deal with Japanese firm SoftBank for an expanded Club World Cup and a global Nations League fell apart amid immediate backlash. The problem is this: The World Cup is not Infantino's to sell. FIFA, which operates legally as a non-profit association, is both a governing federation and an enormous financial enterprise, but the value it seeks to monetise is off something that was not created by FIFA. Football, as it is today, is the product of decades of investment, competition, and the participation of players and fans. The question is whether FIFA should give private investors (including Trump's son-in-law's brother Joshua Kushner) a claim on the commercial future of something as colossal as the World Cup without the consent or scrutiny of the 211 member associations that constitute it. Indeed, it is Infantino's increasingly unilateral style of decision-making that threatens to fracture the footballing world.

The revolt comes at a critical moment for Infantino, with the next FIFA presidential election scheduled for 2027. Instead of revelling in the success of the biggest World Cup ever — albeit one marred by political controversy — he finds himself fighting for survival. The larger principle should be clear to all: One of the richest governing bodies overseeing the world's most popular sport must be administered with transparency and accountability.

A bit of Punjabi and a bit of Spanish

IN THE year 218, a 14-year-old Syrian priest of the Arab sun god Elagabal became emperor of Rome, going on to have a colourful and controversial reign until his assassination four years later. Five centuries later, the ruling elite of the Khazar Khaganate, a Turkic confederacy straddling Asia and Europe, converted to Judaism. The past is another country, where one could encounter cultural interactions and melting pots that have slipped into obscurity. The history of Indian immigration to the US in the early 20th century before the tightening of restrictions is, perhaps, one such chapter that hides fascinating stories. Now, a Mexican-origin singer who wears a turban has brought to light the ties that existed between two communities in California.

In the early 1900s, many Punjabi men in California married Mexican women, and Talibelo, the singer, harks back to that past, although he doesn't claim any such ancestry. Rather, he was drawn to Sikhism after seeing members of the Sikh community in Modesto, California, researched the significance of the turban, and "found it beautiful and dignified", as he told this paper. Now, his Punjabi-Spanish fusion in collaboration with Harveer Singh — an immigrant from Jalandhar whose Spanish singing first drew Talibelo's interest — is getting millions of views online.

At a time of growing nativist backlash, Singh and Talibelo have attempted to highlight immigrants' contributions to the US through music. Their work draws attention to an idea drowned out by political noise: Multiculturalism in an expansive sense, of unexpected combinations creating something new.



RAJA MANDALA
BY C RAJA MOHAN

AMID THE animated Indian commentary on the Mecca Joint Defence Agreement signed on August 7 by Saudi Arabia, Turkey and Pakistan, it is worth recalling a remark made 70 years ago by Huseyn Shaheed Suhrawardy. As Pakistan's prime minister during the Suez crisis of 1956, Suhrawardy was under intense domestic pressure to abandon the Baghdad Pact — a regional security arrangement backed by Britain and the US — and rally behind Egypt's Gamal Abdel Nasser. Suhrawardy dismissed Arab and Muslim solidarity in a phrase that has outlived him: "Zero plus zero plus zero still amounts to zero."

Being analytically right is not the same as being politically correct. Faced with a massive backlash at home and widespread denunciation in the Arab world, Suhrawardy had to eat his words. His government fell within a year. The seven decades since have been kinder to Suhrawardy's analysis.

The United Arab Republic, the Egypt-Syria federation founded in 1958 as pan-Arabism's consummation, dissolved in 1961. The Baghdad Pact lost Iraq in 1959, became the Central Treaty Organisation (CENTO), and expired in 1979. Its developmental twin, the Regional Cooperation for Development — launched in 1964 by Iran, Turkey and

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What my generation can learn from Gen Z, and how we can help



MANOJ KUMAR JHA

GEN Z has compelled the country to sit up and listen. Those of us who have Gen Z children may claim we saw a glimpse of their potential before the rest of society did. Yet, if we are honest, we misunderstood them. They began with a demand that should never have required a national agitation in a mature democracy. Examinations must be conducted honestly, and public institutions must accept responsibility for their failures. The years that young people devote to preparing for their futures cannot be treated as expendable.

I dare say they have changed the political language of protest. What began as the recalculation of an insult has been transformed into an identity of survival, collective strength, and shared belonging. By converting a label meant to diminish them into a badge of resilience and solidarity, they have forged a new political vocabulary, one that connects individual experience with collective identity and turns humiliation into hope. When sections of the established media failed to show what was happening, the protesters represented themselves. Their phones became cameras, and they needed no newsrooms to broadcast.

Some people have dismissed Gen Z methods as non-serious and even obscene. They have misunderstood the political intelligence of humour. Satire can expose arrogance with an immediacy that formal speeches rarely achieve. It can bring together people who do not belong to the same organisation or speak the same ideological vocabulary. Their irreverent language asserted that it is not the duty of the citizens to assume the language and manners preferred by those in authority.

What made me especially admire these young protestors is that they have normalised a fundamental democratic principle, which I and others have been repeating over and over again: An electoral mandate does not relieve a government of the duty to answer citizens between elections. Gen Z has shown other citizens that beyond Parliament and elections, democracy also lives in campuses, collectives, independent media, public meetings, and peaceful protests. When institutions fail to act fairly or become inaccessible, citizens have the

Whatever organisational course they choose, my most fervent wish is that they preserve the qualities that made this mobilisation powerful

Pakistan, the region's three non-Arab Muslim states — became the Economic Cooperation Organisation in 1985 and has achieved little. The Gulf Cooperation Council, founded in 1981 in the shadow of the Iranian revolution and the Iran-Iraq war, could not stop three members blockading a fourth in 2017. Today, the GCC is deeply divided on its approach to war and peace in Iran. The Arab League and the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation are forums for declarations, not instruments of action. National interest has consistently defeated supranational identity, ethnic or religious.

The coalitions that worked were the ones Washington built. American military power, not Arab solidarity, reversed Iraq's annexation of Kuwait in 1991. American-led air and missile defence coordination has repeatedly intercepted Iranian salvos. Six months into the latest hostilities with Iran, the coalition Riyadh has assembled to protect Red Sea shipping — 13 countries and counting — leans on the US Central Command. The accord is therefore not evidence of Islamic security self-reliance but a hedge against American unreliability. The Saudis have watched Washington squander political capital through Donald Trump's erratic policies. They recognise the need to demonstrate, if not develop, other options, however weak.

Pakistan's security cooperation with Saudi Arabia is long-standing; Rawalpindi has provided training, advice and regime protection over the decades. But when Riyadh went to war in Yemen in 2015 and sought Pakistani troops, Islamabad's parliament voted unanimously for neutrality. Since the September 2025 defence pact, Hou-

Pakistan is not among them. A Pakistan less consumed by India and more attentive to its economy might have realised the full possibilities of being a security actor in the Middle East

The writer is Member of Parliament (Rajya Sabha), Rashtriya Janata Dal

thi missiles and drones have struck Saudi Arabia regularly. There is no sign of the Pakistan Army entering that fight; nor has Riyadh joined Rawalpindi's fight with Taliban-led Afghanistan.

Riyadh's Turkish turn is the more significant implication of the Mecca Accord. Only a few years ago, Recep Tayyip Erdoğan was campaigning to make Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman a pariah over the 2018 killing of Jamal Khashoggi. That campaign was inseparable from Ankara's patronage of the Muslim Brotherhood, which several Sunni regimes, including the Saudis, Emiratis and Egyptians, regard as an existential threat.

Erdoğan aspires to a leadership of the Islamic world the Saudis consider theirs by custody of the holy places. And the House of Saud, which fought its way out of Ottoman suzerainty, is in no hurry to fold itself into Erdoğan's imperial ambitions. Riyadh and Ankara have sought to patch up their differences over the last few years, but it would be bold to claim the Mecca Accord dissolves the structural contradictions between them. As a signal to Tehran and Washington, the Mecca Accord might mean something, but it is not a break in the evolution of the regional security order.

The deeper story is one of enduring Arab weakness and the rise of three non-Arab powers: Israel, Turkey and Iran. Pakistan is not among them. In the 1950s, Pakistan enjoyed real standing in the Middle East, a strong Anglo-American connection, an army of imperial pedigree and commanding geography at the edge of the Persian Gulf. A Pakistan less consumed by India and more attentive to its economy might

have realised the full possibilities of being a security actor in the Middle East. But its reliance on regular Saudi bailouts has made Rawalpindi a retainer and a condottiere rather than a partner.

What about Delhi? Undivided India was the sheet anchor of Persian Gulf security. After 1947, Delhi simply walked away, and for decades treated renunciation as a virtue. The Gulf states, weak on their own, have had no choice but to seek external partners; independent India has remained the big tree that gives no shade. As a result, Delhi became a passive bystander in the Middle East.

The past cannot be undone. What of the present? There is no escaping the essence of Suhrawardy's arithmetic: Regional capabilities have grown over the decades, but so has the complexity of the problems. Regional cooperation remains less than credible, and American salience is not about to disappear.

Instead of wringing its hands over the Mecca Accord, Delhi should expand its own military engagement. Vulnerable states across the Middle East are eager to diversify their defence partnerships and have long looked to a reluctant India. India's military diplomacy in the region has gained some recent traction. But to be a credible security actor, Delhi needs to build the capabilities to project military power into the Middle East, in tandem with deeper political and security partnerships there.

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Someone has to pay for UPI. How do we decide who?



ARYA ROY BARDHAN

UPI was never costless. The MDR is the fee a merchant pays its bank to accept a digital payment, ordinarily 1 to 2 per cent on a card transaction. On UPI, it has been zero, mandated by statute. The infrastructure has always been paid for either by banks, the payment applications, or the government, which reimbursed them for the fee they were required to forgo. That subsidy has been unevenly disbursed over time. The figure oscillates from year to year, and even at its height it met only a fraction of industry's estimated operating costs. The budget has proved to be an unreliable means of keeping UPI free. The amendment is the other half of that predicament: To relieve the exchequer, and to permit a fee in its place.

If large merchants are charged, will they not simply pass the cost to their customers? Economists term this pass-through, and the presumption that firms with market power will transfer the entire burden to consumers holds only under restrictive assumptions. The share of the cost that reaches the final price depends on the elasticity and curvature of demand, and may range from half the cost to more than its whole. A second and subtler concern is what a transaction cost does to the structure of money supply and demand. A charge does not remove UPI from the money supply; UPI merely moves bank deposits, which are already money. The fee alters the ease with which that money is used. A significant part of money's usefulness lies precisely in its trivial transaction cost. Once a cost is introduced, the instrument becomes marginally less money-like, and theory anticipates a modest shift towards the medium that bears no fee: Cash. Throughout the expansion of UPI, cash did not recede. Banknotes in circulation continued to rise, reaching approximately Rs 42 lakh crore in 2026. If free UPI did not displace cash, a small fee would scarcely revive it. The genuine concern is the exposure of low-value payments. Were a fee ever to extend to the transactions of Rs 10 and Rs 20 that constitute the core of UPI's use, the retreat to cash would become likely.

A third concern is that of timing. The Bill has arrived in the midst of trade negotiations with the United States, and the coincidence raises suspicion. The United States Trade Representative's 2026 report does register objections to India's payments regime but not to zero MDR. Its complaints are that American firms cannot compete with RuPay, that they are excluded from credit on UPI, that no single application may exceed 30 per cent of the market, and that payment data must be stored within India.

The infrastructure must be paid for by someone. But by whom, and will that decision be taken openly? Ordinary users and small merchants should be kept free by law, not by assurance. Any fee should be capped low and confined to large merchants. Its proceeds should be ring-fenced for the security and reliability of the UPI system. It should be determined transparently, through the payments authority, and held apart from the trade talks. It should be reviewed periodically as the system matures. None of this requires abandoning the core UPI principle. It only requires that the terms of any charge be fixed in law, deliberated, and justified by the cost of the system.

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40 YEARS AGO

August 12, 1986



PM for twin war on terrorism

THE PRIME Minister, Rajiv Gandhi, said that terrorism could be tackled through political means and by gearing up the police and other law-and-order machinery. Gandhi was asked whether terrorism, which was spreading to other parts of the country, could be resolved politically.

Gen Vaidya cremated

THE MORTAL remains of Gen A S Vaidya were consigned to flames as a galaxy of dignitaries bid an emotion-choked farewell to the former Army chief, who fell to the terrorists' bullets.

Pune bandh marked by arson

ARSON AND stoning were reported from some parts of the city during the bandh called by all political parties and youth organisations to protest against the assassination of Gen A S Vaidya. The city police commissioner, B J Misar, told reporters late in the night that so far 25 cases of arson and stoning had been registered and added that 25 vehicles were damaged in stone-throwing by frenzied mobs in different parts of the city. The police made a cane-charge in the Ganesh Peth area where a mob of about 200 went on a rampage, damaging parked vehicles.

Engine trouble for PM

THE PRIME Minister, Rajiv Gandhi, returned from his foreign tour by a Soviet aircraft after an unscheduled halt at Moscow for six hours where the special Air India Boeing 707 had to land due to a fire alarm in one of the engines. The cockpit received the fire warning an hour-and-a-half after the plane left Prague for Delhi. Engine 3 was shut off and the commander in consultation with the PM brought the plane down at the nearest airport, which was in Moscow. There was no panic inside the aircraft. The plane landed safely at Moscow airport with three of its engines working.



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Caste census is dead. Don't expect a formal announcement or funeral



DESHKAAL
BY YOGENDRA YADAV

THE GOVERNMENT that announced the caste census a year ago has decided to kill it. The same cold political calculus that forced a concession has now prompted a renege on that reluctant promise. Obviously, we should not expect a formal announcement or an official funeral. Instead, the idea will be buried quietly, finely camouflaged under technical verbiage, while the charade of the caste census carries on.

According to the report by Deeptiman Tiwary, first carried in this paper ('No drop-down options, caste census format to be open-ended', *IE*, August 9), the Registrar General of India (RGI), in charge of conducting the census, has decided to use an open-ended question on caste rather than a drop-down menu of castes for the population enumeration phase of the coming census of India. Simply put: When the census enumerator comes to your house, she will not offer you a list of caste names to choose from, but simply ask you to name your caste and record it the way you state it.

Now, what's wrong with that? And how does this seemingly trivial and super-technical decision sound the death knell of the exercise of the caste census?

For this you have to read Trina Vithayathil's authoritative book *Counting Caste: Census Politics, Bureaucratic Deflection, and Brahmanical Power in India*. It is a painstaking documentation of how the caste census was sabotaged in 2011. An intense parliamentary debate led by Sharad Yadav contributed to an all-party consensus in favour of carrying out a caste census. But there was no discussion or even an awareness of how exactly caste was to be recorded in the census. This is where the social power

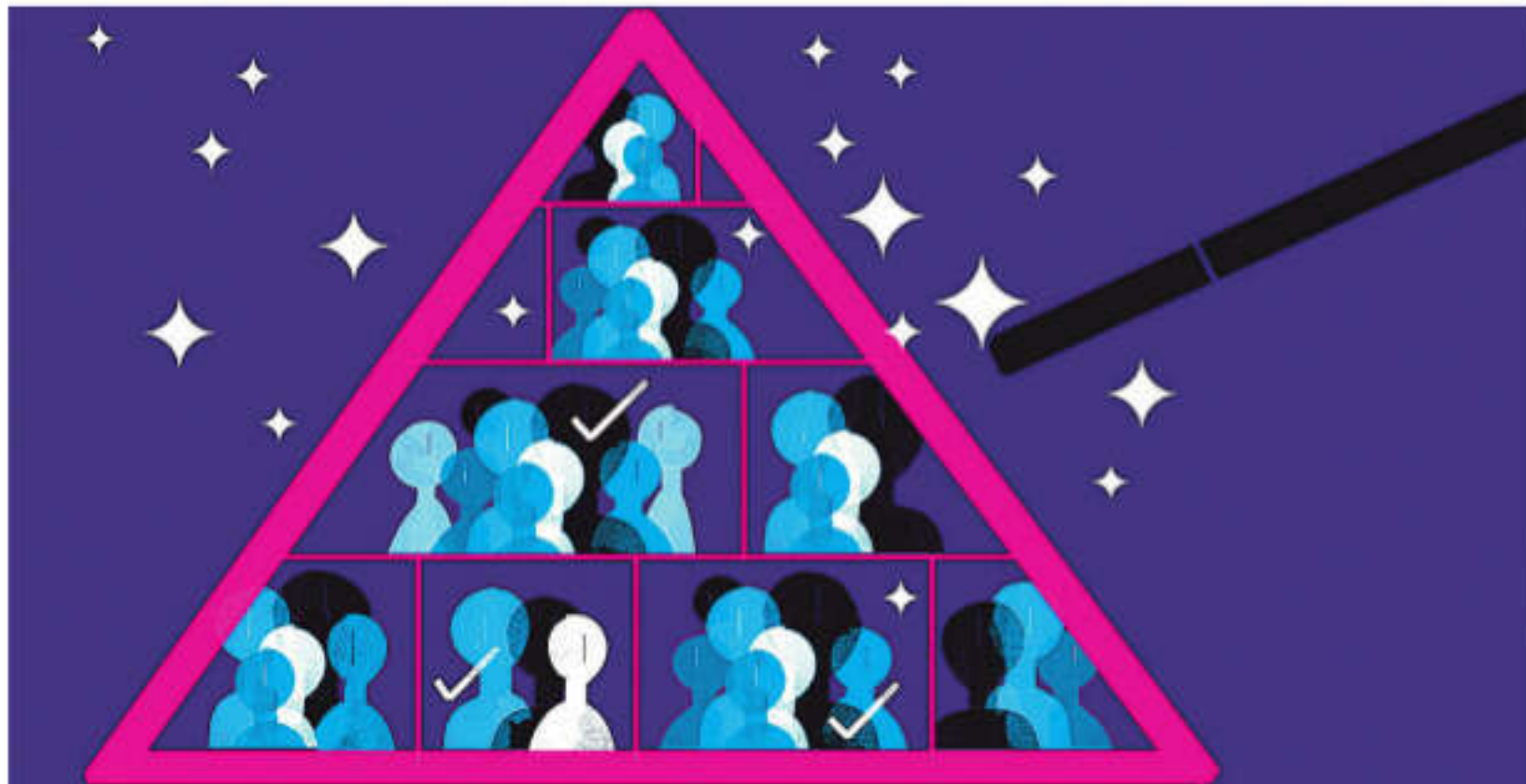


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

of the Brahmanic order asserted itself and deflected the whole enterprise with two critical but managerial and technical decisions. First, caste enumeration was detached from the decennial Census of India, ostensibly not to overburden the census. A separate nationwide survey called the Socio Economic and Caste Census (SECC) was designed for this purpose. Second, caste was recorded through an open-ended question, disregarding the existing SC, ST and OBC lists. This decision and other procedural lapses meant that this huge exercise resulted in 4.7 million caste names, a perfect alibi for first delaying and finally burying the publication of caste data. According to Vithayathil, this was an instance of how Brahmanic power works in India, through bureaucratic deflections.

The Indian Express report suggests that we are about to witness an action replay of the same sabotage, except that this time it will happen not under a separate survey but under the official Census of India 2027. It also confirms that the RGI's office is perfectly aware that this caste census is designed to fail.

Is there an alternative? How do we categorise and classify the infinite variety of castes, sub-castes

Either the BJP has had second thoughts about the caste census, and the possibility of losing its General caste vote bank, especially after the UGC protest and youth rebellion. Or the subterfuge was planned right from the beginning

and their multiple surnames? What is the alternative to asking the people to name their own caste?

Fortunately, there is an alternative. It exists within the official practices of the Indian state. It has been used by the Census of India in the past. It has been successfully used recently in Bihar and Telangana. It is simply this: Instead of asking everyone to name their own caste, begin by asking their caste category (SC/ST/OBC/General) and then ask them to choose from a menu of caste names in their category. The remaining 1 or 2 per cent cases, where the drop-down menu does not work, can be placed under "others" and asked to name their caste.

Do we have a ready-made menu of most Indian caste names? Surprisingly, we do. We already have comprehensive official lists of castes, which includes sub-castes and synonyms, for nearly three-fourths of the Indian population, namely SC, ST and the OBC (officially called Social and Educationally Backward Classes). When the census enumerator goes to a Dalit household, she first asks them if they belong to the SC category. If yes, she then takes out the list of Scheduled Castes and places

them on one of the entries in the official list. The same is the case with STs. This could be easily extended to the OBCs, for which comprehensive lists are available at the state and national levels. (That these two lists do not overlap poses no difficulty for the enumerator, as long as there is no confusion about caste names.)

The remaining one-fourth, the "General" category, are not as difficult to count as it is made out to be. After all, the Census of India 1931 recorded all castes, including those in the General category today. It is safe to assume that not too many new castes would have come up in the last century. Besides, we have a 43-volume encyclopaedia, *People of India* (edited by KS Singh), an official documentation of all castes and communities throughout the country, carried out in the 1980s. That could be used to fine-tune the 1931 list. An open-ended question could be asked to the remaining minuscule population of "others", not to 140 crore Indians.

The real problem is not the technical alternative, but political will, or rather political ill-will. Unlike 2011, when a political decision was sabotaged by bureaucratic deflection, this time it is a clear case of a politically designed sabotage. *The Indian Express* report quotes an unnamed Union minister: "The Opposition has been demanding it for political reasons. We have accepted it. Let them deal with the final data." Clearly, the bureaucratic decision has been taken with political approval, with full knowledge of the failure that awaits this exercise. Now, either the BJP has had second thoughts about the caste census, and the possibility of losing its General caste vote bank, especially after the UGC protest and youth rebellion. Or the subterfuge was planned right from the beginning.

Either way, the political game is clear. The PM can throw up his arms and say to his OBC voters: Look, we tried, but nothing came out of this exercise. And he could wink to his core "upper" caste Hindu vote bank: Don't worry, we've managed it. *Saam bhi margaya, lathi bhi nahin tooti*.

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Ease of doing business needs ease of justice



ARJUN RAM MEGHWAL

INDIA'S JOURNEY towards Viksit Bharat is a reform story that matches the potential as well as the aspirations of "We the People of India". It is not only a story of economic growth, infrastructure and technology. It is equally a journey of institutional reform. As the Indian economy expands, businesses grow, investments increase, and the country strengthens its position in global supply chains, the institutions that support economic activity must also evolve with speed, transparency and credibility. The recently passed Tribunal Reforms Bill, 2026, is an important step in this direction.

The Tribunal Reforms Bill seeks to strengthen the governance architecture of tribunals without altering their substantive jurisdiction. Its central focus is institutional: Improving appointments, governance, transparency, service conditions, independence and efficiency. In that sense, the Bill represents the next stage of a broader reform journey aimed at making India's legal and regulatory ecosystem more modern, predictable and effective.

Over the last decade, under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the nation has witnessed wide-ranging structural reforms. GST transformed indirect taxation; the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code strengthened the insolvency resolution framework; the Jan Vishwas initiative reduced the burden of compliance; Digital India connected governance with technology. The Tribunal Reforms Bill fits naturally into this larger philosophy of "reform, perform and transform".

The importance of tribunal reform becomes evident when viewed against the needs of a modern economy. Tribunals deal with specialised areas such as taxation, company law, securities and the environment. Their purpose is not to replace constitutional courts but to complement the judicial system by providing specialised adjudication and contributing to speedy and effective justice. A dispute in a growing economy is rarely a mere question of accounting or a legal anomaly. Behind it may lie an entrepreneur's confidence, an industry's investment, a business's future, employment opportunities and the continuity of economic activity. When disputes are resolved in a timely and fair manner,

capital can return to productive circulation and confidence in the system is strengthened. Ease of justice and ease of doing business are deeply interconnected.



Articles 323A and 323B of the Constitution laid the foundation for administrative tribunals dealing with service matters and others dealing with specified subjects, recognising the need for specialised mechanisms. Over time, however, the tribunal ecosystem developed across different ministries and departments, leading to variations in practices and multiplicity of procedures. Recognising the need for rationalisation, the Modi government began the process of restructuring tribunals in 2015. The Finance Act, 2017 merged tribunals of a similar nature and reduced their number from 26 to 19, followed by the Tribunal Rules in 2017 and 2020.

Subsequently, the Tribunals Reforms Ordinance, 2021 and the Tribunals Reforms Act, 2021 reduced the number of tribunals from 19 to 16; however, several provisions were struck down by the Supreme Court as contrary to judicial independence and separation of powers. The judicial discourse, including the judgments in *Rojer Mathew*, *Madras Bar Association* and the Supreme Court's judgment of November 19, 2025, consistently emphasised that appointments, tenure and service conditions of tribunal members must uphold judicial independence. It is in this context that the Tribunal Reforms Bill, 2026 has been brought forward.

At the core of the Bill is the proposed National Tribunals Commission (NTC). The NTC will bring 16 tribunals under its umbrella, creating a common framework for their governance and administration. It is proposed to be headed by a former Supreme Court judge or a former chief justice of a high court, supported by two judicial members and two technical members.

The Bill aims to make the appointment process more transparent, structured, merit-based and independent. A dedicated NTC Secretariat is also proposed, supporting the objective of uniform governance. Importantly, the Bill does not change the substantive jurisdiction of individual tribunals. Their jurisdiction will continue to be determined by their respective parent statutes. This distinction is central to understanding the reform.

As India moves towards Viksit Bharat @2047 and accelerates the Reform Express, the spirit of reform must extend to every institution that contributes to national development. Strong institutions inspire confidence; confidence drives investment; investment fuels growth; and effective justice ensures that this virtuous cycle remains anchored in the rule of law. The Tribunal Reforms Bill, 2026 is an important step towards strengthening this cycle. Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mJmZg1

The writer is Union Minister of State (I/C) for Law & Justice and Minister of State for Parliamentary Affairs

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Collective defence

THE CHANGING security environment in the Gulf requires India to pursue a balanced and practical approach ('A pact, divided within, with no single threat', *IE*, August 11). Regional rivalries, military partnerships and external interventions can quickly affect energy supplies and trade routes. India should strengthen diplomatic engagement with all major regional players while avoiding unnecessary alignment with any one camp. Closer cooperation on maritime security, energy security and counter-terrorism would better serve our interests.

M Barathi, Bengaluru

THE EVOLVING security ties among Saudi Arabia, Pakistan and Turkey deserve close attention because developments in West Asia can affect India's energy and strategic interests ('A pact, divided within, with no single threat', *IE*, August 11). India should avoid taking sides in regional rivalries and instead deepen engagement with all concerned countries. Stronger diplomatic channels, maritime cooperation and diversified energy sources can reduce strategic risks. New Delhi should also maintain its longstanding ties with Gulf partners while expanding relations with other regional powers. A steady foreign policy remains the safest course.

K P Muthukumar, Chennai

Revenue model

THE GROWING cost of digital transactions deserves closer policy attention, particularly when small businesses depend heavily on UPI and card payments ('Seamless digital payments have a price', *IE*, August 11). Keeping transactions affordable is important, but payment providers need sustainable revenue models. A transparent incentive framework could reduce the burden on banks without passing costs on to ordinary users. The government should also review interchange charges and encourage competition among payment networks. Digital convenience must remain accessible without weakening the financial system that supports it.

A Myilsami, Coimbatore



KAUSHIK SHAPARIA

AS INDIA enters its 80th year of Independence, it is tempting to look back with pride at how far the country has travelled. But the more important question today is not only how large India has become. It is how relevant India is becoming. India is no longer waiting to be discovered. It is already part of the choices the world is making on trade, technology, talent, energy, supply chains and development. This is the real shift.

We are living through a time when old assumptions are being tested. Countries are rethinking where they source from, where they invest, whom they trust and how they build resilience. The world is not becoming simpler. That is why India's position matters. It has strong relationships with advanced economies but also carries credibility with the Global South. It understands the aspirations of developing countries because it is still living many of them itself. At the same time, it has the ambition, capability and institutional weight to contribute meaningfully to global conversations. That combination is not common.

India is home to more than one-sixth of the world's population but accounts for a much smaller share of global trade. The opportunity now is to bridge that gap. The coming decades will be defined by how effectively India converts demographic scale into economic influence and domestic strength into global leverage.

The idea of Viksit Bharat captures that larger aspiration. It is a

As India enters its ninth decade of Independence, its task is not simply to participate in global growth. It is to help shape it

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statement of intent about the kind of country India wants to become when it completes 100 years of Independence. A bigger economy, certainly. But also, a more capable, confident, inclusive and globally respected one.

To achieve that, capital will matter. India will need investment in infrastructure, manufacturing, clean energy, cities, technology and enterprise. But capital alone is never enough. It must move into the right places, at the right pace, with the confidence that rules are stable and opportunities are real. Countries that can attract long-term capital and put it to productive use will help define the next phase of global growth.

We can already see this in the way India is being viewed by companies and governments looking for new growth corridors. The India-EU Free Trade Agreement is a useful example: Two large democratic partners choosing to deepen economic ties at a time when the global order is being reshaped. For India, it strengthens links with a major advanced market. For Europe, it offers a deeper partnership with a country that is central to Asia's growth and to the wider search for resilient supply chains. Capability is another integral element of the story. India's demographic dividend has long been acknowledged as its biggest strength. However, India's long-term competitiveness will be determined by how effectively it converts its demographic strength

into innovation, enterprise and broad-based prosperity. Today, the gap between average incomes and the incomes of middle-income households suggests that the gains from growth are not reaching all sections of society equally. Creating productive, formal and better-paying jobs must therefore remain a priority, alongside strengthening manufacturing, improving productivity and building globally competitive businesses. As technology and AI reshape industries, success will depend not just on the size of our talent pool, but on the quality of skills, education and healthcare that support it.

India's advantage is that its domestic journey and global role are now deeply connected. The stronger India becomes at home, the more useful it becomes to the world. And the more deeply it engages with the world, the more pathways it opens for its own people.

As India enters its ninth decade of Independence, its task is not simply to participate in global growth. It is to help shape it. The first 80 years were about securing India's place in the world. The years ahead are about defining what India does with that place. That may ultimately be India's most important contribution: Not just becoming one of the world's largest economies but becoming one of its most relevant.

The writer is CEO, Deutsche Bank Group India & Emerging Asia

Stronger India is at home, more useful it is to the world

Citizens, not just daughters in need of forgiveness

placed, and positions the state as a benevolent patriarch dispensing mercy.

Second, the PM's remarks had a deeply paternalistic undertone. By bemoaning "our daughters" speaking such words, he infantilised them, reducing them to "misguided children" who need to be "corrected".

This indicates a larger problem of disregarding women's agency. For instance, whenever men engage in aggressive language during protests, society normalises it as conviction. But when women express themselves similarly, it becomes a debate about morality and "cultural shock". The political grievance becomes invalidated. Their decisions are cast as ill-informed or misguided, and in need of constant policing. This paternalism is everywhere. The most striking illustration of this mindset is in the Hadiya case (2018) where the Kerala

High Court annulled the marriage of a woman on the assumption that she was "weak and vulnerable". It required the Supreme Court to intervene and reinstate her fundamental right to make choices about her own life, religion, and partner.

The same condescension surfaces repeatedly in everyday life. Whenever a woman reports sexual violence, the first questions asked are often about her. It is often her morality that is put on trial before

It is high time women were treated as rights-bearing citizens. Their political and personal agency should not be ignored based on patriarchal norms of civility

any action is taken, and the burden shifts from the criminal to the woman's conduct.

The response to the NEET protestors followed this same script. Thousands of protestors hit the ground asking the government for accountability, but public discourse became about the language some young women and girls used. In fact, the only demonstrable crime that occurred at the protests was when students were assaulted. Young women and minors have since been doxxed, harassed, and vilified.

The right to free speech under Article 19 also includes expression that is impolite, provocative and even offensive, subject only to the reasonable restrictions laid out in Article 19(2). Let's not forget that protest, by its very nature, is born out of frustration at the prevailing system. Citizens cannot be expected to sanitise their anger before they are heard.

We have seen many male politicians use abusive language in the legislative chambers, election rallies, and television debates. It rarely translates into national debate. This double standard highlights political theorist Carole Pateman's argument that the formal citizenship of boys and men counts for more than that of girls and women due to the privileges of patriarchy.

It is high time women were treated as rights-bearing citizens. Their political and personal agency should not be ignored based on patriarchal norms of civility. They do not need forgiveness; they need to be seen and treated as full individuals. Democracies become hollow without equality.

Aribam is a political activist and the author of The Fifteen: The Lives and Times of the Women in India's Constituent Assembly



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• SCIENCE

Milk pouches are difficult to recycle; how new tech turns them into furniture

Arnav Chandrasekhar
Bengaluru, August 11

SEALED POUCHES of milk are some of the most common grocery items in Indian households. But their ubiquity also means thousands of tonnes of plastic waste are generated across the country — one study from 2025 put usage at 100-120 million pouches every day.

A breakthrough at the Indian Institute of Science (IISc), however, could mean that these packets, usually made of polyethylene, could soon find new life as material in the creation of benches and similar goods. This discovery was made by a team from IISc's Department of Materials Engineering. A research paper on the topic was also published in March.

Why were milk packets chosen as a material?

According to IISc's Professor Suryasarathi Bose, part of the team, one of the reasons that milk packets were selected for the study is that they are a form of waste that often ends up in public bins or on roadsides for extended periods of time. Other waste items such as plastic bottles are picked up much faster, as they are more valuable to rag-pickers and others. At the recycling stage as well, dark coloured plastics — often used in milk packets as part of an inner layer to block out ultraviolet and visible light to extend shelf life — are not desired by recycling companies.

Bose said: "They might be ending up in landfills eventually, but there is a longer gestation period on the road-side and in dustbins as they don't get picked up. Oil containers, etc. are picked up by ragpickers... but unless there is a drive, there is no incentive to pick up these packets."

How does the technology work?

During recycling, the polyethylene in these milk packets are combined with recycled components of another material, polypropylene, which is used to contain oil and shampoo, etc. However, as these are not similar at the molecular level, molecules known as "vitrimers" aid in using these two materials to form a new recycled material.

"We thought: why not blend these milk pouches that are weaker in terms of properties, and get a material that is structurally very strong and can be used outdoors. We were able to 3D-print podiums which are used in auditoriums.... One such podium is now given to IISc to test it," said Bose, who is also a founder at VOiLA, a startup specialising in 3D printing recycled waste material. Podiums are not the only thing that can be printed from the new material — other outdoor furniture such as benches can be made as well.

Another material not easily recycled is multi-layer plastic, often used to package chips and snacks. Since they are made of multiple layers, recycling is impractical as it would require the layers to be peeled apart.

One Bengaluru-based company, Unified Intelligence, is using these plastics to create durable building materials — including interior walls at Bengaluru Airport's Terminal 1. These plastics are gathered en masse and cleaned before being shredded. They go through a process called thermofusion to make panels, which can be used to build walls by creating a honeycomb-like structure between them.

The company's managing director Paul Koshy said, "At four inches, it is slightly thinner than a brick wall, but it is multiple times stronger. Even if you hammer it, it will bend and then come back to its own shape."

He said while it was slightly more expensive to use these recycled materials to build a house per square foot, the advantage came in terms of building speed and less water consumption in construction.

One of the challenges companies in this field are facing is that basic standards are laid out for materials like concrete, brick and mortar. Unusual building materials will have to rely on direct lab test certificates demonstrating properties such as fire resistance and mechanical stress.

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGF9mljMzg1

• CULTURE

Indian Spider-Man's origin story: A Satyajit Ray-Stan Lee rumour & Rs-10 comics

Arav Shah
New Delhi, August 11

WITHIN 10 days of its release, *Spider-Man: Brand New Day* has smashed box office records both in India and internationally. It is now the highest-grossing Hollywood movie in India, with a box office collection of over Rs 400 crore and counting.

But the series's links to India go beyond its commercial success. Earlier in 2023, another successful Spider-Man rendition, the animated film *Across the Spider-Verse*, introduced a previously unknown character to global audiences in the form of Pavitr Prabhakar, adapted from the comic issues titled Spider-Man: India.

Spider-Man is a property of the US-based Marvel Comics, but the Indian variant of the wall-crawler was the brainchild of the Indian publisher Gotham Entertainment Group in 2004. Sharad Devarajan, the ex-CEO of Gotham Entertainment and current CEO of Graphic India, told *The Indian Express* that he and fellow creators Jeevan

J Kang and Suresh Seetharaman pitched the concept and illustrations to Marvel.

"Fortunately, the leaders of Marvel's publishing and creative team at the time saw the value and creativity in exploring this... It is one thing to translate existing US comics, but this was one of the first 'trans-creations', where we actually reinvented the origin of a character so that Spider-Man was an Indian boy growing up in Mumbai, dealing with local problems," he said.

A rumour unravelled

For years, a widespread internet rumour said that Ray once travelled to New York to meet with Marvel's Stan Lee.

Apparently, Ray was a huge Spider-Man fan, and the two discussed the possibility of an Indian Peter Parker. Ray walked away, encouraged to conceptualise the character, but nothing ever materialised.

While Devarajan said he had not heard these rumours confirmed, including in his interactions with Marvel Comics executives like Stan Lee, they made the rounds



The Indian Spider-Man. SHARAD DEVARAJAN

after the release of their Spider-Man: India comic. The Indian Spider-Man is directly

linked to Prabhakar and his co-creators, who created the character and his story.

Traditionally, Marvel (behind characters such as The Avengers) and DC Comics (creators of Superman and Batman) have been the two major rivals in the superhero comic genre. Devarajan said he grew up in the US and read both their stories.

"I started Gotham comics with my co-founder, Suresh, first securing the publishing licenses from DC Comics for Superman, Batman and MAD Magazine, and then expanding to take on Marvel's regional publishing rights," Devarajan said. "While there has since been a multiverse of great Spider-Man reimaginings, back in 2004, reimagining an icon like Spider-Man was still a very rare occurrence, and may have been a first of its kind in the industry," he said.

Tapping into Indian market

Before Gotham's establishment in 1997, there weren't too many options for accessing Western comics in the Indian market. A reader could either source limited, im-

ported print copies available at select bookstores or trawl through second-hand stores in the hopes of finding a legible print.

"We launched the first mass market comic editions in English and local languages, affordably priced between Rs 10 and 15, and released millions of issues across the country", Devarajan said. This pricing strategy likely helped prove demand beyond simply offering a wider net for distribution.

A dhoti-wearing Spider-Man

By the early 2000s, Gotham Entertainment had been around long enough to break new ground, and Marvel executives shared that belief with them.

With the creation of an Indian Spider-Man, however, came its own unique set of challenges. Devarajan said, "In the West, Peter Parker is mocked for studying too hard, but in India, it is an admirable trait, so that wouldn't have worked."

The creators instead chose to play on a larger social allegory and made Pavitr Prabhakar a village boy who was in Mumbai on a

scholarship. Feeling out of touch with the fast-paced lifestyle of the city elite, he represents values such as simplicity. "That was reflective of what we saw in 2004, when India's big cities seemed to be moving at light speed while much of rural India felt completely separated", Devarajan said.

Prabhakar's very powers also underwent a cultural shift. Instead of the spider bite that is the source of Peter Parker's transformation, the creators attributed his supernatural awakening to an ancient yogi whom he encounters while running from his bullies.

Another eye-catching detail was the costume. Pavitr Prabhakar is mostly seen sporting a red and blue dhoti, with mojari shoes. "We wanted Indian kids to imagine Spider-Man swinging from the Gateway of India, bouncing off rickshaws, celebrating Diwali with his Aunt Maya," Devarajan said.

Alongside these adaptations, the creators strived to "remain true to the underlying core of Spider-Man epitomised by Stan Lee's saying", Devarajan said. "With great power comes great responsibility."

• AGRICULTURE

Monsoon revived, but why there's cloud over the farm



HARISH DAMODARAN

THE SOUTHWEST monsoon's revival in July, in the face of a strengthening El Niño, has helped considerably narrow the gap in area sown under kharif crops this season relative to last year's coverage.

The Agriculture Ministry's data shows that Indian farmers had planted only 350.85 lakh hectares (lh) area in the current kharif (monsoon) season till July 6, which was 20.8% below the 442.80 lh sown during the same period of 2025.

These acreage gaps were even higher for oilseeds (39.3%), pulses (21.8%) and cotton (23%). A previous Explained column had pointed out that the combined value of India's imports of the three commodities was close to \$25 billion in 2025-26 (April-March) and how El Niño could push this further to a new high in the current fiscal.

The above lag in sowings was due to a poor start to the monsoon season (June-September). Rainfall during June for the country as a whole was 38% below the normal long-period average (LPA) for the month.

June usually witnesses around three low-pressure systems (LPS) that bring rain and are active over 11 days of the month. This June was an anomaly, with not a single LPS being formed. That made it the sixth-driest June in India since 1901. The previous five years to have registered lower June rainfall were 2014, 2009, 1926, 1923 and 1905.

Significantly, the deficient June rainfall was despite El Niño only emerging and being in a weak-to-moderate phase that month.

The July turnaround

In July, El Niño intensified into a moderate-to-strong event.

Yet, this month recorded four LPSs, as against the normal three. And since these systems moved slowly with longer durations, the number of LPS-affected days were about 24 (normal is 14). As a result, all-India rainfall in July was 2.4% above the LPA. This was contrary to the India Meteorological Department's (IMD) forecast of "most likely to be below normal (<94% of LPA)" rains for the month.

The monsoon's turnaround in July and

• KHARIF AREA COVERAGE AS ON AUGUST 10

	2026	2025	% GROWTH
Rice	344.78	360.67	-4.41
Pulses	103.78	105.73	-1.84
(a) Arhar/Tur	37.53	40.14	-6.50
(b) Moong	31.37	33.21	-5.54
(c) Urad	22.86	20.29	12.67
(d) Moth Bean	8.80	8.67	1.50
Coarse Grains	168.50	173.21	-2.72
(a) Maize	87.15	90.63	-3.84
(b) Bajra	62.44	63.00	-0.89
(c) Jowar	12.82	12.61	1.67
(d) Ragi	2.80	3.10	-9.68
(e) Small Millets	3.30	3.88	-14.95
Oilseeds	180.20	175.01	2.97
(a) Soyabean	119.92	119.66	0.22
(b) Groundnut	46.82	43.11	8.61
(c) Sesamum	9.96	8.52	16.90
(d) Sunflower	1.01	0.59	71.19
Cotton	106.01	106.42	-0.39
Sugarcane	58.31	58.62	-0.53
Jute & Mesta	6.34	6.22	1.93
ALL KHARIF CROPS	967.92	985.89	-1.82

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the cumulative rainfall deficit for the season easing to 12% as on August 11, notwithstanding a strengthening El Niño, has spurred kharif sowings. The 96792 lh area covered till August 7 was only 1.8% lower than the progressive acreage during the corresponding period of last year

Moreover, the sowing gap has also reduced to 1.8% in pulses and 0.4% in cotton, while exceeding last year's levels for oilseeds, particularly groundnut and sesame (see accompanying table).

"The rains during the third and fourth weeks of July have boosted sowings and also been *amrit-varsha* (life-rejuvenating) for the already-sown crops that were facing moisture stress. Without these showers, their vegetative growth (development of roots, stems and leaves) would have got affected," said Nitin Kalantri, a leading dal (split pulses) miller from Latur in Maharashtra.

The area sown under soyabean, too, has shown recovery. "Overall, the crop condition is normal to good. Healthy vegetative growth is being observed in most areas, with no major insect pest or disease incidence re-

ported during field inspections," said DN Patthak, executive director of the Indore-based Soybean Processors Association of India.

Delayed effect

El Niño, which increases temperatures and suppresses rain, comes with a lag of 1-2 months and can play out over 5-6 months or more.

•

Even if kharif (monsoon) season is not as bad as feared, the rabi crop (winter-spring) may be affected.

The worst isn't over

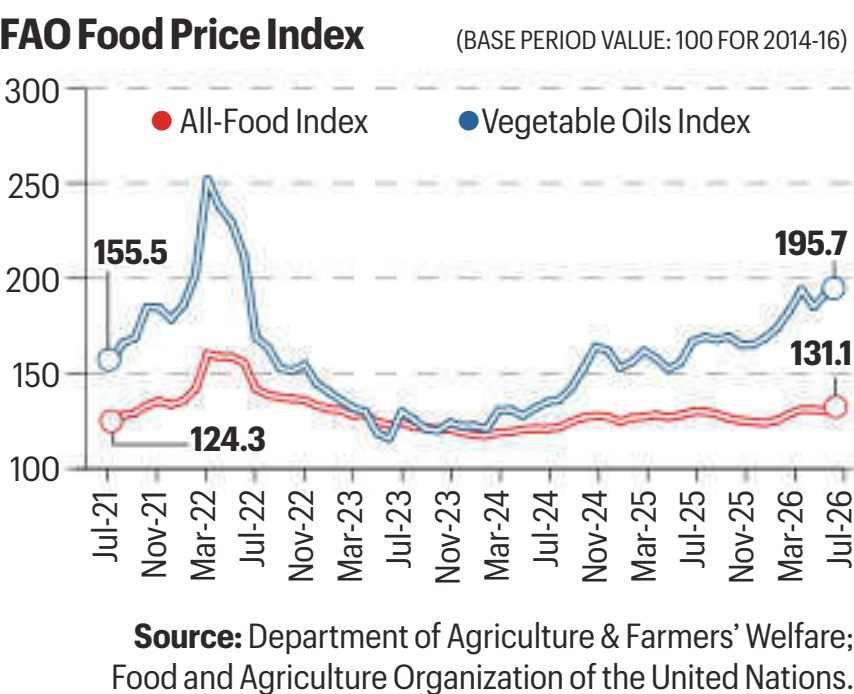
The kharif crops need rain during August and early September too, when they undergo flowering and grain/pod formation that ultimately translate into yields.

The IMD has predicted a fresh LPS to form over the north Bay of Bengal and adjoining West Bengal-Bangladesh coasts around August 12, which should sustain the monsoon's present active phase at least till the third week of the month. The uncertainty is over what happens after that.

Most global weather agencies expect sea surface temperatures in the central and eastern Pacific Ocean off the coasts of Peru and Ecuador to keep climbing, before turning into a "very strong" El Niño during October-December. Further, the El Niño conditions may persist through the winter and spring months till March 2027.

There are two implications from this.

FIRST, El Niño's actual impact on rainfall



• AVIATION

When pilots are tested for drugs: The process & punishment

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, August 11

A SECOND drug test of the pilot-in-command of the Air India Phuket-Delhi flight that fell 300 feet has come back "positive for marijuana", according to sources.

The incident, which left 24 passengers and cabin crew members injured, was initially attributed to severe turbulence. But sources also suggest that the Airbus A320 jet faced some snags in its hydraulic and control systems just before the incident.

The Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AARB) is probing the incident.

According to aviation safety regulator Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA), the global spread of drug abuse and increase in availability of psychoactive substances are serious concerns to aviation safety. Over four years ago, the DGCA established and implemented a stringent protocol for flight crew members — pilots — and other segments of the aviation workforce who test positive for psychoactive substances. The implications in case of a confirmed case of psychoactive substance abuse can range from mandatory rehabilitation — for the first offence — to licence

cancellation in the case of repeated instances of use of banned substances.

Rules governing testing

The DGCA's Civil Aviation Requirement (CAR) on testing aviation personnel for drug consumption was released in September 2021 and took effect on January 31, 2022. While pilots and air traffic controllers are seen as the primary focus segments of these rules, they also extend to the broader range of aviation personnel engaged in safety-sensitive functions, like aircraft maintenance engineers and certifying staff, trainee pilots, and instructors and examiners.

Flight crew and air traffic controllers are the only groups where a 10% annual random test is strictly mandated, while other groups are required to be tested at the time of hiring or after specific incidents. Apart from the routine random testing, these tests are also usually done after a safety-related incident, as is the case with the Air India Phuket-Delhi flight of August 4.

Airlines and other organisations like flying schools, maintenance and repair organisations and air navigation services providers are also encouraged to extend the random testing to other segments of their workforce.

Tests a must

- The DGCA treats refusal to undergo testing as severely as a positive result. Upon initial refusal, the employee is removed from duty and must clear a drug test within 48 hours.
- On failure to do so, their licence is suspended for a year, & they must undergo rehabilitation before returning to duty.
- In case a person refuses the test the second time, or tests positive after the first refusal, licence will be suspended for three years. A subsequent violation shall lead to cancellation of licence.

The testing protocol

The urine sample of the pilot or any other employee on whom the test is being conducted is to be split and stored in two containers. The testing process begins with a immediate screening test on the sample in the first container. If this initial test is 'non-negative', which means it is indicative of the presence of psychoactive substances, the pilot is immediately taken off flying duty, pending the results of a confirmatory test.

The Air India pilot's screening test was indeed 'non-negative'.

The sample in the second container is then sent for the confirmatory test at a laboratory using complex instruments. "In case sample A is non-negative, then sample B with signatures of the sample collector, employee (donor) and medical personnel of the concerned Organization shall be forwarded to the appropriate laboratory for Confirmatory Test," the CAR says.

In case the confirmatory test is found positive — as it has been in the current case — the medical in-charge of the organisation concerned is required to consult a medical review officer (MRO) to determine if the positive result was due to a legitimate therapeutic treatment or some innocuous

source, and not drug abuse. For instance, pain relief medication containing codeine may trigger a positive result for opiates.

According to an advisory issued by pilot body Airline Pilots' Association of India (ALPA India), pilots should not self-medicate as common cold, cough, allergy and sleep-aid formulations sold across pharmacies may contain ingredients from the tested classes of psychoactive substances.

What if drug use is confirmed

If the MRO confirms the result is a case of drug use, an escalating ladder of disciplinary actions comes into the picture.

If it is the first occasion of a positive drug test, the employee is referred by his or her organisation to a specialist doctor, counselor, or de-addiction centre for a rehabilitation programme. To return to active duty, the employee must undergo new testing, receive a negative report and obtain a fitness certificate from the organisation's medical in-charge.

If the employee who returned to duty after a first offence is found positive again, his or her licence is suspended for three years. A third positive test result leads to the cancellation of the person's license.

'SECURITY-RELATED INFRA COST FOR UPI IS 10-20 PAISA/TRANSACTION'

As AI threat loomed, UPI players flagged rising security costs

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, August 11

COMPANIES OPERATING UPI platforms are learnt to have told the government in private meetings that the cost of securing the payments network is rising sharply, with emerging artificial intelligence (AI) systems adding a new layer of risk to fraud prevention and cybersecurity.

The firms are understood to have specifically flagged threats posed by Anthropic's Mythos Preview, arguing that defending payment systems against increasingly capable AI tools will require greater investment, a concern they have cited as part of their broader pitch for allowing a merchant discount rate (MDR) on UPI transactions.

Industry insiders estimate that the total spends on security-related inputs account for over 20% of the total costs of running a UPI platform annually, which could rise sharply in deploying cutting-edge security software to prevent risks posed by AI systems like Mythos.

Securing UPI platforms

"Many of the UPI ecosystem participants have flagged to us that due to risks linked to systems like the Mythos Preview, which most Indian entities do not yet have access to, there is going to be an exceeding investment towards securing UPI platforms," a senior government official said.

Earlier this year, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman had held a high-level meeting with stakeholders from the financial sector, to assess the risks posed by Mythos over concerns that the system's capabilities could pose significant risks to India's banking sector.

Anthropic's Mythos Preview



Industry insiders estimate security-related inputs account for over 20% of annual UPI platform costs.

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RG9mIjMzg1 them, and in hiring talented engineers, among other things.

"We were in conversation with a major technology company that runs payments in India and also has access to Mythos Preview, and even they had their fair bit of concerns about what the system was capable of," he said on condition of anonymity, and without revealing the name of the company. To be sure, Google, which runs a UPI platform in India, has access to Mythos Preview, under Anthropic's Project Glasswing.

The founder also said that the security-related infrastructure cost for UPI is about 10-20 paisa per transaction, with investments needed in deploying AI tools, security software, and cloud services that are typically not made in India, and therefore have to be paid for in dollars.

"And this cost doesn't come down even as you scale, because the volume of transactions keeps getting bigger, and new threats keep emerging," he said.

Queries sent to the Payments Council of India, and companies that operate UPI platforms remained unanswered until press time. **FULL REPORT ON** [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](http://www.indianexpress.com)

Net equity MF inflows in July fall 15%, large-caps see outflows after 31 months

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, August 11

LARGE-CAP schemes saw monthly outflows for the first time since December 2023 as net inflows into equity mutual funds fell 15% month-on-month in July, according to data released by the Association of Mutual Funds in India (AMFI).

This came as foreign investors, who heavily invest in large caps, returned to Indian stocks after four months in July, likely allowing other investors to book profits after an improved month for the Indian stock market, according to Chief Executive Venkat N Chalasani.

Equity flows moderate

Overall inflows into equity-oriented mutual funds fell to Rs 24,697 crore in July, with large-cap funds seeing an outflow of Rs 1,322 crore. Mid-cap, small-cap, and multi-cap schemes saw inflows increase from the previous month as these sections of

the market outperformed the overall market in July.

For context, the Nifty 50 gained around 2.2% in July, which was its best monthly performance since April.

Broader markets outperformed, with the Nifty Small-cap and Nifty Mid-cap indices gaining around 2% during the month. Fewer negative shocks from West Asia, revival of foreign inflows during the month, and better-than-expected corporate earnings in the April-June quarter helped markets score better.

"Large-cap stocks have moved to reasonable valuations but are saturated at the moment in terms of growth potential. At a time when investors are hand-picking growth-oriented stocks, we are seeing the blue chips see less interest, while money pours into mid- and small caps," an investment head at a domestic fund house said.

Ankur Punj, the MD and business head at Equirus

ON FIRM FOOTING

MID-CAP, small-cap, and multi-cap schemes saw inflows rise from the previous month as these sections of the market outperformed the overall market in July

THE CONTRIBUTIONS from systematic investment plans (SIPs) remained robust, above the Rs 30,000-crore level for the fifth consecutive month with inflows of Rs 31,961 crore in July, higher than the Rs 31,781 crore in June.

FLOWS INTO exchange-traded funds (ETF) fell 34% in July after inching up last month. Flows into gold ETFs fell 55%

Wealth, also echoed a similar view. "The trend (of fall in equity MF inflow) also highlights ongoing portfolio rebalancing amid evolving valuations, with investors favouring segments that offer stronger

long-term return potential while remaining mindful of associated risks," he said.

The contributions from systematic investment plans (SIPs) remained robust, remaining above the Rs 30,000-crore level for the 5th consecutive month with inflows of Rs 31,961 crore in July, higher than the Rs 31,781 crore in June.

Some sections of the market are cautious on equity funds due to the heavy dependence on the retail segment and lower returns in recent times.

"While flow is positive largely through the 30k crore strong SIPs, we feel there is a cautious stance on equity-oriented MFs given lower returns over the past 2-year period. We also believe flows to some extent moving towards SIF's (special investment funds) and arbitrage products which are to be low risk and absolute returns," according to Akhil Chaturvedi, executive director and chief business of-

ficer at Motilal Oswal Asset Management Company.

Data from AMFI shows flexi-cap equity funds, which comprise stocks from every section of the equity market, have provided an average return of around 12% over the last five years.

In comparison, many multi-asset hybrid funds have delivered returns of 15-22% over the last three years, rewarding investors who have diversified into other asset classes.

Flows into exchange-traded funds (ETF) fell nearly 34% to Rs 11,071 crore in July after inching up last month. Flows into gold ETFs fell nearly 55%. However, flows into index funds turned positive to Rs 1,537 crore, compared to an outflow of 58 crore last month.

Flows into debt schemes turned positive at Rs 1.88 lakh crore in July compared to outflows of Rs 10.91 lakh crore a month ago. **FULL REPORT ON** [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](http://www.indianexpress.com)

RBI, BRICS in talks to link payment systems, CBDCs: Governor

George Mathew
Mumbai, August 11

RESERVE BANK of India (RBI) Governor Sanjay Malhotra on Tuesday said the RBI was working to increase the use of the rupee in cross-border trade and payments, and it was also discussing ways with BRICS countries to make international transactions faster and cheaper.

Cross-border payments and the use of local currencies for international trade were closely linked to the broader effort to internationalise domestic currency, he said.

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

rencies, including the rupee, Malhotra said while speaking at a FICCI-Indian Banks Association (IBA) event.

"We have a task force on payments under BRICS," Malhotra said, adding that cross-border payments remained an area of interest for member countries because of the scope to reduce costs, particularly for retail transactions, and improve transaction speeds.

He cited Unified Payments Interface (UPI) as an example of how payments can be made almost instantaneously. "Look at

UPI, for example. It is instantaneous. You have to wait for some hours, some days for your foreign remittances to take place. So, there is a lot of work that is being done over there," he said. The governor said several options were being discussed to improve cross-border payments, including linking payment systems of different countries and the possible use of central bank digital currencies (CBDCs). However, these proposals were still at the discussion stage.

The RBI is also seeking to in-

crease the use of local currencies in international trade.

Malhotra said India already had arrangements with a number of countries to facilitate trade in local currencies, although the volumes remained relatively small. "We need to expand that," he said. As part of this effort, the RBI has started entering into memoranda of understanding with central banks of other countries to create greater awareness among importers and exporters about the benefits and mechanisms for using local currencies in in-

ternational trade. The RBI has so far signed such arrangements with the UAE, Mauritius, the Maldives and Indonesia, Malhotra said. "They have given us encouraging results and we will continue our efforts to internationalise the rupee and promote the use of local currencies for cross-border payments and for trade," he said. The push comes as central banks globally explore alternatives to traditional correspondent banking arrangements.

FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](http://www.indianexpress.com)

India's top 500 listed companies have just 9 women CEOs & 25 MDs

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, August 11

TOP 500 listed companies in India have just nine women chief executive officers (CEOs) and 25 women managing directors (MDs), according to the data tabled by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs in Lok Sabha.

The data revealed that there are 67 women executive directors (whole-time directors) and 22 women chief financial officers in these top 500 companies categorised based on their turnover.

The government's response

came on Monday, in reply to questions raised by rebel Trinamool Congress MP Sayani Gosh, who asked whether the government has assessed the representation of women in senior corporate leadership and the major barriers affecting their progression.

The ministry said that assessment on barriers to progression of women directors has not been done.

The corporate affairs ministry data further shows that there are a total of 638 independent directors and overall 860 directors or board members in

the top 500 listed companies in India. The directors include additional directors (18), directors (738), managing directors (25), nominee directors (12) and whole time directors (67).

If we look at women's participation across all companies, the data shows that 11.60 lakh women directors are associated with active companies, out of a total of 39.99 lakh directors.

There are a total of 21.39 lakh companies and 5.06 lakh LLPs are currently active across the country.

FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](http://www.indianexpress.com)

BRIEFLY

Govt extends PM E-DRIVE scheme timeline

New Delhi: The Centre has extended the PM Electric Drive Revolution in Innovative Vehicle Enhancement (PM E-DRIVE) Scheme for electric two-wheelers till March 31, 2028, and the incentives for the segment have been halved to Rs 2,500 per kWh from Rs 5,000 per kWh earlier. The Ministry of Heavy Industries said registered electric two-wheelers can avail an incentive of Rs 2,500 per kWh, capped at Rs 5,000 per vehicle, for the period between April 1, 2025, and March 31, 2028. PTI

Vijay Singh steps down from Sir Ratan Tata Trust

New Delhi: Tata Trusts vice-chairman Vijay Singh has stepped down as a trustee of Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT) and has decided not to seek a renewal when his current term expires on August 14, people familiar with the matter said. Singh will continue as a trustee of the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT). The development comes amid differences among SRTT trustees, with the trust barred by the Maharashtra State Charity Commissioner from holding meetings of its board pending an inquiry. PTI

MARKETS

			
Sensex	NIFTY	Gold	US Dollar
78,154.25	24,471.70	₹1,52,803	₹95.44
-388.19	-112.10		
-0.49%	-0.46%	Silver	Oil
		₹2,35,352	\$87.07

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA
GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF AUGUST 7, 2026

KONKAN RAILWAY CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of India Undertaking)
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE (Two Packet System)
Konkan Railway Corporation Ltd. invites "Open e-Tender" in "Two Packet System" from experienced agencies for "Gantry Operation, Inspection & Maintenance of Chenab Railway Bridge (Br. No. 225) in connection with Integrated Maintenance Project of Katra (excluding) -Banihal (excluding) section of Udhampur-Srinagar-Baramulla Rail Link Project, Jammu & Kashmir"
Tender Notice No.: KR-PD-JK-CHENAB-IM-3-2026, dated 10.08.2026. Approx. Cost of the work: Rs. 12.05Cr (excluding GST), Cost of Tender Form: Nil. Bid Security: Rs. 24,10,100/- to be submitted through payment modes as mentioned in Tender document. Completion period of Contract: 24 Months. Submission of Tender: 07.09.2026 up to 15.00 hrs. Opening of Tender: 07.09.2026 at 15.30 hrs. For further details and updates please visit <https://www.ireps.gov.in> Amendments/Corrigendum, if any, would be hosted on the above website only.

CONCOR INVITES e-Tender in Two Packet System of tendering for the following work-
Tender No.: CON/AREA-II/ENG/MCC/Chandri/E-89598/2026-27
Name of Work: Construction of Warehouse, Building Works, External Electrical Works, Fire Fighting Works and Allied works in connection with Development of Multi Modal Cargo Terminal at Chandri (Gujarat) (Package-II)
Estimated Cost: ₹ 3481.39 Lakhs (including GST)
Completion Period: 12 (Twelve) Months
Earnest Money Deposit: ₹ 69.62,800/- (Rs. Sixty-nine Lakhs Sixty-two Thousand Eight Hundred only)
Cost of Tender Document: NIL
Tender Processing Fee (Non-refundable): ₹ 3540 (inclusive all taxes & duties through e-payment)
Date of sale of Tender (online): 12.08.2026 (15.00 hrs) to 02.09.2026 (upto 17:00 hrs)
Date & Time of submission of Tender (online): 04.09.2026 (upto 17:00 hrs.)
Date & Time of Opening of Tender (online): 07.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
For financial eligibility criteria, experience with respect to similar nature of work, etc, please refer to detailed tender notice available on website www.concorindia.co.in, but the complete tender document can be downloaded from website www.tenderwizcard.com/CCIL only. Further, Corrigendum / Addendum to this Tender, if any, will be published on website www.concorindia.co.in or www.tenderwizcard.com/CCIL and Central Procurement Portal (CPP) only. Newspaper press advertisement shall not be issued for the same.
Group General Manager (Projects), Phone No.: 011-41222500

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER,
PUBLIC HEALTH CIRCLE, SAMBALPUR, ODISHA
e-mail id:- sephsbp@gmail.com
NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH e-Procurement
Bid Identification No. ACEPHSBP-02/2026-27 Dt. 06.08.2026

01	Number of Work	:	01 no
02	Type of Bid	:	Two Bid system
03	Estimated Cost	:	Rs. 652.30 lakh
04	Period of Completion	:	12 (twelve) Calendar Months
05	Class of Contractor	:	'A' & 'Special' Class
06	Date & Time of availability of bid document in the portal	:	From 11.00 Hrs. of Dt. 14.08.2026 to 17.00 Hrs of 28.08.2026
07	Last date/time of seeking clarification	:	17.00 Hrs of 19.08.2026
08	Last date/time of receipt of bids in the portal	:	17.00 Hrs of 28.08.2026
09	Date & Time of opening of Technical bids	:	At 11.30 Hrs. of 29.08.2026
10	Name and Address of the Officer Inviting Bid	:	Additional Chief Engineer, P.H. Circle, Sambalpur, Brooks' Hill, Near Stadium, At/Po- Motijharan, Dist- Sambalpur-768 001.

Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement portal "<http://www.tendersorissa.gov.in>"

Sd/-
Additional Chief Engineer
P.H. Circle, Sambalpur.

OIPR-13001/13018/1/2627/0002

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA – DEPARTMENT OF SPACE CONSTRUCTION & MAINTENANCE GROUP, SDSC – SHAR SRIHARIKOTA – 524124
Brief E-TENDER NOTICE
e-Tender Notice No.CMG/C/CON/268716
On behalf of President of India, EPC tenders are invited through e-tendering for the following works:

Brief Name of work	Est. Value (Rs)
Planning, Design, Construction and Commissioning of Crew Isolation and Gaganyatri Nivas facility at SDSC SHAR Sriharikota, Tirupati District of Andhra Pradesh (Civil, PH, Road, Site Development, Swimming pool, Landscape, Electrical, AC, and allied works in EPC MODE-II).	2602 Lakhs

Last date for sale (Tender documents can be downloaded) upto **02/09/2026 14:30 hrs.** For eligibility criteria and other details, interested tenderers may please refer to the detailed bilingual (Hindi-English) Notice Inviting Tenders (NIT) on the website <https://www.isro.gov.in/Tenders.html> and tender free view at <https://www.tenderwizcard.com/isro>
Sd/- GROUP HEAD, CMG/ SDSC SHAR

JAMNAGAR UTILITIES & POWER PRIVATE LIMITED
Registered Office: CPP Control Room, Village Padana, Taluka Lalpur, District Jamnagar - 361 280, Gujarat
Phone: 022-35557700 • Email: debtentureinvestors@jupl.co.in
Website: www.jupl.co.in • CIN: U45100GJ1991PTC051130
EXTRACT OF UNAUDITED STANDALONE FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30TH JUNE 2026
(Rs. in crore, except per share data and ratios)

Sr. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended		Year Ended
		30 Jun '26	30 Jun '25	
		Unaudited	Unaudited	Audited
1	Total Income from Operations	1,175.04	1,137.72	4,604.27
2	Net Profit before Exceptional Item and Tax	478.51	616.20	297.39
3	Net Profit before Tax (after Exceptional Item)	478.51	616.20	835.68
4	Net Profit after Tax	274.96	489.23	282.73
5	Total Comprehensive Income [Comprising Profit (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (OCI) (after tax)]	8,033.08	1,680.85	809.82
6	Paid up Equity Share Capital	2,720.69	2,720.69	2,720.69
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)			25,400.07
8	Securities Premium Account			-
9	Net worth	29,107.15	27,608.49	28,257.43
10	Paid up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt	12,281.82	16,436.56	13,073.55
11	Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares		5,000.00	-
12	Debt Equity Ratio	0.42	0.58	0.48
13	Earnings Per Share (EPS) for the period / year - Class 'B' Equity Shares of face value of Re. 1 each - Basic and Diluted (in Rupees) - After Exceptional Item	0.10	0.17	0.10
	- Basic and Diluted (in Rupees) - Before Exceptional Item	0.10	0.17	(0.09)
14	Capital Redemption Reserve	5,000.00		5,000.00
15	Debtenture Redemption Reserve	935.00	935.00	935.00
16	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	3.04	2.64	0.29
17	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	3.04	2.64	1.18

Notes:

- The above is an extract of the detailed format of the Unaudited Standalone Financial Results for the quarter ended 30th June 2026 filed with the Stock Exchange under Regulation 52 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Unaudited Standalone Financial Results for the quarter ended 30th June 2026 are available on the website of BSE Limited (www.bseindia.com) and can be accessed on the Company's website (www.jupl.co.in).
- For the other line items referred in Regulation 52(4) of Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, the pertinent disclosures have been made to BSE Limited (www.bseindia.com) and can be accessed on the Company's website (www.jupl.co.in).
- The Audit Committee has reviewed, and the Board of Directors has approved the above results and its release at their respective meetings held on 11th August 2026. The statutory auditors have carried out a limited review on the aforesaid results.

For Jamnagar Utilities & Power Private Limited
Sd/-
Satan Parkhi
Chairman
DIN - 00094660

Date : 11th August 2026
Place : Mumbai

NAVI MUMBAI INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT
NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST FOR CONSTRUCTION OF PROPOSED GA HANGAR – NO 3 AT NAVI MUMBAI INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT
Navi Mumbai International Airport Limited ("NMIAL") has been granted the right to develop, operate and maintain the Navi Mumbai International Airport ("NMIA") on DBFOT basis. NMIAL proposes to undertake the construction of the proposed general aviation (GA) Hangar's.
The scope of works includes, but not limited to, the engineering, supply, fabrication, erection & installation, integration, interfacing, testing, commissioning, obtaining all requisite statutory approvals / licenses, warranty support, rectification of defects, obligations during Warranty Period/ defect rectification period, of the proposed GA Hangar's at NMIA.
NMIAL invites responses to the Expression of Interest ("EOI") from qualified, experienced and reputed contractors for above mentioned Works for NMIA.
Interested applicants may download and submit their response to the EOI by registering on the NMIAL e-portal: <https://nmiaairport.abcpbcore.com>
For further details and instructions, please visit the E-tenders section: www.nmiaairport.co.in
The deadline for submission of the response to EOI is 17th August 2026, 17:00 hrs IST.
Note: NMIAL reserves the right to reject any response to EOI or change / cancel the tender process at any time without prior notice or without assigning any reason whatsoever.
NAVI MUMBAI INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT LTD.
Email: nmia.tenders@adani.com
Website: www.nmiaairport.co.in

The Big Picture

WEDNESDAY, AUGUST 12, 2026

15

The Indus Code

THE RACE TO CRACK A 4,000-YEAR-OLD SCRIPT

AI experts, computer scientists, a 17-year-old in Washington DC — a new generation of enthusiasts is attempting to unlock a secret code: what does the Indus script tell us about one of the world's oldest civilisations?

ADRIJA ROYCHOWDHURY on the many impulses and ambitions fuelling the quest. The promise of a \$1 mn prize helps

THE VICTORY claims were audacious, even amusing. "I've created a powerful algorithm and it is operating at 99.1%... Let this email message serve as my claim to the prize for translating the Indus Valley Script," read one of the many messages that flooded Rajesh P N Rao's email in the months after the Tamil Nadu government's January 2025 announcement of a \$1 million reward for anyone who deciphered the Indus script.

With no mechanism in place yet for claimants to register their 'discovery', many have been writing to Rao, a Seattle-based computer scientist who is arguably among the most public faces in a race to solve one of mankind's most enduring mysteries — decoding the Indus Valley script.

"The first two months were intense. I must have received 200 emails, claiming all kinds of fascinating and delusive decipherments of the script," says the 56-year-old Rao, who has been trying to decode the script for two decades.

Among those who wrote to Rao were a mother-daughter duo in South America, who argued that the Indus script shared a common origin with the writing system of an indigenous Latin American community. Another claimed the signs represented a celestial "address" — a coordinate-based naming system rooted in the astronomical traditions of the third millennium BCE. Others ventured even further into the improbable, proposing that the script encoded altered states of consciousness or mystical knowledge.

A century-old pursuit to decode

Since the announcement of the discovery of the 4,000-year-old Indus Civilisation in 1924, the script has remained one of history's greatest uncracked codes, inspiring generations of linguists, archaeologists, computer scientists and enthusiastic amateurs.

Then in January 2025, when Tamil Nadu announced the \$1 million prize for decoding the script, the interest got renewed. The announcement followed a study by the state's Archaeology Department that claimed similarities between signs on Indus artefacts and graffiti marks recently unearthed at archaeological sites in the state, bringing the century-old puzzle back into academic and political debates. With that, the code crackers went back to work.

The interest in the script has evolved over the course of the century. On the one hand are those such as Finnish Indologist Asko Parpola and Canadian epigrapher Bryan Wells, who have dedicated their lives and careers to decoding the script; on the other are those who have recently turned to artificial intelligence to crack the problem that has eluded human effort for so long.

Archaeologist Pallavee Gokhale, who has been studying Indus artefacts and the scholarship around the script, says that when the script was first discovered in 1924, decipherment efforts drew heavily on prevailing archaeological theories. "As the Aryan migration theory gained prominence, those working on the script became increasingly interested in identifying the language of what they considered the indigenous people of India," Gokhale says.

She believes that unlike many other problems of ancient history, the Indus script is in the form of data that is conducive to computing and statistical models. "Today, with AI, machine learning and data science at the forefront, many believe these technologies can finally help solve the problem," says Gokhale.

Sundar Ganesan, director of the Chennai-based Roja Muthiah Research Library, which hosts the Indus Research Centre that's backed by the Tamil Nadu government, says, "We have received at least 60 decipherment claims in the last year and a half, and we tell them to approach the government since we do not have any locus standi on this yet," he says.

Code crackers at work

Long before AI became the buzzword that it is today, Rao had in the early 2000s turned to computational methods to

understand the corpus of symbols that would throw light on "who we are as Indians, and who our ancestors were".

A school-time fascination with the Indus Civilisation stayed with him even as he pursued his undergraduate study in engineering in the US and went on to do his doctorate in computer science from the University of Rochester.

Later, during a visit to India, he got to know that a group of scientists at the Tata Institute of Fundamental Research (TIFR) in Mumbai was trying to decipher the Indus script using tools such as statistical analysis, machine learning, and information theory — methods that would be alien to historians, but were most familiar to him. For Rao, it was the best opportunity to use his expertise in unraveling the world of ancient India, one that had had him hooked since he was a child.

Among the team working at TIFR was Nisha Yadav. She studied Physics and Computer Science, and was part of a research group at TIFR that was studying astronomy in ancient India, when she stumbled upon the various theories about the Harappan script. And then, much like Rao, a fascination that had stayed in the recess of her mind since Class 5 became a full-blown obsession.

"These theories about the script lacked an objective approach," she says in an interview to *The Indian Express*. Computers, she believed, could interpret the script, without giving in to human biases.

Yadav and her colleague Mayank Vahiya decided that instead of finding meanings in the signs, it might be better to find patterns and sequences. "The idea was to find out what is the probability of a particular sign following or preceding another sign," says Yadav, who is now Science Communication & Publication Officer at TIFR.

Later, a few other independent researchers, including Rao, Hrishikesh Joglekar, and Ronojoy Adhikari, joined the TIFR team to take the project ahead.

Once the computer had identified the statistical patterns in the sequence of Indus signs, the researchers compared these patterns with those found in known languages, including Sanskrit, Tamil and several tribal languages, as well as in non-linguistic systems such as DNA sequences and Western classical music. They found that the statistical structure of the script more closely resembled that of natural languages than non-linguistic sequences, suggesting that it likely encoded language, even if the language itself remains unknown.

"We can write in the Indus script, but we cannot read it," Yadav explains.

Sometime in 2014, Bengaluru-based computer scientist Bahata Ansumali Mukhopadhyay met Adhikari, who was part of the TIFR team. Mukhopadhyay was then desperately looking to find an intellectual cure to her corporate boredom. The Indus script was the perfect outlet.

"There is a romance in solving a problem from ancient history," she says.

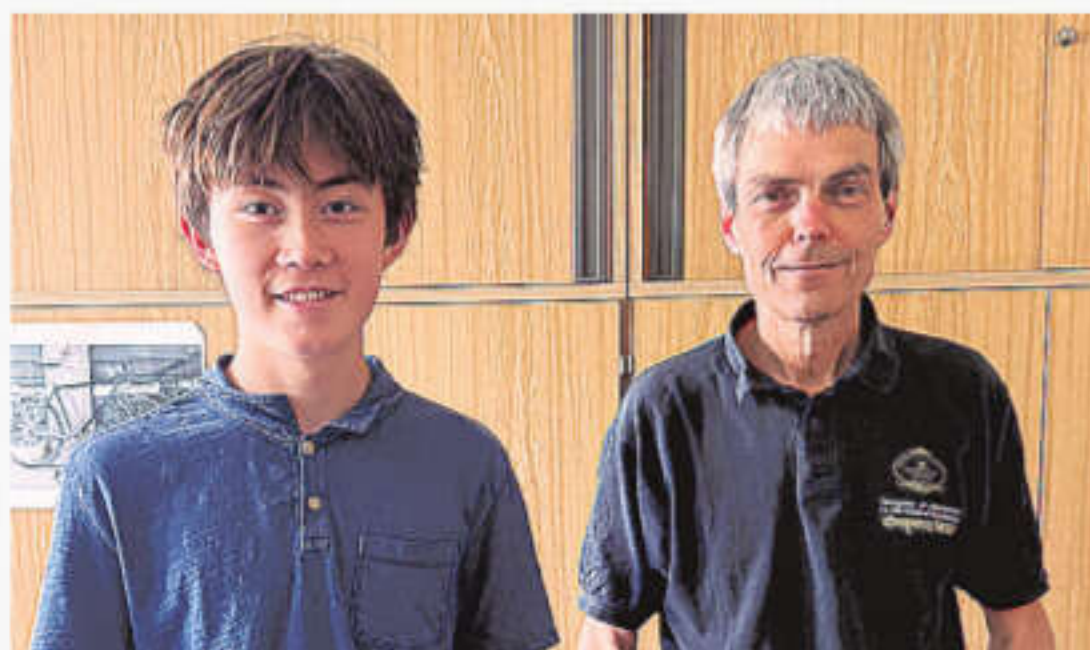
While continuing with her day job, she immersed herself in the world of Indus signs — in the process, losing out on sleep and social life, and even postponing key medical treatments. Mukhopadhyay used skills and tools from archaeology, phonetics, linguistics, and mathematics and statistics, as and when whatever was required. "I had the right questions, and I did whatever I needed to prove the answers," says Mukhopadhyay, who recently concluded that the script does not phonetically spell words of any language.

While Mukhopadhyay's conclusion has been published in multiple scientific journals, she has not bothered to find out about the process to claim the prize money. She is, however, glad that the announcement has made many more people aware of the script.

The youngest among the decipherers is 17-year-old Louie Merriam, a high-schooler based in Washington DC who grew up alongside a lot of "desi" friends, and is fond of watching Bollywood movies. He found himself drawn towards Indian culture and history and consequently found a passion project in the Indus script. He says, "As a student, I have time and can spend time on leisurely activities like the Indus script."

Currently, he is assisting Rao in the decipherment project. "We are using AI to investigate how each sign behaves — whether it is a noun or verb, for example," Merriam explains.

He concedes that AI could be influenced by the human biases fed into it, but he tries



(Clockwise from top) Louie Merriam, 17, with geodesist Andreas Fuls; Canadian epigrapher Bryan Wells; Nisha Yadav of TIFR; Seattle-based Rajesh P N Rao; computer scientist Bahata Ansumali Mukhopadhyay
Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

• MAIN CHALLENGES

- No comparable inscription has yet been found. For instance, when British orientalist James Prinsep deciphered Brahmi in the 1830s, he did so by comparing its inscriptions to bilingual coins with Greek and Indian scripts
- Phonetic values to signs can't be assigned without knowing the language.
- There is limited textual evidence — inscriptions are short, averaging five signs — and with a lot unknown about the civilisation still, there is little material to analyse

to make the program as blind as possible. "I don't discuss much about the script with AI. Instead, I just provide it with the data I have collected and ask it to point out the statistical patterns and anomalies," he says.

Merriam says the announcement of the million-dollar prize had prompted many of his friends in the US to embark on deciphering the script. He says most of them were first- and second-generation Indian migrants who are adept at computers and STEM subjects, but have "very little interest" in their own history. "After a few excited hours, they quickly realised that the script was hard work, and moved on," he says.

Merriam stuck on. "I would much rather use my computer science skills on the Indus script, than on finance spreadsheets."

A lifetime of solving a script

Quantitative and statistical methods, it seems, guided even an earlier generation of scholars.

Many first encountered the script while working on other ancient writing systems, only to end up dedicating their entire lives to the study of Bronze Age India.

Such was the case with Bryan Wells, a 75-year-old Canadian epigrapher who first encountered the Indus script in 1988 while working on Maya hieroglyphs as an undergraduate student of archaeology at the University of Calgary. The ancient script of the Mayan civilisation in Latin America, however, was overcrowded with researchers, prompting Wells to turn towards the ancient Indian script instead.

There was very little work done on the Indus script at the time, except for the corpus of signs that had been built by epigraphist and civil servant Iravatham Mahadevan and Indologist Asko Parpola. Wells says he soon realised that the corpus

• THE MAIN THEORIES

BRAHMI SCRIPT: Sir Alexander Cunningham, who reported the discovery of a seal from Harappa long before the ruins came to light, suggested that the inscription bore signs of the Brahmi script

SANSKRIT: The most notable voice connecting the Indus Script and Sanskrit was that of archaeologist S R Rao, but his theory was criticised as being ideologically biased

DRAVIDIAN: Asko Parpola and later scholar Iravatham Mahadevan supported the Dravidian or proto-Dravidian theory. The script, Parpola argued, used 'rebus' — a pictogram meant the word for the object or the action depicted, or any word that sounded similar. He connected the fish sign in the script to the Dravidian word for fish, 'min', which has a homophone meaning star

NOT A LANGUAGE AT ALL: In 2004, historian Steve Farmer, computer linguist Richard Sproat, and Indologist Michael Witzel argued the script consisted of non-linguistic symbols of political and religious significance. Of late, researcher Bahata Ansumali Mukhopadhyay argued that the script does not phonetically spell out words and that it was mainly used for commercial transactions

had several defects. "Until we had a proper computer-based database, it was pointless to try to decode the script," he says.

Computers, he says, were absolutely necessary for decoding the script simply because of the exorbitant amount of detail in the signs — there are about 5,500 texts, more than half of which were on seals found from Indus sites. "Every artefact is talking about a different subject matter," he says.

At the time, it was rare for those working on ancient scripts to make use of computers. Wells says that even with Mayan hieroglyphs, which had attracted huge monetary investments, a computer-based database was created only as recently as 2005.

Wells spent the first few years documenting every tiny scratch of Indus signs, from site reports to photographs, and every online mention. He needed a software to record the signs and, in 2006, he reached out to Andreas Fuls, a Berlin-based geodesist (scientists who measure the geometry, gravity and spatial orientation of Earth), who at that time was researching Maya archaeoastronomy. Fuls was building a software for recording ancient undeciphered scripts.

Since 2008, the two have built one of the largest databases of the Indus script — 30 tables and 1.4 million data points.

Over the last 30 years, during which he devoted himself to the script, Wells lost his eyesight to diabetes, but kept working anyway.

But he now believes that one can never decipher the script 100 per cent. "That is because there are at least 300 signs in the corpus that occur only once," he says.

About the recent attempts using AI, he says it would be a futile attempt unless one knows the language in which it is written.

A script, he says, is considered deciphered only if an entire community of archaeologists, philologists, and other specialists agree. "Now, what is the probability of a hyper nationalist from north India agreeing that the script is Dravidian?" he asks. "There will always be dissent, and the Tamil Nadu government would never have to really cough up the million dollars."

The claim to a million dollars

Shortly after then Chief Minister M K Stalin made the announcement of the prize money, Bharat Rao, a Texas-based computer programmer, claimed to have cracked the script. He first reached out to Stalin on X, then wrote an email to the minister in charge of science and technology, but received no response.

"They announced a prize, but no mechanism or evaluation method has been put in place," he says.

Using a mathematical model called cryptography, Bharat Rao, in a matter of six months, reached the conclusion that the script encoded Vedic Sanskrit. The seals, he claims, carry religious significance and spell the name of Rudra and other deities frequently. There are also stories from the Puranas inscribed on the artefacts.

Bharat Rao's claim is yet to receive scholarly approval, but he argues that he has the proof of "mathematical correctness".

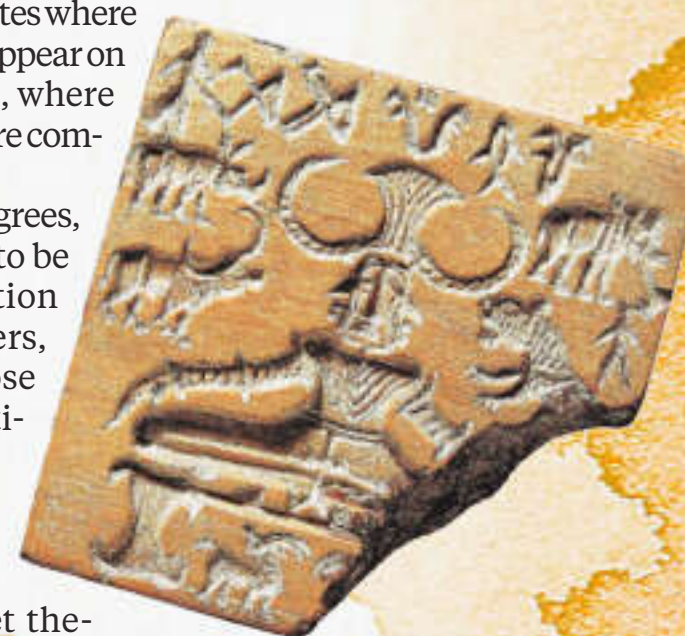
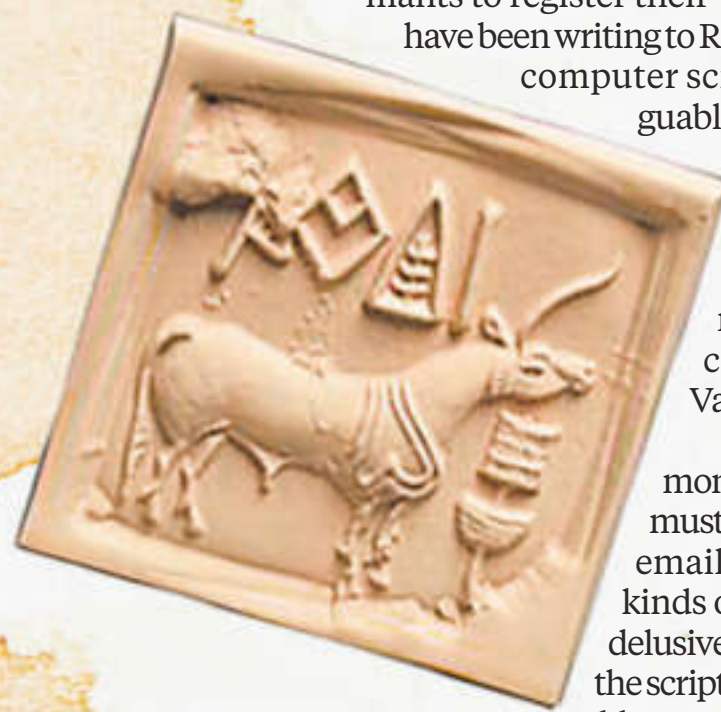
Despite this and other claims, scholars working on the Indus Civilisation say all decipherment attempts are an exercise in futility unless backed by archaeology.

UK-based Indus archaeologist Adam Green argues that the Indus script can be understood only in the backdrop of the archaeological context in which it appears. "For instance, in Mohenjodaro, we find a lot of script on copper tablets, which is not the case in other Indus sites where the script may only appear on seals, or still others, where pottery graffiti is more common," says Green.

Rajesh P N Rao agrees, saying there needs to be genuine collaboration among epigraphers, historians and those using AI and quantitative methods.

"Right now, everyone is just working on their own, with their pet theories, refusing to talk to others. Most are after some personal glory, or perhaps a million dollars," he laughs.

The writer, Head of Research at *Indianexpress.com*, reported for this article during her fellowship as a *Journalist-in-Residence* at the Max Planck Institute for the History of Science, Berlin



FEDBANK FINANCIAL SERVICES LTD. AUCTION NOTICE

Loan A/c Number	Base Branch	District 1 Contact	District Auction Date
FEDGLO1170012057, FEDGLO1170012059	Bhangel - 9555984246	BHANGEL - 9555984246	01/10/2026
FEDGLO1170012061	Bhangel - 9555984246	BHANGEL - 9555984246	02/10/2026

Loan A/c Number	Base Branch	District 1 Contact	District	Auction Date	District
FEDGL0247000631, 06532, 06533, 06657, 06673, 06975	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	11/09/2026	FEDGL0170010512	Bhangel - 9555984246
FEDGL0247000691	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	12/09/2026	FEDGL0170010522	Bhangel - 9555984246
FEDGL0247000702	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	12/09/2026	FEDGL0170010524	Bhangel - 9555984246
FEDGL0247000710	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	15/09/2026	FEDGL0170010560	Bhangel - 9555984246
FEDGL0247000716	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	18/09/2026	FEDGL0170004310	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000743	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	21/09/2026	FEDGL0170005320	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
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FEDGL0247000754	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	28/09/2026	FEDGL0170005333	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
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FEDGL0247000762	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	05/10/2026	FEDGL0170005350	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
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FEDGL0247000772	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	15/10/2026	FEDGL0170005360	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000773	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	16/10/2026	FEDGL0170005361	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
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FEDGL0247000775	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	18/10/2026	FEDGL0170005363	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
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FEDGL0247000778	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	21/10/2026	FEDGL0170005366	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000779	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	22/10/2026	FEDGL0170005367	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000780	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	23/10/2026	FEDGL0170005368	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000781	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	24/10/2026	FEDGL0170005369	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000782	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	25/10/2026	FEDGL0170005370	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000783	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	26/10/2026	FEDGL0170005371	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000784	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	27/10/2026	FEDGL0170005372	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000785	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	28/10/2026	FEDGL0170005373	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000786	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	29/10/2026	FEDGL0170005374	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000787	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	30/10/2026	FEDGL0170005375	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000788	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	31/10/2026	FEDGL0170005376	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000789	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	01/11/2026	FEDGL0170005377	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000790	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	02/11/2026	FEDGL0170005378	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000791	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	03/11/2026	FEDGL0170005379	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000792	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	04/11/2026	FEDGL0170005380	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000793	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	05/11/2026	FEDGL0170005381	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000794	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	06/11/2026	FEDGL0170005382	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000795	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	07/11/2026	FEDGL0170005383	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000796	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	08/11/2026	FEDGL0170005384	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000797	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	09/11/2026	FEDGL0170005385	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000798	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	10/11/2026	FEDGL0170005386	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000799	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	11/11/2026	FEDGL0170005387	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000800	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	12/11/2026	FEDGL0170005388	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000801	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	13/11/2026	FEDGL0170005389	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000802	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	14/11/2026	FEDGL0170005390	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000803	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	15/11/2026	FEDGL0170005391	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000804	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	16/11/2026	FEDGL0170005392	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000805	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	17/11/2026	FEDGL0170005393	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000806	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	18/11/2026	FEDGL0170005394	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000807	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	19/11/2026	FEDGL0170005395	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000808	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	20/11/2026	FEDGL0170005396	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000809	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	21/11/2026	FEDGL0170005397	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000810	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	22/11/2026	FEDGL0170005398	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000811	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	23/11/2026	FEDGL0170005399	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000812	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	24/11/2026	FEDGL0170005400	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000813	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	25/11/2026	FEDGL0170005401	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000814	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	26/11/2026	FEDGL0170005402	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000815	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	27/11/2026	FEDGL0170005403	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000816	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	28/11/2026	FEDGL0170005404	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000817	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	29/11/2026	FEDGL0170005405	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000818	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	30/11/2026	FEDGL0170005406	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000819	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	01/12/2026	FEDGL0170005407	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000820	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	02/12/2026	FEDGL0170005408	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000821	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	03/12/2026	FEDGL0170005409	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000822	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	04/12/2026	FEDGL0170005410	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000823	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	05/12/2026	FEDGL0170005411	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000824	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	06/12/2026	FEDGL0170005412	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000825	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	07/12/2026	FEDGL0170005413	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000826	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	08/12/2026	FEDGL0170005414	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000827	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	09/12/2026	FEDGL0170005415	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000828	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	10/12/2026	FEDGL0170005416	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000829	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	11/12/2026	FEDGL0170005417	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000830	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	12/12/2026	FEDGL0170005418	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000831	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	13/12/2026	FEDGL0170005419	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000832	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	14/12/2026	FEDGL0170005420	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000833	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	15/12/2026	FEDGL0170005421	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000834	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	16/12/2026	FEDGL0170005422	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000835	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	17/12/2026	FEDGL0170005423	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000836	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	18/12/2026	FEDGL0170005424	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000837	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	19/12/2026	FEDGL0170005425	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000838	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	20/12/2026	FEDGL0170005426	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000839	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	21/12/2026	FEDGL0170005427	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000840	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	22/12/2026	FEDGL0170005428	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000841	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	23/12/2026	FEDGL0170005429	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000842	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	24/12/2026	FEDGL0170005430	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000843	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	25/12/2026	FEDGL0170005431	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000844	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	26/12/2026	FEDGL0170005432	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000845	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	27/12/2026	FEDGL0170005433	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000846	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	28/12/2026	FEDGL0170005434	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000847	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	29/12/2026	FEDGL0170005435	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000848	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	30/12/2026	FEDGL0170005436	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000849	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	31/12/2026	FEDGL0170005437	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000850	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	01/01/2027	FEDGL0170005438	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000851	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	02/01/2027	FEDGL0170005439	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000852	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	03/01/2027	FEDGL0170005440	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000853	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	04/01/2027	FEDGL0170005441	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000854	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	05/01/2027	FEDGL0170005442	Bulandshahr - 9559160828
FEDGL0247000855	Aasandh- 9996599565	karnal - 7015335053	06/01/2027	FEDGL0170005443	Bulandshahr - 955

Change in Venue or Date, if any, will be displayed on our Website <https://www.fedina.com/gold-loan/special-sections/auction-venue/>. Customer who want to release their ornaments shall visit any of the above branch/es or contact at the number mentioned above on/or before auction Date subject to the terms and condition applicable. Auction will be conducted at respective Districts. In case the auction does not get completed on the given date due to any reasons, the auction in respect thereto shall be conducted on subsequent working days at district level as per above schedule. This would continue till the auction process is over. On failure of the first offline auction at District level, auction will also be initiated through the E-auction platforms of SAMIL <https://gold.samil.in> and/or e-Procurement Technologies Ltd. (AuctionTiger) - <https://egold.auctiontiger.net/>.



GOVERNMENT OF INDIA, MINISTRY OF RAILWAY
RESEARCH DESIGNS & STANDARDS ORGANISATION
Manak Nagar, Lucnow-11.
Notice for inviting E-Tender

For and on behalf of president of Union of India. The Jt. Director/Civil RDSO, Lucknow invites open E- Tender (online) for the following work: -

S. N.	Open tender No.& Name of work	Approx.cost (Rs.)	Earnest Money (Rs.)	Completion period	Date of closing/opening
1	Tender Notice No. WKS-1477A-DC dated 06.08.2026 Provision of the new water pipeline for the STP treated water provision in parks, banglows/quarters lawn.	1,98,12,488.49	3,96,300.00	10 (Ten) Months	02.09.2026

Details of above E-tenders are available on web site. (www.irops.gov.in). Tenderers can submit their bids upto 15.00 hrs of dt. 02.09.2026. The above E-tender will be opened on same day at 15.00 hrs. in the office of the Director/Civil, RDSO, Manak Nagar, Lucknow.

Note. Due to administrative reasons, the earlier tender for the work, which was scheduled to be opened on 19.08.2026, has been cancelled. The same work is being re-tendered, and the tender will now be opened on 02.09.2026.

Sd/-
Jt Director/Civil
RDSO, Lucknow,
For and on behalf of the
President of union of India

RO No. 23/2026-27/Civil



SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
Track Machine/Engineer Department
e-Tender

Srl. No. (1) Tender No.: SECR-TM-Tools -2026-06, Date: 24-07-2026
Name of Work: Supply, Erection and commissioning of complete arrangement of Pneumatic tools with pipeline, compressor & accessories at Satellite Depot, Nagpur/SECR.
Tender Value: ₹ 17,75,040.96
Tender closing date & time: 11:00 Hours of 17/08/2026.
Sr. No. (2) Tender No.: SECRHQENGGM-BRN-2026-05A, Date: 29-07-2026
Name of Work: Supply, fixing and welding of gantry rails to BRN wagons for use of TRT machine.
Tender Value: ₹ 2,36,02,820.00
Tender closing date & time: 11:00 Hours of 20/08/2026
For full details of tender notice and tender documents, tenderer may login to the website: www.irops.gov.in. No manual tenders will be entertained against E-Tender.
Executive Engineer/T.M.H.Q. CPR/10/321 S.E.C. Railway, Bilaspur.
South East Central Railway X@secrail



RAJASTHAN HOUSING BOARD

No. :- 104 Dated :- 10/08/2026

NIB No. - 02/2026-27

Bid for 1. Construction of EWS-80 nos & LIG-120 nos (SRS-2025) Houses at Langera Residential Scheme Barmer 2. Construction of Boundry Wall in Park and Toe Wall in PU, OCF, Institutional and Educational etc at Sector-1, 8, 9 and 10 at Shiv Bari Scheme, Bikaner 3. Tree Plantations & Maintenance work for 3 year in various RHB Schemes Ph-II, under Division-I Jodhpur 4. Plantation & Plants Maintenance work at RHB Keru Land Jodhpur 5. Tree Plantations & Maintenance work for 3 year in various RHB Schemes Ph-I, under Division-I Jodhpur are invited from interested bidders from 12.08.2026 to 01.09.2026 upto 06:00 PM. Other particulars of Bids are available on the procurement portal (<https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> & sppp.rajasthan.gov.in) of the State and RHB's website www.rhb.rajasthan.gov.in.

UBN No. :- RHB2627WLOB00139, RHB2627WSOB00140, 141, 142 & 143
Raj.Samwad/C/26/9350 Addl. Chief Engineer-II, Jodhpur



UJVNL LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763508, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No: 665 Date: 11/08/2026

e-Tender Notice

Office of the Dy. General Manager (M&U-Yamuna Valley) UJVNL Limited, Hydol Colony, Dhalipur, Dehradun (Uttarakhand) invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:
TenderNo-02/DGM(M&U-YY)/UJVNL/2026-27
Name of work. - Under water Inspection of the Water conductor system of 4X60 MW Chibro Hydroelectric Project by Remote-Operated Vehicle (ROV)
Estimated cost: Rs. 4,10,30,000.00 (GST Extra)
Date of availability of bid document on website: 13.08.2026 at 16:00 hrs.
Last date for submission of bids on website: 04.09.2026 at 17:00 hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal <http://uktenders.gov.in>
Dy. General Manager

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"



राजस्थान सरकार
राष्ट्रीय स्वास्थ्य मिशन, राजस्थान
विकिर्सा स्वास्थ्य एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग, स्वास्थ्य भवन,
विक्रमगढ़, राजस्थान, जयपुर।
Email id- sso-nmh-p-g@nic.in

समाचार/समाचारकर्मी / सल्लोके / Telemanas Tender/2026/158 दिनांक- 5/8/2026

NOTICE INVITING E-BID
NIB NO. MMS 2627A 2298

E-bid for Request for Proposal (RFP) for Selection of a Project Management Unit (PMU) for Operation & Management of Tele-MANAS Services estimated value IN 7.11 Crores is invited from interested bidders up to date 25.08.2026. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> or <https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in>) of the state, and departmental website, <https://rajswasthya.rajasthan.gov.in>

Sd/-
Mission Director
National Health Mission (NHM)

DIPRC/C/13879/2026

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

For and on behalf of President of Republic of India, Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/Construction-II) North Western Railway, Jaipur issues following corrigendum in EPC Tender No. EL-C-EPC-TRD-IP-T01-25-26 "Design, Supply, Erection, Testing & Commissioning of 132KV/2X25KV Traction Sub Stations (Scott Connected Transformer) with associated Switching Posts for 2 x 25 KV/AT feeding system & SCADA In Jaipur - Sawaimadhopur section of Jaipur Division of North Western Railway.

Corrigendum-3

Published details	Corrigendum details
Amendment No.3- not included in document	Standard EPC Tender Document for single stage two packet system (Amendment No.3) as corrigendum-3 which is available on IREPS website www.irops.gov.in

All other terms and conditions will remain same

1173-DE/26 Dy Chief Electrical Engineer/Construction-II), Jaipur



दक्षिणांचल विद्युत वितरण निगम लि०
अधीक्षणा अभियन्ता विद्युत वितरण मण्डल-हाथरस

पत्रांक- 2764/वि०वि०म०हा०/विज्ञापन/ दिनांक: 11/08/2028

अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना

1- EDCH-28/2026-27- विद्युत वितरण मण्डल हाथरस के क्षेत्रान्तर्गत "टर्नकी आधार पर पूर्णजमा योजना मद में नामाभि गये क्रमान्तर्गत कार्य कराये जाना।
ई-निविदा की अंतिम तिथि: 17.08.2026, विस्तृत जानकारी एवं प्रपत्र वेबसाइट <https://etender.up.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध है। अग्रेतर समस्त सूचनाएँ वेबसाइट पर ही प्रदर्शित की जाएंगी।

हस्ता./-
अधीक्षणा अभियन्ता

कार्यालय अधीक्षणा अभियन्ता जल संसाधन वृत, जयपुर

क्रमांक :- 1324 दिनांक :- 04/08/2026

ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 05/2026-27

UBN No.-	NIB Code No.-
राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से कार्य Restoration of Waste Weir & Rehabilitation of VRB & Channelization of D/S flow channel of Khejdi Dam teh Chaksu District Jaipur जिसकी अनुमानित लागत 244.46 lakh (including GST) लाख है। चित्त विभाग के नवीन नियमों के तहत सक्षम श्रेणी में पंजीकृत संवेदकों से ई-निविदा के माध्यम से ई-प्रोक्युमेंट प्रक्रिया हेतु आनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा अपलोड करने की अंतिम दिनांक 01.09.2026 है। निविदा से संबंधित विवरण संबंधित वेबसाइट www.waterresources.rajasthan.gov.in , http://www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in , http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in से देखी जा सकती	

अधीक्षणा अभियन्ता जल संसाधन वृत, जयपुर।
UBN No. WRD2627WSOB00475
DIPRC/C/13978/2026

राजस्थान सरकार

कार्यालय जिला रसद अधिकारी, सवाई माधोपुर, (राज.)

Email:- dsoswm@gmail.com
NOTICE INVITING TENDER

E-Bids for Selection of Transporter For Handling and Transportation of Food grains Under PDS from FCI Depots To FPS in District sawai madhopur are invited Online Tender through e-proc from interested bidders up to 25-08-2026. For Complete details of downloading/ uploading/ submitting of tender form and all other conditions of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> or <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in>) of the state, The approximate value of the procurement is 4.00 cr. for One year.

Sd/-
कार्यालय जिला रसद अधिकारी,
सवाई माधोपुर, (राज.)

**UBN CODE:- FCC2627SLRCC00096 कार्यालय जिला रसद अधिकारी,
DIPRC/C/14189/2026 सवाई माधोपुर, (राज.)**

INDIAN RAILWAYS
GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS
(RAILWAY BOARD)
E-TENDER NO.2026RSI1741TC

Principal Executive Director, Railway Stores (S), Ministry of Railways, Railway Board, Government of India invites e-tender for procurement of 42,396 Nos. Constant Contact Side Bearers (CCSB) for BG bogie wagons to RDSO Specification No. WD-62-Misc.-17 (Rev-1) July-2025 variant B To drawing No. WD-12008-S/1 (Alt-3) for BOXN type wagons (34,076 Nos.) and WD-62-Misc.-17 (Rev-1) July-2025 variant C to drawing No. WD-12007-S/1 (Alt-3) for BOBRN type wagons (8,320 Nos.) through E-Reverse Auction.

2.0 The interested tenderers are advised to visit the website <http://irops.gov.in> for details of the tender and submission of their e-bids.

3.0 No manual offers will be accepted against e-tender.

4.0 Tender will be closed at 15.00 hours on 14.09.2026.

5.0 Any corrigendum to this tender will be published on the website <http://irops.gov.in> only and not in print media.

Director, Railway Stores (W),
Ministry of Railways, Railway Board, New Delhi,
For and on behalf of the President of India

2774/26 SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

CONSTABLE	Security Force remember its gallant
 DHANPAL SINGH 113 BN BSF 01.04.1969 – 12.08.1994	Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Dhanpal Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting with militants in Kishwar area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.
 CONSTABLE KARTAR CHAND 17 BN BSF 01.05.1970 – 12.08.2001	Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Kartar Chand on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries in a grenade blast, triggered by militants in Kupwara area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.
 HEAD CONSTABLE SANJAY KUMAR DUBEY 149 BN BSF 06.02.1982 – 12.08.2023	Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Head Constable Sanjay Kumar Dubey on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he made ultimate sacrifice while on operational duty in area of Ibrahim Ki Dhani, Jaisalmer (Rajasthan).
 Veer Balidant Lance Naik Bashir Hussain 98 Bn 14-1-1954 To 12-8-1991	Director General and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Lance Naik Bashir Hussain of 98 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating terrorists during an area domination patrol in Punjab on 12 August 1991. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.
 Veer Balidant Sub Inspector Dalip Singh 44 Bn 8-3-1938 To 12-8-1992	DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Sub Inspector Dalip Singh of 44 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating militants during an attack on the Bank of India at Lal Chowk, Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir on 12 August 1992. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.
 Veer Balidant Constable Shankar Lal Walker 10 Bn 20-7-1969 To 12-8-2000	DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Shankar Lal Walker of 10 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being grievously injured in a cowardly attack by militants in Jammu & Kashmir on 12 August 2000. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Office of the Chief Engineer Water Resources Zone Jodhpur

Notice Inviting Bid (NIB No - CE/WRD/JDPR/002/2026-27)
NIB-WRD2627A0179

Notice inviting Bid for 01 work (Raipur & Renovation work of Jawai Canal System Tehsil Sumerpur, Dist. Pali) Rs 2098.03 Lacs in the State of Rajasthan India invited from interested bidders' Date of sale of Bid 31.07.2026 to 31.08.2026 up to 13:00 hours. Date of receiving of Bid 31.08.2026 up to 18:00 hours and Bid will be opened on 01.09.2026 at 15:00 hours. Other particulars of the Bid may be visited on the <http://sppp.raj.nic.in> and <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> of the state., and Water Resources department Rajasthan website.
UBN: WRD2627WLOB00396

Sd/-
Chief Engineer

DIPRC/C/13840/2026 Water Resources Zone Jodhpur

District WELFARE OFFICER, GURUGRAM

जिला कल्याण अधिकारी, गुरुग्राम प्रथम तल, 0124-2305415
E-Mail- dwogrg@hry.nic.in

प्रैस नोट

डा० अम्बेडकर मेधावी छात्र संशोधित योजना वर्ष 2026-27

वर्ष 2026-27 मे विभाग द्वारा अनुसूचित जाति, विमुक्त जाति, धुमंतु अर्ध धुमंतु व टपरीवास जातियों, पिछड़े वर्ग व सामान्य वर्ग के छात्र/छात्राओं हेतु डा० अम्बेडकर मेधावी छात्र संशोधित योजना का परिचालन किया जा रहा है जिसके तहत 10वी, 12 वीं व ग्रेजुएट मे उत्कृष्ट अंक प्राप्त करने वाले छात्र/छात्राओं जिनकी पारिवारिक वार्षिक आय 4.00 लाख रु से अधिक ना हो के लिए 17.8.2026 से आनलाईन आवेदन पत्र आमंत्रित किए गए हैं। स्क्रीमानुसार छात्रवृत्ति हेतु अंक प्रतिशतता का विवरण निम्न अनुसार है:-

क्र० सं०	कैटेगरी	कक्षा	प्रतिशतता
		ग्रामीण	शहरी
1	अनुसूचित जाति, विमुक्त जाति, धुमंतु अर्ध धुमंतु व टपरीवास जातियों	10वीं 12वीं न्यूनतम	60 70 65
2	पिछड़े वर्ग ए०	10वीं	60 70
3	पिछड़े वर्ग बी०	10वीं	75 80
4	सामान्य वर्ग	10वीं	75 80

उक्त शर्तों के आधार पर योग्य छात्र/छात्राएँ विभागीय पोर्टल पर saralharyana.gov.in पर आवेदन कर सकते हैं। आवेदन पत्र प्राप्त करने के अंतिम तिथि 30.11.2026 निर्धारित की गई है। स्क्रीम संबंधी विस्तृत जानकारी sewa.haryana.gov.in पर उपलब्ध है।

हस्ता./-
जिला कल्याण अधिकारी
गुरुग्राम।

No. 48072/HRY

UJVNL Limited
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone-0135-2763508, 2763808; Fax 0135-2763507
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866

RO No. 668 NOTICE INVITING TENDER Dated : 11/08/2026
Office of the Executive Engineer PCM Dhalipur, Dehradun invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of the tender is given below:
Tender No.- 20/EE/PCM/Dhalipur/2026-27 & 21/EE/PCM/Dhalipur/2026-27
Name of work:- 1. Hiring of one number Mahindra & Mahindra, Tata Sumo, Bolero or equivalent diesel vehicle along with driver for the office of Dy. General Manager (CM) Dhalipur, Dehradun.
2. Hiring of one number Mahindra & Mahindra, Tata Sumo, Bolero or equivalent diesel vehicle along with driver for the office of Executive Engineer PCM Dhalipur, Dehradun
Estimated value of Tender: Rs. 5,18,964.00 Each (GST Extra)
Date & Time of availability of bid document on website: 11.08.2026 at 17:00 Hrs
Last Date & Time for submission of tender: 01.09.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs
For fuller and further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "<https://ujvnl.uk.gov.in>".
Executive Engineer
PCM-Dhalipur, Dehradun

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
ELECTRICAL CIRCLE (R&B)
NIRMAN SOUDHA BHUBANESWAR
E-mail seec.bbsr2010@gmail.com

Bid Identification No.S.E.E.C (R&B) 29/2026-27

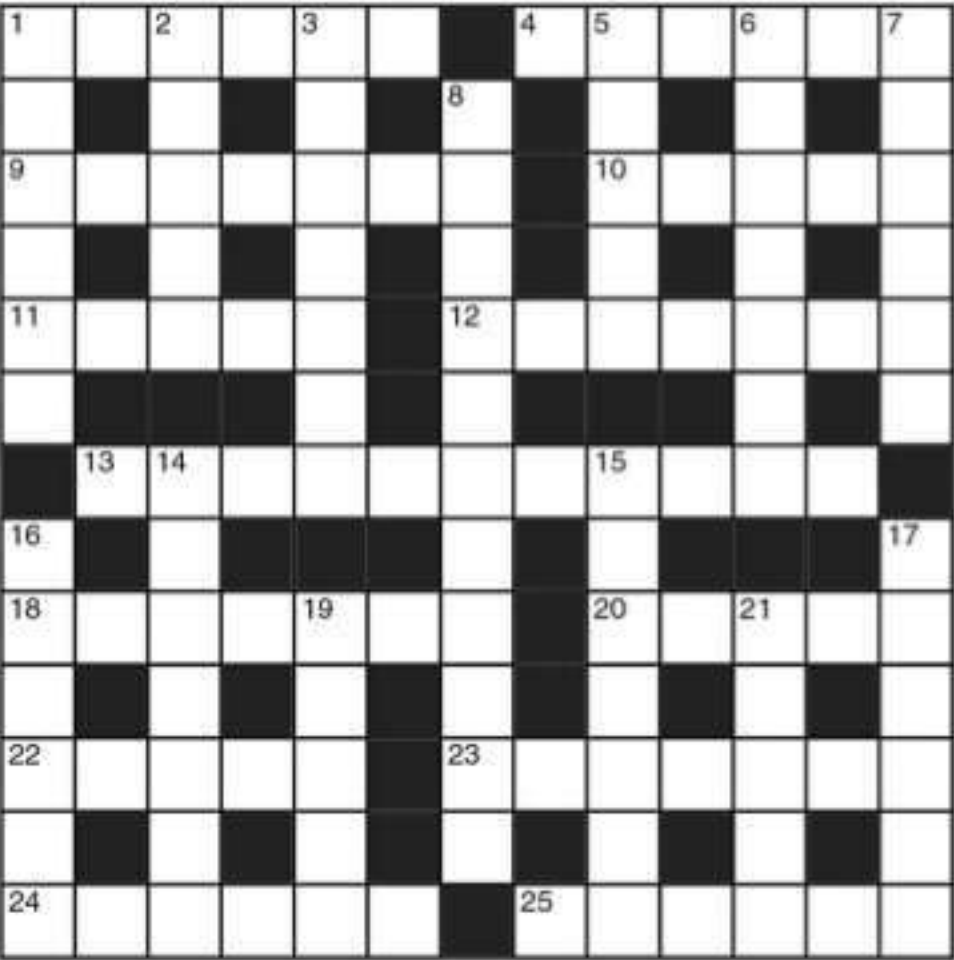
No. 3822 Date 10-08-2026

The Superintending Engineer, Electrical Circle (R&B) Odisha, Bhubaneswar on behalf of the Governor of Odisha invites percentage rate bids for E.I. works which are to be received through online bidding, double cover system as detailed in :<https://tendersorissa.gov.in>. The details of bid documents will be available in the above website from dt. 21.08.2026 at 05.00 P.M. to dt.05.09.2026 up to 05.00 P.M. The bidders must possess compatible Digital Signature Certificate of Class II or III. Bids received online shall be opened dt.07.09.2026 at 11.30 A.M. in the Office of the Superintending Engineer, Electrical Circle (R&B) Odisha, Bhubaneswar. Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal www.tendersorissa.gov.in.
Addendum / Corrigendum, if required, will be available only in the Website.

Sd/-
Chief Engineer (Roads-I), Odisha
OIPR-34001/34006/1/26-27/0030

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA CORRIGENDUM				
Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD CORP./AUTH	OLD REFERENCE/NET NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH
1	THE ROHTAK CO OP MILK PRODUCERS UNION LTD. ROHTAK	2026_HRC_53565A_1 2026_HRC_53565A_1 2026_HRC_53565A_1	DATE EXTENDED UPTO 13.08.2026 AT 16:00 PM OPENING ON 14.08.2026 AT 11:30 AM	vitanidha@gmail.com
2	THE ROHTAK CO OP MILK PRODUCERS UNION LTD. ROHTAK	2026_HRC_536442_1	DATE EXTENDED UPTO 17.08.2026 AT 16:00 PM OPENING ON 18.08.2026 AT 11:30 AM	vitanidha@gmail.com
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in				No.4809/HRY

CROSSWORD



- ACROSS
- 1 She shows skill in carving ham (6)
- 4 A row of a scarf knitted (6)
- 9 A case for the government chiefs (7)
- 10 Work hard to clean some of the tennis courts (5)
- 11 Agree to execute an order in coded signal (5)
- 12 Without brakes? Without breaks! (7)
- 13 A fraction of the money the actor gets (4-7)
- 18 He gets a countermand to stop at sea (5,2)
- 20 Allowance that was general in the US (5)
- 22 Brown arrived and left (5)
- 23 Community centre for retired ladies (7)
- 24 Sea air (6)
- 25 Bluff king and his successor (6)
- DOWN
- 1 Scotsman saw strange birds (6)
- 2 A subject causing trouble? (5)
- 3 Gift for the poor - a welcome gesture (7)
- 5 How bread's gone up! (5)
- 6 One of the toasts that may be offered with a meal (7)
- 7 A close shave? (6)
- 8 Buy drinks and a slice of bread (5,6)
- 14 Hardly a full-blooded complaint (7)
- 15 Bright red name-tag perhaps (7)
- 16 They check the movement of aircraft on the ground (6)
- 17 Stopped wearing corsets (6)
- 19 Uplifting story about one port (5)
- 21 Time has not diminished the spy (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6064 ACROSS: 1 Apostle, 5 Pipit, 8 Hot on the trail, 9 Skein, 10 Melanie, 11 Coarse, 12 Campus, 15 Leeward, 17 Abaft, 19 Infant prodigy, 20 Gates, 21 Sleigh DOWN: 1 Ashes, 2 On the face of it, 3 Tenants, 4 Exhume, 5 Petal, 6 Plain speaking, 7 Tilters, 11 Calling, 13 A la mode, 14 Adopts, 16 Annus, 18 Tryst

JUMBLLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip. We must learn to live together as ____ or perish together as fools. - Martin Luther King Jr (8)

IMPER

ADHOR

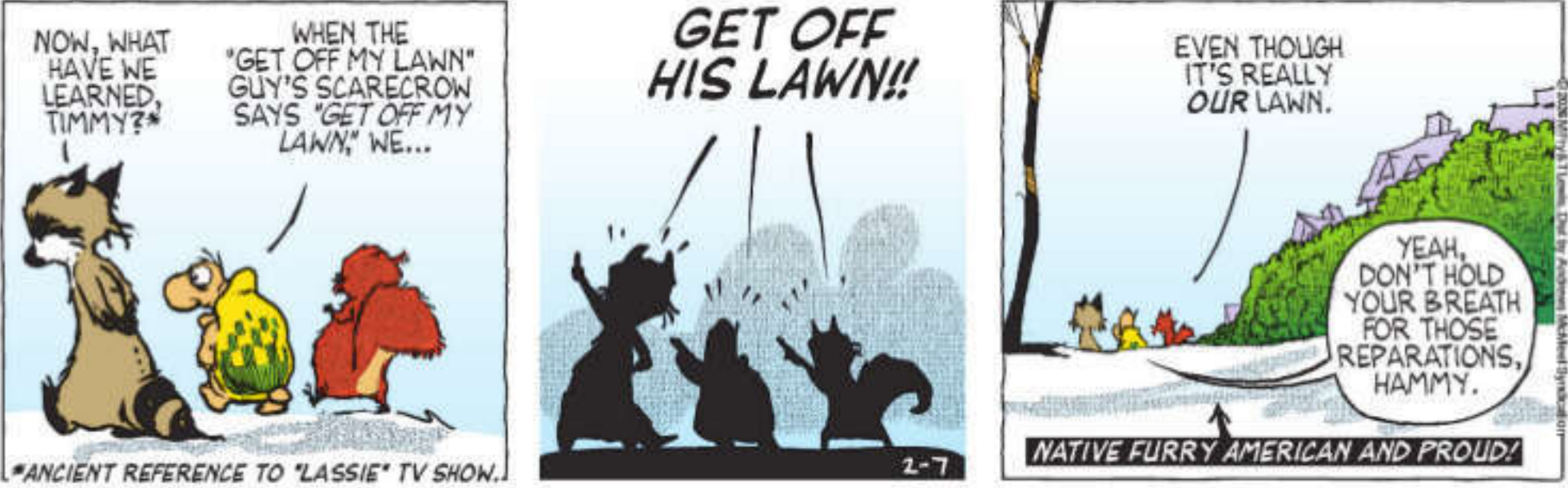
IILPST

AMSUBH

fools. - Martin Luther King Jr

ANSWER: We must learn to live together as brothers or perish together as fools. - Martin Luther King Jr

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

6 8

5 4 9 7 8

4 2 9 3 7

9 7 2 4 1

3 5

1 7 6 2 9 8 4

SUDOKU 6408

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6407

8 4 7 6 1 2 9 5 3

1 9 5 3 7 8 6 4 2

6 2 3 4 5 9 8 7 1

4 1 6 5 9 7 3 2 8

3 8 2 1 6 4 7 9 5

5 7 9 2 8 3 4 1 6

9 6 4 8 2 5 1 3 7

2 3 1 7 4 6 5 8 9

7 5 8 9 3 1 2 6 4

ROYAL STARS

- ♈

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): This is the perfect time to hatch some new ideas and plans, perhaps related to vacations, your kids or an artistic project that appeals to you. Even though it's a sudden decision, it might lead to more stability in the future. Tonight: Socialise with others.
- ♉

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): This year you can improve your home or move to a better one. Meanwhile, today's Solar Eclipse is exactly the energy you need to make a sudden decision that can ultimately solidify things the way you want. Tonight: Relax and enjoy yourself.
- ♊

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Today's Solar Eclipse might prompt you to make a radical decision that'll push you in a new direction. This might relate to your siblings, relatives or neighbours. Tonight: A discussion.
- ♋

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): The New Moon today is a dazzling Solar Eclipse that takes place in your Money House, which could trigger a new way of thinking for you about how you want to handle your money. The result might be more reliable. Tonight: Check your belongings.
- ♌

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Today, a dazzling Solar Eclipse takes place in your sign. This will give you the impetus to make a sudden decision that ultimately brings more security or stability to your world. Tonight: You're strong.
- ♍

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Because today's Solar Eclipse is taking place in a hidden part of your chart, it could make you excited and restless in a vague way. You might feel you want to begin something new. Get ready to act on your feelings. Tonight: Do some thinking.
- ♎

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): You're a social sign, and today the Solar Eclipse is in your House of Friendships making you entertain some ideas about your relationship with a friend or your relations with a group. Tonight: Friendships.
- ♏

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Today is the classic day to explore some ideas that affect your future. They might even be radical. Nevertheless, go with what moves you. Tonight: You're admired.
- ♐

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): You are the traveller of the zodiac. Today's Solar Eclipse will encourage you to do something unusual, even radical. It might relate to publishing, higher education, medicine, the law or travel. Go for it. Decide to shape your future. Tonight: Learn and explore.
- ♑

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): This is an interesting day because the Solar Eclipse might prompt you to think about a new approach to shared property or inheritances. What you decide might ultimately be a more sensible decision. Tonight: Check your finances.
- ♒

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Today the Solar Eclipse is taking place directly opposite your sign, which will encourage you to think of a radically new approach to your closest relationships. Don't hesitate to share these ideas with someone, because it could be a game-changer. Tonight: Genuinely listen to someone.
- ♓

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): This is the perfect day to entertain new ideas related to your job, health or pet. This is because you might make a sudden decision that somehow leads to greater future security for you. Ironically, it might be a radical decision. Tonight: Get something done.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.PC. /84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Faheem Qureshi, S/o: Sadik Qureshi, R/o: H.No. E-150, Buland Masjid, Shastri Park, Delhi,** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 241/2019, U/s: 379/411/34 IPC,** registered at **P.S.: Subzi Mandi, Delhi,** and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Faheem Qureshi,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Faheem Qureshi,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Faheem Qureshi, FIR No.: 241/2019, U/s: 379/411/34 IPC,** registered at **P.S.: Subzi Mandi, Delhi,** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.09.2026.**

By Order
Ms Preeti Rajoria,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07,
Room No. 32, Central Distt.,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/10937/N/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Manas Gupta, S/o Madan Mohan Gupta R/o RZ-4A, T/F, B/S Plot No. B-304, Uttam Nagar, Jain Park, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence Case **FIR No. 3722/2022 u/s 138 NI Act at P.S. Moti Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Manas Gupta** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Manas Gupta** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s **82 Cr.P.C.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Manas Gupta** accused of **FIR No. 3722/2022 u/s 138 NI Act at P.S. Moti Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.10.2026.**

By Order: Shri. Gaurav Singal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06 (West),
West, Room No.- 355,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/10763/WD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Pankaj @ Nonu S/o Ravi Kumar R/o H. No. 9733, Gali No. 09, Multani Dhandha, Paharganj, New Delhi-110055** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 33/2017 U/s 356/379/411/34/174A IPC, P.S. Rajinder Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Pankaj @ Nonu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Pankaj @ Nonu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Pankaj @ Nonu** of case **FIR No. 33/2017 U/s 356/379/411/34/174A IPC, P.S. Rajinder Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.10.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Preeti
Judicial Magistrate First Class -03
Cental District, Room No. 150
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/10561/CD/2026 (Court Matter)

GREATER VISAKHAPATNAM MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

VISAKHAPATNAM

RFP Tender Notice No.01/2026-27/CE (GVMC) / SE (Projects) / EE (PD-I) / GVMC/ Dt: 11-08-2026

01. No. of Works : 1 (One) (RFQ Tender)

02. Downloading Starting Date : 11-08-2026 @ 6.00 PM

03. Downloading End Date : 31-08-2026 @ 5.00 PM

04. Last date for Submission of bid : 31-08-2026 @ 5.00 PM

Further details at <http://www.appecurement.gov.in>

O/o The Executive Engineer (PD-I) Division Sd/- Commissioner, GVMC

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited

Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Palgh Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad- 500003, Telangana, India
CIN: U40109TG1997PLC028483

(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD-MMD- GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Refurbishment of coal burner nozzles and tips.

1 Tender Enquiry No. 185GATP/BMD-26-27/50007647
"Procurement for Refurbishment of coal burner nozzles and tips." at 2X279 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Dist.: Tam Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from 11/08/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.

Notes- Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>

No. 14132/PH GATP-7826

PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE TO SH. SURMUKH SINGH & THE GENERAL PUBLIC

In connection with the investigation of **FIR No. 106/2016, Dated 10.02.2016,** registered under **Sections 420/468/471/120B/506/34 IPC at Police Station- Sangam Vihar, New Delhi,** it has been revealed that **Sh. Surmukh Singh, S/o Sh. Gurdas Singh, R/o Sector 16, Faridabad, Haryana,** is stated to be the owner of Plot No. 2963/1046, Gali No. 16, H-Block, Sangam Vihar, New Delhi. **Sh. Surmukh Singh** is hereby directed to appear before the Investigating Officer, DIU South, First Floor, Police Station Malviya Nagar, New Delhi, **within 30 days** of publication of this notice, along with relevant documents relating to the aforesaid property. Any person claiming ownership, possession, or any legal interest in the said property, or having information regarding the present whereabouts of **Sh. Surmukh Singh,** may also appear before the Investigating Officer within the aforesaid period and furnish relevant information/documents.

Investigating Officer
District Investigation Unit (DIU), South District
First Floor, Police Station Malviya Nagar
New Delhi

DP/11033/SD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rishi Kumar, S/o: Mukesh Kanodia, R/o: BM-70, West Shalimar Bagh, North West Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 107/24, U/s 406 IPC, P.S.: Kotwali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rishi Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rishi Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Rishi Kumar** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 107/24, U/s 406 IPC, P.S.: Kotwali, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.09.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Sayesha Chadha
Judicial Magistrate First Class-08 (Central)
Room No. 272, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/10640/N/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

SEE SECTION 84 BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURKSHA SANHITA

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused Persons Namely **Anuj S/o Manoj R/o Vill. Charkhi, Distt.-Dadri, Haryana & Old Bharat Nagar, near Bus Stand, Kadam Chowk, Distt-Bhiwani, Haryana,** have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 125/2026 U/s 309(4)/311/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita,** has been registered at **PS: Vikaspuri, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Anuj** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Anuj** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused said, **Anuj** of **FIR No. 125/2026 U/s 309(4)/311/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita,** has been registered at **PS: Vikaspuri, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.09.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Vinod Kumar
JMFC-05
Dwarka Court, New Delhi

DP/11192/WD/2026
(Court Notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Saleem @ Irshad S/o Chiddan R/o E-589, Gali No.4, Sri Ram Colony, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 604/2017 U/S 325/34 IPC, PS Khajuri Khas, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Saleem @ Irshad** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Saleem @ Irshad** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Saleem @ Irshad** of **FIR No. 604/2017 U/S 325/34 IPC, PS Khajuri Khas, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **21.09.2026.**

By Order,
Ms. Shruti Saraswat
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No.22, First Floor, North-East District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/11195/NE/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. & 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Nasruddin Ansari, S/o: Munir Miyan R/o: J-242, Prem Nagar 2nd Kirari, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 583/23, U/s: 498A/304B IPC PS: Prem Nagar, Delhi,** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Nasruddin Ansari,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Nasruddin Ansari,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Nasruddin Ansari,** of **FIR No. 583/23, U/s: 498A/304B IPC PS: Prem Nagar, Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.09.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Shagaun
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06
North West Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/10847/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Sh. Vinay Kumar Gupta S/o Sh. Ramesh Chand Gupta R/o H. No.145, Block-19, Kalyanpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Ct Case No. 4754/2019 U/s 138 NI Act PS: Kalyanpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sh. Vinay Kumar Gupta** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sh. Vinay Kumar Gupta** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sh. Vinay Kumar Gupta** accused of **Ct Case No. 4754/2019 U/s 138 NI Act PS: Kalyanpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **11.09.2026.**

By Order
Sh. P. Bhargava Rao
JMFC-05, Room No. 03
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/11185/ED/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Rohit Srivastav Authorized Signatory of M/s Maddox Tradelinks Pvt. Ltd. R/o B-3738, Sai Niwas, Bhagwati Garden, Kakrola, Uttam Nagar, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case Regd. No. 247/2017 & 482/2017 U/s NI Act, P.S. Krishna Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rohit Srivastav** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rohit Srivastav** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rohit Srivastav** of **Case Regd. No. 247/2017 & 482/2017 U/s NI Act, P.S. Krishna Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.09.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Divyram Lila
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
South East District, Room No. 508
Saket Court Complex, Delhi

DP/11156/SHD/2026 (Court Matter)

Government of Karnataka

DEPARTMENT OF HIGHER EDUCATION

6th Floor, 2nd Gate, M.S. Building, Ambedkar Veedhi, Bangalore-560 001.

No. ED/82/UNE/2026 Date: 11.08.2026

Selection of Vice-Chancellor of Karnataka Janapada Vishwavidyalaya, Gotagodi, Haveri

The Higher education department, Government of Karnataka invites online application for the selection of Vice-Chancellor of Karnataka Janapada Vishwavidyalaya, Gotagodi, Haveri, Karnataka as per section 13(2) of Karnataka Janapada Vishwavidyalaya Act, 2011 from eligible and distinguished Academicians/ Professors.

Application should be submitted online within 30 days (including general holidays) from the date of this advertisement using the link available on department of Higher education website. <https://hed.karnataka.gov.in>. It is requested to visit department of Higher education website for further information in this regard.

Sd/-
Secretary to Government
Department of Higher Education

DIP/PCP/2090/NR/2026-27

Ex-Aus player
Henriques to
lead Portugal in
T20 WC qualifier



Moises Henriques has featured in all three formats for Australia and has played in the IPL. PTI

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 11

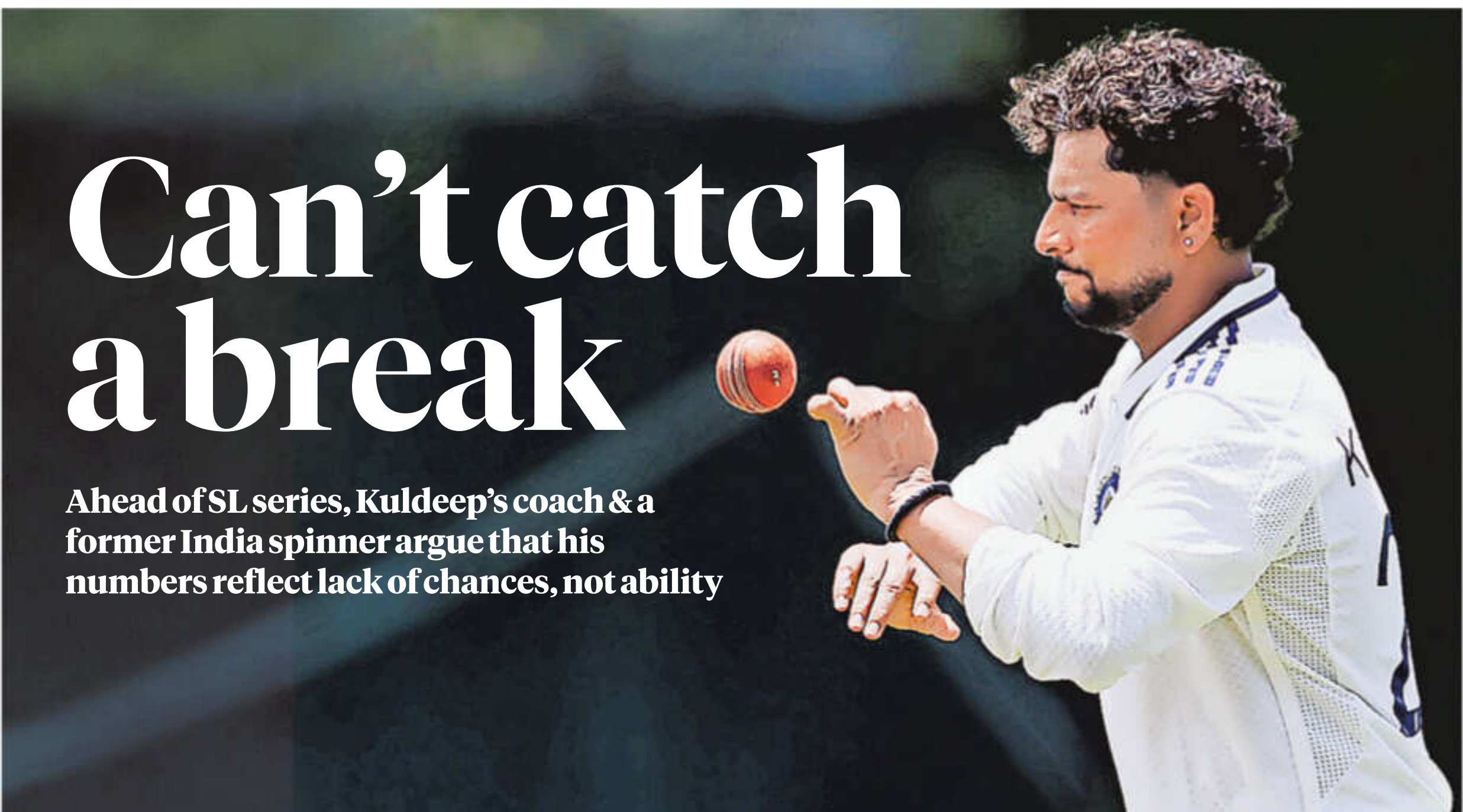
PORTUGAL HAVE found a new captain for their cricket team, and it is a name cricket fans will be familiar with. Moises Henriques, who has featured in all three formats for Australia and has also played in the Indian Premier League, will be leading the Portuguese team in their bid to qualify for the ICC Men's T20 World Cup for the first time.

On Tuesday, the Portuguese Cricket Federation announced the squad for the upcoming T20 World Cup Europe Sub-regional Qualifier C, with Henriques named as the leader of the pack. Notably, Henriques was born in Madeira — the hometown of another Portuguese national team captain, Cristiano Ronaldo — before his family moved to Australia when he was still a child.

Henriques represented Australia in 24 T20Is, 16 ODIs and four Tests. His last international appearance was in August 2021, at a T20I match against Bangladesh. He made the switch to represent Portugal in June, having already served a three-year cool-off period necessary whilst making the transition from a full-member nation to an associate.

Henriques is currently the only player in the Portugal squad to have played international cricket for another country, though they boast players who have First-Class experience in other nations. Craig Cachopa, who was born in South Africa, has played domestic cricket in both New Zealand and England. Siraj Ullah Khadem, meanwhile, is a Bangladesh-born cricketer who played at the 2006 ICC U-19 Cricket World Cup under Mushfiqur Rahim's leadership. Coincidentally, Henriques was the Australian captain in that same tournament.

The Europe Sub-regional Qualifier C will be contested amongst ten teams across two venues in Finland — Vantaa and Kerava. The ten teams have been split into two groups of five, with the two group-winners qualifying for the final. The winner of the final will qualify for the Europe Regional Qualifier, where they will compete against Scotland, Jersey and Denmark for a place in the Global Qualifier, which will ultimately decide which teams will travel to Australia and New Zealand for the 2028 Men's T20 World Cup.



Can't catch a break

Ahead of SL series, Kuldeep's coach & a former India spinner argue that his numbers reflect lack of chances, not ability

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, August 11

AFTER INDIA'S white-ball tour of Ireland and England this July, during which Kuldeep Yadav spent nearly all his time on the bench, the opportunity to play the One-Day Cup for Yorkshire came around and he didn't have any second thoughts. The plan had been Kanpur, then Sri Lanka, working under his childhood coach Kapil Dev Pandey ahead of what was a make-or-break series for the 31-year-old wrist-spinner. Instead, from London, Kuldeep changed course and headed north to Leeds, in search of game time that had been badly missing.

As India head into the series against Sri Lanka, Kuldeep finds himself in a precarious situation. Understudy to R Ashwin and Ravindra Jadeja as a third spinner, kept out by team combinations, his Test appearances stand at 18 in nine years. Even after Ashwin retired, he has played only five Tests, with Washington Sundar preferred, and now faces a fresh challenger in Manav Suthar.

"This series is made for Kuldeep," Pandey tells *The Indian Express*.

"*Uska waqt aagaya*. He has to believe it and show it to the world that he is a match-winner. Of course, the pressure is definitely on him, but at this level it is all about handling that. He has been playing for years now, so this is the time to pull all that experience together and show who he is and what he can capable of when he plays."

Finding rhythm

In the one-off Test against Afghanistan, Kuldeep showed signs of rustiness, inevitable given the time he has spent warming the bench across formats. That is why he turned out for Yorkshire, even if it meant it was one-day cricket.

"Before he landed in Sri Lanka, I wanted him to be in the rhythm," Pandey says. "No matter how many overs you bowl in the nets, in a match when the batsman is trying to put you off, you have to find that rhythm. If you can keep hitting the right line and



Manav Suthar. FILE

length when batsmen are after you, then you are in the game. So that's what he did in England," Pandey says, pointing to the five matches he played in ten days.

Pandey doesn't hide that the noise around Kuldeep since Suthar's arrival hasn't made things easy for the 31-year-old. If anything, he calls it a glorious opportunity for Kuldeep to take his game to another level. "In early years, even when Ashwin and Jadeja were there, he has played ahead of them," Pandey says. "So why can't he do it now?"

In subcontinent teams, a third-choice spinner losing his way isn't new. But in most cases, the opportunities rarely opened back up, as with Murali Kartik or Venkatapathy Raju. With Kuldeep, the story is different: a left-arm wrist-spinner is a unique breed, with enough variation up his sleeve that, played regularly, he has produced performances of note. His well-disguised variations have left batsmen struggling to read him out of the hand.

Since Ashwin's retirement, Kuldeep has one five-wicket haul in five Tests, a return that isn't bad but has been viewed through the harsh lens of a spinner not stepping up. Raju, who played much of his career in a three-pronged spin attack himself, says Kuldeep should by now be carrying the weight of expectation.

"It is an international level. You can't think about all that. We have to be ready for it. But in Kuldeep's case it is unfortunate that he doesn't get to play enough matches. That's why it makes it more difficult for him. The trust is very important. It takes a different skill to

“Uska waqt aagaya. He has to believe it and show it to the world that he is a match-winner. Of course, the pressure is on him, but at this level it is all about handling that.”

KAPIL DEV PANDEY
KULDEEP YADAV'S COACH

bowl longer spells," Raju says.

Raju doesn't hide his disappointment that India didn't make Kuldeep the second spinner the moment Ashwin retired.

"Somebody like Kuldeep shouldn't be warming the bench. Once Ashwin retired, he should have always been second choice. As long as Jadeja is there, he will play as an all-rounder. But Kuldeep being a wrist-spinner should be a straightforward choice. Whether the pitch is helpful or not, he will get you those wickets," Raju says.

Important series

The importance of the series isn't lost on Kuldeep. Before leaving for the UK, he had sessions with Pandey in Kanpur, who made him bowl. "I gave him old ball, ones that don't turn, ones which seam had worn off and even the new ball and Kookaburra," Pandey says. "What he bowls with shouldn't be a concern. If he gets the basics right, he can work magic."

In the warm-up fixture, Kuldeep showed encouraging signs, but once India head to Galle, they confront a key question. Whether the opportunity opens up for Kuldeep or not, one thing is clear for Pandey: a promise made and heard decades apart.

"This series is important. This is what he has been craving for a long time, to play Tests regularly. Last year when he didn't play a Test in England, you heard experts say had he played it could have been different. So I hope he gets an opportunity.

"It is what Kuldeep told me when I met him as a boy. *Uska waqt aagaya*."

India face steep race to reach WTC Final

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, August 11

AUSTRALIA, SOUTH Africa and New Zealand currently occupy the top three places in the World Test Championship (WTC) final race, while India faces a steep climb to get there. The next few months will offer a clearer picture for next year's final at The Oval.

Who are the current top three?

Australia lead the table with 87.5 percent after eight Tests, having won seven and lost one. South Africa are second on 75 percent from four Tests, while New Zealand are third on 72.22 percent after six. All three sides still have significant Tests remaining. Australia face South Africa and India away in October 2026 and January 2027, respectively. New Zealand have India at home followed by four Tests against Australia away before a two-Test home series against Sri Lanka, among their remaining opponents. South Africa have no more away Tests, as Australia, Bangladesh and England will come visiting for a three, two and three-match Test series from October to January. Bangladesh are fourth on 58.33 percent, ahead of India, who are fifth with 48.15 percent.

What India need to do

With the series against New Zealand and Australia still to come, India's qualification hopes depend on putting together a run of results while hoping that the teams above them drop points. India have nine Tests remaining—two in Sri Lanka, two in New Zealand and five at home against Australia. They need a strong finish, probably close to a clean sweep. They have won four, lost four and drawn one



India head coach
Gautam Gambhir. CREIMAS

of their nine Tests so far. Winning all nine Tests would take India to 74.07 percent. Seven wins and two draws would take them to 66.67 percent. Neither figure guarantees qualification because the final standings will also depend on results involving other teams.

Which teams are in danger of falling away?

Sri Lanka, England, West Indies and Pakistan are currently outside the qualification battle. Sri Lanka's 41.67 percent keeps them below India, while England, West Indies and Pakistan are further back in the table. These sides are not mathematically out of contention, but would need a strong run of results and favourable outcomes elsewhere to keep their chances alive.

Which matches could decide the race?

Australia's three-Test series against South Africa in October is one such clash: either team can strengthen its position while simultaneously denying points to a direct rival. New Zealand's meetings with India and Australia are similarly important.

The five-Test home series against Australia offers India their best opportunity to gain points. But they need to get there with their qualification hopes still intact; a poor result in Sri Lanka or New Zealand would make a difficult equation more demanding.

Sarfraz vs Jurel: India face a spin-friendly selection dilemma



India have a choice to make: Whether to slot Sarfraz Khan (L) at 5 or 6, or retain Dhruv Jurel in the line-up as a specialist batter. PTI/CREIMAS



Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, August 11

INDIA'S PREPARATIONS for the Sri Lanka Tests may have been hampered by the absence of Jasprit Bumrah, B Sai Sudharsan for the series and Washington Sundar for the first Test, but as they reached Galle on Tuesday, they appear to be a team that is fairly settled. Of course, a decision on who partners Mohammed Siraj is yet to be taken, while Devdutt Padikkal looks like he would fill Sudharsan's void at No. 3.

But there is one more spot for India to ponder — whether to slot Sarfraz Khan in at No 5 or 6 or to retain Dhruv Jurel. When Sudharsan was ruled out, the initial conversations revolved around Ruturaj Gaikwad, but it was Sarfraz who got the nod.

In many ways, his selection was a surprise. For when India A toured Sri Lanka last month, he did not feature in that squad. But the team management had been clear in terms of whom they wanted — a middle-order batsman who is equipped to bat in spin-friendly conditions. And Sarfraz fit the bill perfectly.

Case for Sarfraz

During the whitewash against South Africa last year, following the defeat in Kolkata, the team management had sought Gaikwad's inclusion for the second Test in Guwahati, only for it to be turned down. But here, when the opportunity presented itself, they have gone back to Sarfraz for primarily what he brings to the table. As reported by this newspaper earlier, India batting group's plans in Sri Lanka revolve around two aspects — the use of the sweep shot and the feet to step down the track. Sarfraz ticked those boxes as well.

The question now is whether Sarfraz will be included in the XI ahead of Dhruv Jurel. With Rishabh Pant being the first-choice wicketkeeper, Jurel has been playing as a specialist batsman since the West Indies series. Since scoring 125 in Ahmedabad, which pushed for his continued run, he has had a lean patch.

But he led India A in Sri Lanka and made 141* & 14 and 53, reiterating the potential the team management and selectors see in him. However, while a few others were among the runs in the warm-up game, Jurel returned with 1 & 17, thereby opening up a discussion over his spot in the XI.

While Jurel has stepped up at crucial junctures for India in the past, he still remains a batsman who is far from cementing his spot. His game against spin, like most of his teammates, is largely built on waiting for the bad deliveries to arrive. In conditions where spinners dominate, taking the attack to them isn't his comfort zone. The sweep shot isn't his go-to option unless being pushed into it.

Spin option

Hence, including Sarfraz becomes a tempting option. In the domestic circuit, he is amongst the most effective users of the sweep shot — conventional as well as the lap-sweep that Mumbaiers deploy thanks to their habit of batting on red soil surfaces where bounce is in play. In his limited Test appearances so far, in particular against New Zealand and England, he showed the willingness to put spinners straightaway under pressure by bringing out the sweep shots, which included the slog-sweep.

Once he put those shots to good use, he feasted when the spinners erred in their length — relying on his cut and drive. Last IPL, when Chennai Super Kings acquired him at the auction, their primary reason was his game against spinners — where he would use the square pockets to score off.

In Sri Lanka, if the ball turns and there is every reason to believe it would, particularly in Galle, then what Sarfraz offers becomes vital. Apart from being quick on his feet, he is street smart with his game against spinners. Taking calculative risks is part of his DNA, and when it gets challenging to score when the ball goes soft, then it is hard to look beyond Sarfraz.

It is what he has done consistently in the domestic circuit. While critics keep pointing out that most of his runs have come at No 5, what is also often overlooked is that, in situations where the top-order has wobbled, he has been a shock absorber. The quality to blend caution and aggression would be needed in Sri Lanka if the hosts opt for turning tracks.

Having not played any red-ball games in recent times, two net sessions are what Sarfraz has to show the team management what he can bring to the table. With Jurel being part of the original picks, they may still go ahead with him, but it is not an open-and-shut case.

• GAME ON

City of Light lights up for Esports WC as Antetokounmpo, Carlsen come calling

Mayank Chaudhary
Paris, August 11

THE ARC de Triomphe glows in the colours of the Esports World Cup. A giant screen at the Trocadéro flickers with live matches. Billboards along the Champs-Élysées flash players' faces instead of perfumes. The streets of Expo Porte de Versailles buzz with fans gathered around the entrance of the exhibition centre.

Paris has been taken over by gaming.

For seven weeks, the French capital has become the global heart of competitive gaming or rather, Esports. More than 2,000 players, 200 clubs, from over 100 countries have descended on the City of Light. A record \$75 million (approx INR 715 cr) prize pool is up for grabs across 25 tournaments. And the city, with its storied history of hosting

world-class events and multicultural exposure, has embraced its new role as the epicentre of Esports with open arms.

But this marriage of tradition and technology almost never happened. The Esports World Cup 2026 was supposed to be in Riyadh for its third straight edition. It was forced to move out just weeks before due to escalating tensions in the Middle East, and what followed was a logistical miracle.

Teams and equipment were airlifted across continents. Visas were fast-tracked. A venue was transformed. And Paris, a city known for its reverence for art and culture, opened its doors to a new kind of spectacle.

Right from the moment one steps out of Charles de Gaulle International Airport and goes towards the city centre, the effort to make this event visible is unmistakable. The under-

ground subways, metro stations, hoardings and billboards along the highways are all part of a meticulously planned campaign to ensure that the EWC is impossible to miss.

Nassim, a local Parisian, was one of those who couldn't help but notice.

"We can see the promotion, the marketing, from a remote standpoint. It's really huge. Even if you are not from the Esports community, you can see it in the streets... the billboards of the event, and it happening for so many weeks reflects the scale of this event," he says.

"There are a lot of people, not just from Paris but from all around the world, who have come here to share their love for Esports. So I believe that is a success to that degree."

Nassim calls himself a casual gamer, but today, something else brought him to the event. "I play Rainbow 6 Siege, but today I am only here for



Paris Expo Porte de Versailles, the venue of Esport World Cup. (R) James Kleban with his cousin. EXPRESS

Giannis Antetokounmpo."

Various attractions

The NBA legend came for a fan meet-and-greet session, and Nassim believes his presence has driven a surge in interest as well. The pull of such icons has been a big reason for a large crowd.

While Nassim only travelled a few kilometres, brothers Ori and Itai convinced their father to come all the way from London to meet their favourite hoopster. The duo didn't even demand an autograph from the Miami Heat star; only a selfie would do.

Ori admitted on behalf of



both brothers: "We don't know anything about it (Esports World Cup). We are only here for Gianni."

But his brother Itai also had his eyes on another icon. "I know that Magnus Carlsen is playing here. I want to meet him."

Ori is such a big fan of Antetokounmpo that he has

kept the 'Greek Freak' as his mobile phone's wallpaper.

While autographs may not work for some, Octave, who came with his little brother and mother, was content after receiving signatures from his favourite players. Octave travelled to Paris from Nancy, a city in northeastern France.

"I had a lovely time in there. I met all the professional players. They signed our cards. It was very cool. I hope to see them again tomorrow," he says.

Octave plays Rocket League with his friends and wants to do so professionally in the future. He says he is hopeful of making a career in this domain.

Making a living in Esports hasn't always been a feasible option. But now that the Esports space has outgrown its nascent stage, James Kleban's mother would like her son to give it a shot.

James, who lives in Dallas, came to the event with his French mother and cousin.

"It was a great experience for us," he says. "I am going to come tomorrow as well. It's all so fun. So cool to see all the players hanging around. Some professional athlete came and sat next to me."

He plays Fortnite and Minecraft and wishes these games would be included in the Esports category. His mother was surprised to learn that players do not represent a particular country but only a franchise. However, when she heard about the Esports Nation Cup — an event where players compete under the banner of their franchises but represent their countries — her perspective changed. Now, she wants her son to give it a serious shot.

(THE WRITER IS IN PARIS AT THE INVITATION OF THE ESPORTS FOUNDATION)

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, August 11

WHEN UNDER the cosh, Jarmanpreet Singh curls his biceps for strength. Abhishek Nain clenches his fist. Suraj Karkera taps his chest.

It isn't a physical flex. These are reminders. Each has a tattoo etched into the skin, carrying a story of its own – of family, faith, struggle, or simply the person they want to be.

As India head into the hockey World Cup this weekend, facing Wales in the opener on Saturday, there will be plenty of talk about tactics, form and the players expected to deliver when the pressure is at its highest. But beneath the jerseys, some carry something more personal – little reminders inked into their skin of where they come from, what they believe in and, sometimes, who they believe they are.

“When I am low, feeling a little down, I look at my tattoo and get confidence from it,” says Abhishek. One of India's fiercest strikers and a constant, reliable source of field goals, he has a crown inked on his knuckles – a reminder, when the chips are down, that he is the “king of the D”.

On the left knuckles, he has the word ‘Jaat’ inscribed in calligraphy. “It fills me with confidence. Makes me feel tough,” he says. “Haryanvi Jaats are mentally very tough. We walk the talk. There's this inherent zid. So whenever I look at this, I'm reminded of that.”

Faith and loyalty

The tattoos aren't merely for decoration. Each one of them tells a story. For Manpreet Singh, India's most-capped player, the ‘Ik Onkar’ on his arm is an expression of faith. The incomplete Olympic rings on Hardik Singh, arguably India's most influential player on the field, represent an ambition still unfinished. The top part of the centre ring, he says, will be completed after “winning the gold medal at the Los Angeles Olympics in 2028”.

Underneath the bulky goalkeeper kit, Karkera wears the words: ‘For those I love, I will

Ink that inspires: The stories behind India's hockey World Cup campaign



From family and faith to hardship and ambition, the tattoos of players reveal the men sporting the jerseys



(Left to right) Suraj Karkera, Abhishek Nain and Jarmanpreet Singh will man the goalpost, forward line and defence respectively for India at the hockey World Cup in Belgium and Netherlands, starting August 15. MIHIR VASAVDA

sacrifice.’ It signifies ‘deep loyalty’. “It's about putting the loved ones before myself. I also serve in the Army, so (loyalty is natural),” says Subedar Karkera.

Few tattoos, however, carry a deeper, more personal resonance than Jarmanpreet's. On his right forearm, Jarmanpreet has the Olympic rings – customary, if you are an India player – and the name of his daughter, Jind. “She was born in the morning, and I was named in the squad later that evening,” Jarmanpreet says.

But it is the tattoo on his biceps that carries the story of his struggle. The wingback – whose darting runs down the right launch many an Indian attack – has an elegant fist bump. It's a tribute to his younger brother Sandeep Singh, who

was Jarmanpreet's ‘right-hand man’ during the most ‘difficult phase of his career’.

During the 2015 Hockey India League, Jarmanpreet flunked a dope test after his sample returned positive for a banned drug, 19-norandrosterone, a metabolite of nandrolone. It entered his body, the player has argued in the past, after taking a painkiller injection from a local doctor in his village in Punjab.

Jarmanpreet was only 19 at the time. A product of Jalandhar's famous Surjit Singh Academy, he was in contention for a spot on the team for the 2016 Junior World Cup that India won. But the failed dope test led to a two-year ban, threatening to derail a promising career.

Sandeep ensured his elder

brother didn't go off the rails. “Because of the ban, I could not practice with any team or play any tournament. I couldn't be around a domestic team, either. So, I had to practice alone,” Jarmanpreet says. “My brother stood by me. He is a hockey player, too. After his training, he would ensure I could do mine. Whether it was a hot afternoon or cold evening. Weekday or Weekend. No matter what it was, he made sure I had a training session at least once a day.”

Soon after he served his ban, Jarmanpreet was picked for India. Soon after rejoining the team, he paid a touching tribute to his brother with the tattoo. “I believe if there is a bad time in the life of a player or any person for that matter, then he has to face everything alone,” Jarman-

preet says. “But there should be someone in your life who pushes you whenever you fall or feel low. For me, that person was Sandeep. He now lives in Canada and plays hockey there. But he continues to help me.”

For him, like the rest of the team, the tattoo isn't merely a decoration. It is a window into the people behind the players India will need when the World Cup begins: the striker who draws strength from his identity, the midfielder chasing an unfinished dream, the goalkeeper driven by loyalty and the defender who remembers the brother who helped him through his darkest days.

When the pressure builds and the stakes rise, these stories sit beneath the jerseys, carrying the men who wear them.

Lakshya training for the wind, not just the opponent, ahead of Worlds

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, August 11

LAKSHYA SEN has felt an Olympic bronze and an All England title, both well within reach, taken out of hands by the same element: drift.

For Sen, the invisible, uncontrollable winds have injected one lesson into his marrow: court conditions can kill the flicker in any match if he doesn't control the shuttle's whims. It happened at January's India Open in Delhi too, when he lost to Lin Chun Yi.

So, ahead of the BWF World Championships, Sen has camped at the National Centre in Guwahati to get acclimated to big halls like the Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium. For a week, he is trying to work through wavy winds, with A/C blowers operating from the front, rear and sides.

“We will change blower directions mid-rally even, and plan for everything,” says father DK Sen. ‘Everything’ is the operative part. For, counter-intuitively, a slow, dead, windless IG Stadium will open up the game for both Sen and his opponents – and he can be blitzed out. Sen needs the wind, but he needs it to be tamed his way. Where his game of hyper-controlled net strokes gives him the points. And also, where his backhand corner judgments are accurate, for that's where opponents tend to attack him.

Hard work, Sen's go-to after losses, is not the panacea. Coaches can't help much beyond the broader idea of which shots to avoid in drifty conditions. Navigating court windstorms comes down to the player alone: whether he can control the shuttle.

The Olympics highlights are not something Sen would want to revisit. 8-3 up to 8-12 against Lee Zii Jia. When he refused to still his jangling nerves, slow down, take a break or reset. When he became the confused storm himself, rushing through a phase he couldn't control.



Lakshya Sen has camped at the National Centre in Guwahati to get acclimated to big halls like the IG Indoor Stadium. PTI

When Lee manipulated the winds in Paris, sending lifts and clears he knew wouldn't fly out. From the slower end, instead of high clears, Sen tried to overhit against the wind.

Attacking, without smashing. Winds can weigh heavy in many ways. And they don't show up in video analysis. Hence, Guwahati.

Shuttle control in drifty conditions goes beyond being discerning on the lines. These are vernier-calliper adjustments to find the right length, that come with standing in the eye of the storm, reading trajectories and speeds, a hand-eye-ear coordination that demands alertness on every shot. And then some more, to judge where the opponent's returns land.

Thinking on his feet

It's not that Sen has never learnt to read drifts. One doesn't reach two All England finals, an Olympic semifinal and win the Thomas Cup without battling winds. But the simulation needs the mind and limbs to get accustomed to playing, or holding back from, certain strokes.

Massive arenas are mini-typhoons, and conditions change with the crowd size, from court to court, morning to evening, mid-rally even. The net dips on serves are tougher still to tame.

Talking about it isn't something shuttlers think of as cool. It has the whiff of an excuse. But preparing for it is a must.

Sen's preparation this time has centred on speed. Dealing with drifts also means knowing when to decelerate, slow down and find sluggish pauses in the storm so he's not blown off by the opponent's accelerations.

What the Indian has never shed away from is tough opponents. His appetite for a scrap is unlimited. He thrives on the big stage: Worlds, Olympics, noisy crowds. And he knows how to peak for the Majors.

The World Championship draw was hardly a flutter. He has avoided match-ups with ambushing speedsters, and Kunlavut Vitidsarn and Alex Lanier are in his path, testing his patience which wears thin with endless retrieving. Kunlavut brings deception at the net; Lanier plays orthodox-weird from the back court, another irritant.

Kunlavut hasn't had the best of times - losing at the crunch in recent tournaments. He hasn't titled since January, though he might well be holding back. The familiarity though can work to Sen's advantage – the H2H is 5-8 currently. The Indian doesn't fancy the shuttle coming back in endless rallies. So, he is most likely looking to make winds his disruptive ally.

Father Sen explains that fans and players look at draws very differently. He uses the word *jhujhna*: contending with a difficult situation, and calls it a player's job description.

“*Kaunsa bhi draw aage khele na hai*. Even if it's a top player, you have to deliver. *Draw leke baith gaye toh ho gaya kaam, jhujhna hoga*,” he says, dismissing any dread over Lakshya's 15th seeding. One has to deliver irrespective of the draw, so why fret. Just prepare.

Jhujhna mode is switched on. At big events, Sen's a moth to the flame. The only vents permitted are on the air-cons.

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